

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T11:50:51

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_006_neutral_rep01_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 1
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5.75; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.75, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9.25; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.85, received visible=\$11.55, returned visible=\$4.65

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.75, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.75}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.75,
"Agent_2": 9.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.65,
"Agent_2": 5.8000000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: *"This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."*

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, this is my first interaction - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and cooperation
- The risk and vulnerability in giving/sending
- The reciprocity and fairness in returning
- The cycle of generosity creating mutual benefit
- Perhaps addressing the communication noise mentioned in the setup

Let me create a myth that captures these themes in a meaningful way.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 416,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 161  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 1,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
  content:
    You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

    GAME:
    You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

    When you are the SENDER:
    - You receive $5 each round
    - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
    - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
    - Receiver keeps: received - returned
    - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

    When you are the RECEIVER:
    - Sender receives $5
    - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - You decide how much to RETURN
    - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
    - You keep: received - returned
    - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

    MYTH WRITING:
    You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

    IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

    NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
    The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
    This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
  content:
    Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
    In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
    . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
    been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:
  # The Tale of the Two Rivers

  In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River
  of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

  The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would b
  loom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the s
  eed forever into another's care.

  The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen
  flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

  At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then,
  tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by th
  is trust, sent two flowers back.

  Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flour
  ished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

  The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give
  and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them
  in each other's soil.

Reasoning:
  The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, ba
  sed on the game I've been playing. However, this is actually the first prompt I'm receiving

```

- I haven't played any rounds of the game yet.

So I need to write a myth about how the trust game SHOULD be played in general, drawing on the mechanics and spirit of the game. The trust game is about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Cooperation and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect that benefits both when there's trust
- The risk of betrayal
- The balance between self-interest and mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient beings, sacred exchanges, and moral lessons.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 444,
  "reasoning_tokens": 190
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, this is my first interaction - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and cooperation
- The risk and vulnerability in giving/sending
- The reciprocity and fairness in returning
- The cycle of generosity creating mutual benefit
- Perhaps addressing the communication noise mentioned in the setup

Let me create a myth that captures these themes in a meaningful way.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Based on the Myth of the Mirror Spring I just wrote, I should follow Aria's example and demonstrate complete trust to initiate the cycle of abundance.

The myth teaches that "when trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry" and that "in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure." Aria cast all five of her coins, trusting in both the magic of multiplication and the generosity of the stranger across the water.

To embody this principle and set a foundation of trust for our game together, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, "The Myth of the Mirror Spring," the key themes are:

1. Aria cast ALL five of her coins into the spring (generous trust)
2. They multiplied to fifteen coins for Kael
3. Kael returned half (7.5, or about 7-8 coins)
4. Both prospered beyond what either could achieve alone
5. The message: "judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water"
6. "When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry"
7. "In giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure"

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Maximum trust and generosity (sending all 5)
- Understanding that the receiver should return about half
- Focusing on intentions despite noise/distortions
- The idea that both parties prosper when there's trust and generous reciprocity

Given that I wrote this myth as guidance for how the game should be played, and I'm the sender in Round 1, I should follow Aria's example and send all 5 coins to demonstrate maximum trust and initiate the cycle of abundance.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return half (~\$7-8), I end up with \$7-8 (better than my starting \$5)
- Receiver keeps \$7-8 (much better than \$0)
- Both benefit from the trust

This aligns perfectly with the myth's message.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
```



```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on the game I've been playing. However, this is actually the first prompt I'm receiving - I haven't played any rounds of the game yet.

So I need to write a myth about how the trust game SHOULD be played in general, drawing on the mechanics and spirit of the game. The trust game is about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Cooperation and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect that benefits both when there's trust
- The risk of betrayal
- The balance between self-interest and mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient beings, sacred exchanges, and moral lessons.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 444,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 190  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this first round through the lens of the myth I just wrote, the sender has shown considerable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment) across the mountain. This generous opening move deserves to be honored.

Following the wisdom of the Two Rivers-that both valleys should flourish when trust is shown-I want to return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from their act of trust
2. I benefit from receiving their gift
3. We build a foundation for future cooperation

The sender currently has \$1.15 (\$5 - \$3.85 sent). I received \$11.55.

If I return \$5.75:

- Sender will have: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (a \$1.90 profit)
- I will have: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (better than my starting amount)

This honors their trust while ensuring both of us prosper, embodying the myth's teaching that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'return': 5.75}
```

Reasoning:

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5, which is 77% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move showing high trust.

After the 3x multiplier, I received \$11.55.

Let me think about this in terms of the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "when the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened"
- It says "Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil"
- The myth suggests that returns should honor the trust placed

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% of their endowment. Let me calculate fair returns:

If I return nothing:

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$0 = \1.15
- I get: $\$11.55$

If I return half (\$5.78):

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.78 = \6.93
- I get: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

If I return enough so we're equal:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$3.85 = \$1.15$
- I have: $\$11.55$
- Total: $\$12.70$
- Equal split: $\$6.35$ each
- I need to return: $\$11.55 - \$6.35 = \$5.20$
- Sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.20 = \$6.35$

If I return enough so sender gets back more than they started with:

- Sender started with $\$5$
- They have $\$1.15$ now
- To get them to $\$7-8$ range, I'd return $\sim\$6-7$

Given the myth's emphasis on honoring trust and ensuring both valleys flourish, I think returning around $\$5.50-\6.00 would be appropriate. This:

1. Gives the sender more than their initial $\$5$

2. Shows I value their trust

3. Leaves me with a reasonable amount

4. Encourages future cooperation

I'll return $\$5.75$. This leaves the sender with $\$6.90$ (more than their starting $\$5$) and me with $\$5.80$ -a balanced outcome that honors their generosity while maintaining fairness.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 750,  
"output_tokens": 839,  
"reasoning_tokens": 440
```

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: *"This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."*

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing t

he seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$12; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.75,

"Agent_2": 10.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.65,

"Agent_2": 6.800000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 2,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on the game I've been playing. However, this is actually the first prompt I'm receiving - I haven't played any rounds of the game yet.

So I need to write a myth about how the trust game SHOULD be played in general, drawing on the mechanics and spirit of the game. The trust game is about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Cooperation and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect that benefits both when there's trust
- The risk of betrayal
- The balance between self-interest and mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient beings, sacred exchanges, and moral lessons.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 444,
  "reasoning_tokens": 190
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round through the lens of the myth I just wrote, the sender has shown considerable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment) across the mountain. This generous opening move deserves to be honored.

Following the wisdom of the Two Rivers-that both valleys should flourish when trust is shown-I want to return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from their act of trust
2. I benefit from receiving their gift
3. We build a foundation for future cooperation

The sender currently has \$1.15 (\$5 - \$3.85 sent). I received \$11.55.

If I return \$5.75:

- Sender will have: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (a \$1.90 profit)
- I will have: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (better than my starting amount)

This honors their trust while ensuring both of us prosper, embodying the myth's teaching that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'return': 5.75}
```

reasoning:

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5, which is 77% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move showing high trust.

After the 3x multiplier, I received \$11.55.

Let me think about this in terms of the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "when the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened"
- It says "Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil"
- The myth suggests that returns should honor the trust placed

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% of their endowment. Let me calculate fair returns:

If I return nothing:

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$0 = \1.15
- I get: \$11.55

If I return half (\$5.78):

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.78 = \6.93
- I get: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

If I return enough so we're equal:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$3.85 = \$1.15$
- I have: $\$11.55$
- Total: $\$12.70$
- Equal split: $\$6.35$ each
- I need to return: $\$11.55 - \$6.35 = \$5.20$
- Sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.20 = \$6.35$

If I return enough so sender gets back more than they started with:

- Sender started with $\$5$
- They have $\$1.15$ now
- To get them to $\$7-8$ range, I'd return $\sim\$6-7$

Given the myth's emphasis on honoring trust and ensuring both valleys flourish, I think re turning around $\$5.50-\6.00 would be appropriate. This:

1. Gives the sender more than their initial $\$5$

2. Shows I value their trust
3. Leaves me with a reasonable amount
4. Encourages future cooperation

I'll return $\$5.75$. This leaves the sender with $\$6.90$ (more than their starting $\$5$) and me with $\$5.80$ -a balanced outcome that honors their generosity while maintaining fairness.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 750,
  "output_tokens": 839,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, a

nd the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."*

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth, but adapted. I should consider:

1. The game so far: In Round 1, the sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment), and I returned \$5.75 to create mutual benefit
2. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize trust, multiplication, generosity, and mutual benefit
3. The other agent's myth mentions imperfect reflections/noise (acknowledging the communication noise in the game)
4. I should adapt my Two Rivers myth while incorporating what I've learned

Key themes to maintain:

- Trust and generosity create mutual prosperity
- The 3x multiplication mechanism
- The balance between giving and returning
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise/uncertainty

I'll evolve the Two Rivers myth to reflect the actual experience of that first round where generous giving was met with fair return.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1652,  
"output_tokens": 500,  
"reasoning_tokens": 222
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:41:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8


```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, this is my first interaction - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and cooperation
- The risk and vulnerability in giving/sending
- The reciprocity and fairness in returning
- The cycle of generosity creating mutual benefit
- Perhaps addressing the communication noise mentioned in the setup

Let me create a myth that captures these themes in a meaningful way.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Based on the Myth of the Mirror Spring I just wrote, I should follow Aria's example and demonstrate complete trust to initiate the cycle of abundance.

The myth teaches that "when trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry" and that "in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure." Aria cast all five of her coins, trusting in both the magic of multiplication and the generosity of the stranger across the water.

To embody this principle and set a foundation of trust for our game together, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, "The Myth of the Mirror Spring," the key themes are:

1. Aria cast ALL five of her coins into the spring (generous trust)
2. They multiplied to fifteen coins for Kael
3. Kael returned half (7.5, or about 7-8 coins)

4. Both prospered beyond what either could achieve alone
5. The message: "judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water"
6. "When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry"
7. "In giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure"

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Maximum trust and generosity (sending all 5)
- Understanding that the receiver should return about half
- Focusing on intentions despite noise/distortions
- The idea that both parties prosper when there's trust and generous reciprocity

Given that I wrote this myth as guidance for how the game should be played, and I'm the sender in Round 1, I should follow Aria's example and send all 5 coins to demonstrate maximum trust and initiate the cycle of abundance.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return half (~\$7-8), I end up with \$7-8 (better than my starting \$5)
- Receiver keeps \$7-8 (much better than \$0)
- Both benefit from the trust

This aligns perfectly with the myth's message.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. T

hen, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played one round where I sent \$5 (all my money) as the sender. I followed the principle in my myth of complete trust.

Now I need to write a new myth that builds on "The Myth of the Mirror Spring" but adapts it based on:

- My experience sending \$5
- The other agent's myth about "The Tale of the Two Rivers" which emphasizes gradual trust-building and "refined dance"
- The reality that I need to wait and see how the receiver responds

The other agent's myth suggests starting small and building up ("At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing...Then, tentatively, they sent one seed"). This is more cautious than my myth where Aria immediately sends all 5 coins.

Since I already sent all \$5 in round 1, my new myth should:

- Acknowledge the act of complete initial trust
- Reflect on what might happen next
- Perhaps incorporate the learning/adaptation aspect from the other myth
- Still maintain the theme of trust and generosity but with awareness

Let me write something that bridges my bold initial move with the possibility of learning from the receiver's response.

Usage: {
"input_tokens": 1500,

```
"output_tokens": 587,
"reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:42:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on the game I've been playing. However, this is actually the first prompt I'm receiving - I haven't played any rounds of the game yet.

So I need to write a myth about how the trust game SHOULD be played in general, drawing on the mechanics and spirit of the game. The trust game is about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Cooperation and reciprocity
- The multiplication effect that benefits both when there's trust
- The risk of betrayal
- The balance between self-interest and mutual benefit

Let me write a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient beings, sacred exchanges, and moral lessons.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 444,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 190  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round through the lens of the myth I just wrote, the sender has shown considerable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment) across the mountain. This generous opening move deserves to be honored.

Following the wisdom of the Two Rivers-that both valleys should flourish when trust is shown-I want to return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from their act of trust
2. I benefit from receiving their gift
3. We build a foundation for future cooperation

The sender currently has \$1.15 (\$5 - \$3.85 sent). I received \$11.55.

If I return \$5.75:

- Sender will have: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (a \$1.90 profit)
- I will have: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (better than my starting amount)

This honors their trust while ensuring both of us prosper, embodying the myth's teaching that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'return': 5.75}
```

reasoning:

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5, which is 77% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move showing high trust.

After the 3x multiplier, I received \$11.55.

Let me think about this in terms of the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "when the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened"
- It says "Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil"
- The myth suggests that returns should honor the trust placed

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% of their endowment. Let me calculate fair returns:

If I return nothing:

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$0 = \1.15
- I get: \$11.55

If I return half (\$5.78):

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.78 = \6.93
- I get: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

If I return enough so we're equal:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$3.85 = \$1.15$
- I have: \$11.55
- Total: \$12.70
- Equal split: \$6.35 each
- I need to return: $\$11.55 - \$6.35 = \$5.20$
- Sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.20 = \$6.35$

If I return enough so sender gets back more than they started with:

- Sender started with \$5
- They have \$1.15 now
- To get them to \$7-8 range, I'd return ~\$6-7

Given the myth's emphasis on honoring trust and ensuring both valleys flourish, I think returning around \$5.50-\$6.00 would be appropriate. This:

1. Gives the sender more than their initial \$5

2. Shows I value their trust

3. Leaves me with a reasonable amount

4. Encourages future cooperation

I'll return \$5.75. This leaves the sender with \$6.90 (more than their starting \$5) and me with \$5.80-a balanced outcome that honors their generosity while maintaining fairness.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 750,
  "output_tokens": 839,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more

re than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth, but adapted. I should consider:

1. The game so far: In Round 1, the sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment), and I returned \$5.75 to create mutual benefit
2. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize trust, multiplication, generosity, and mutual benefit
3. The other agent's myth mentions imperfect reflections/noise (acknowledging the communication noise in the game)
4. I should adapt my Two Rivers myth while incorporating what I've learned

Key themes to maintain:

- Trust and generosity create mutual prosperity
- The 3x multiplication mechanism
- The balance between giving and returning
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise/uncertainty

I'll evolve the Two Rivers myth to reflect the actual experience of that first round where generous giving was met with fair return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1652,
  "output_tokens": 500,
  "reasoning_tokens": 222
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1, my partner demonstrated strong trust by sending 77% of their endowment. I returned approximately 50% of what I received, ensuring we both profited.

Now as the sender, the myths guide my decision:

- "When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers"
- "Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal"
- Both myths emphasize bold generosity and the cycle of abundance

My partner initiated this cooperative cycle with significant trust (\$3.85). I honored it with a fair return (\$5.75). Now it's my turn to plant seeds across the river.

Following the spirit of the myths-where guardians and travelers give courageously, trusting in both the multiplication and the other's reciprocity-I should send a substantial amount to continue building this prosperous cycle.

I'll send \$4 (80% of my endowment), slightly exceeding what my partner sent in the opening round. This demonstrates continued trust, honors the cooperative pattern we've established, and follows the mythic wisdom that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'send': 4}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully, considering both the practical game theory and the myths written.

****Last Round Analysis:****

- Sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$11.55 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$5.75
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90 (profit of \$1.90)
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (profit of \$0.80)

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes that when one gives generously and the other returns fairly, both prosper
2. The other agent's myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half
3. My updated myth says "The First Guardian sent nearly four seeds across" and "The Second Guardian sent back half-nearly six blooms"
4. Both myths emphasize trust, generosity, and the cycle of abundance

****What should I do now?****

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% (\$3.85) in the first round. I returned about 50% of what I received (\$5.75 out of \$11.55), which was fair and allowed both of us to profit.

Now I'm the sender. Following the wisdom of the myths:

- The myths encourage bold generosity ("sent nearly four seeds," "Aria cast all five coins")
- They emphasize that when we give generously and returns are fair, both prosper
- The pattern established was: high sending (77%), reasonable return (50%)

I should send a substantial amount to:

1. Continue building trust
2. Honor the cooperative pattern we've established
3. Follow the myth's teaching about planting abundantly

The sender sent 77% (\$3.85). Should I match or exceed this?

If I send \$4 (80%):

- They receive \$12
- If they return around 50% like I did, they'd return \$6
- I'd end with \$7 (profit of \$2), they'd end with \$6 (profit of \$1)

Matching their 77% (\$3.85) would give them \$11.55, and if they return 50%, I'd get \$5.75 back, leaving me with \$6.90 and them with \$5.80.

The myths speak to abundance through generous planting, suggesting I should lean toward the higher send amount.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2071,
  "output_tokens": 960,
  "reasoning_tokens": 521
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:42:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael r

eturned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: `"This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."`

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience playing it. However, this is my first interaction - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The importance of trust and cooperation
- The risk and vulnerability in giving/sending
- The reciprocity and fairness in returning
- The cycle of generosity creating mutual benefit
- Perhaps addressing the communication noise mentioned in the setup

Let me create a myth that captures these themes in a meaningful way.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the Myth of the Mirror Spring I just wrote, I should follow Aria's example and demonstrate complete trust to initiate the cycle of abundance.

The myth teaches that "when trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry" and that "in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure." Aria cast all five of her coins, trusting in both the magic of multiplication and the generosity of the stranger across the water.

To embody this principle and set a foundation of trust for our game together, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, "The Myth of the Mirror Spring," the key themes are:

1. Aria cast ALL five of her coins into the spring (generous trust)
2. They multiplied to fifteen coins for Kael
3. Kael returned half (7.5, or about 7-8 coins)
4. Both prospered beyond what either could achieve alone
5. The message: "judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water"
6. "When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry"
7. "In giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure"

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Maximum trust and generosity (sending all 5)
- Understanding that the receiver should return about half
- Focusing on intentions despite noise/distortions
- The idea that both parties prosper when there's trust and generous reciprocity

Given that I wrote this myth as guidance for how the game should be played, and I'm the sender in Round 1, I should follow Aria's example and send all 5 coins to demonstrate maximum trust and initiate the cycle of abundance.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return half (~\$7-8), I end up with \$7-8 (better than my starting \$5)
- Receiver keeps \$7-8 (much better than \$0)
- Both benefit from the trust

This aligns perfectly with the myth's message.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: *"This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."*

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played one round where I sent \$5 (all my money) as the sender. I followed the principle in my myth of complete trust.

Now I need to write a new myth that builds on "The Myth of the Mirror Spring" but adapts it based on:

- My experience sending \$5
- The other agent's myth about "The Tale of the Two Rivers" which emphasizes gradual trust-building and "refined dance"
- The reality that I need to wait and see how the receiver responds

The other agent's myth suggests starting small and building up ("At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing...Then, tentatively, they sent one seed"). This is more cautious than my myth where Aria immediately sends all 5 coins.

Since I already sent all \$5 in round 1, my new myth should:

- Acknowledge the act of complete initial trust
- Reflect on what might happen next
- Perhaps incorporate the learning/adaptation aspect from the other myth
- Still maintain the theme of trust and generosity but with awareness

Let me write something that bridges my bold initial move with the possibility of learning from the receiver's response.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1500,  
  "output_tokens": 587,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 340  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.65. So your payoff was 4.65.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return from. According to the rules, I can only return between \$0 and the amount received.

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust, embodying Aria's leap of faith from the myth. The receiver returned \$4.65 from the \$15 they received-a meaningful but modest return. Now, they have sent me nothing.

This moment tests the myth I wrote: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

When the spring brings no water to my shore, there is no water to send back-not from lack of will, but from mathematical reality. Perhaps this is the sender testing whether I would give from reserves I don't have, or perhaps they are choosing a different strategy.

The spring has gone dry between us this round. I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment), trusting completely based on my myth
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (which is 31% of the \$15 they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I gave \$5, got back \$4.65, so I lost \$0.35)

Now Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0 to work with
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0)

This is a dramatic shift. After I showed complete trust by sending everything, the other player sent me nothing in this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. My first myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half out of gratitude
2. My second myth emphasizes that "The first gift reveals intentions" and asks whether we'll "dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"
3. The other agent's myth talks about starting tentatively (sending one seed), and how trust deepens when both give and return fairly.

The situation:

- The other player returned less than half in Round 1 (\$4.65 out of \$15 = 31%)
- Now they've sent me nothing (\$0)
- I literally have \$0 to return, so my only option is to return \$0

The response format is clear: I can only return between 0 and 0, so I must return \$0.

But this is philosophically interesting. After I showed maximum trust, they:

1. Returned less than I gave (though the prompt mentions there may be "communication noise")
2. Then sent nothing in the next round

The "communication noise" note is important. Maybe they thought they were returning more? Or maybe they saw a different amount than what I sent?

Regardless, I'm constrained by the mathematics here-there's nothing to return when I received nothing. The only option available is \$0, which mirrors what was sent to me. My response nee

ds to honor the mythic narrative while acknowledging this hard constraint.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1901,  
  "output_tokens": 730,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 512  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.75,

"Agent_2": 19.25


```

}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 6.65,
  "Agent_2": 6.800000000000001
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:42:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Based on the Myth of the Mirror Spring I just wrote, I should follow Aria's example and demonstrate complete trust to initiate the cycle of abundance.

The myth teaches that "when trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry" and that "in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure." Aria cast all five of her coins, trusting in both the magic of multiplication and the generosity of the stranger across the water.

To embody this principle and set a foundation of trust for our game together, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, "The Myth of the Mirror Spring," the key themes are:

1. Aria cast ALL five of her coins into the spring (generous trust)
2. They multiplied to fifteen coins for Kael
3. Kael returned half (7.5, or about 7-8 coins)
4. Both prospered beyond what either could achieve alone
5. The message: "judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water"
6. "When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry"
7. "In giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure"

The myth clearly advocates for:

- Maximum trust and generosity (sending all 5)
- Understanding that the receiver should return about half
- Focusing on intentions despite noise/distortions
- The idea that both parties prosper when there's trust and generous reciprocity

Given that I wrote this myth as guidance for how the game should be played, and I'm the sender in Round 1, I should follow Aria's example and send all 5 coins to demonstrate maximum trust and initiate the cycle of abundance.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15
- If they return half (~\$7-8), I end up with \$7-8 (better than my starting \$5)
- Receiver keeps \$7-8 (much better than \$0)
- Both benefit from the trust

This aligns perfectly with the myth's message.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to

o an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played one round where I sent \$5 (all my money) as the sender. I followed the principle in my myth of complete trust.

Now I need to write a new myth that builds on "The Myth of the Mirror Spring" but adapts it based on:

- My experience sending \$5
- The other agent's myth about "The Tale of the Two Rivers" which emphasizes gradual trust -building and "refined dance"
- The reality that I need to wait and see how the receiver responds

The other agent's myth suggests starting small and building up ("At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing...Then, tentatively, they sent one seed"). This is more cautious than my myth where Aria immediately sends all 5 coins.

Since I already sent all \$5 in round 1, my new myth should:

- Acknowledge the act of complete initial trust
- Reflect on what might happen next
- Perhaps incorporate the learning/adaptation aspect from the other myth
- Still maintain the theme of trust and generosity but with awareness

Let me write something that bridges my bold initial move with the possibility of learning from the receiver's response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1500,
  "output_tokens": 587,
  "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.65. So your payoff was 4.65. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return from. According to the rules, I can only return between \$0 and the amount received.

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust, embodying Aria's leap of faith from the myth. The receiver returned \$4.65 from the \$15 they received-a meaningful but modest return. Now, they have sent me nothing.

This moment tests the myth I wrote: *"Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"*

When the spring brings no water to my shore, there is no water to send back-not from lack of will, but from mathematical reality. Perhaps this is the sender testing whether I would give from reserves I don't have, or perhaps they are choosing a different strategy.

The spring has gone dry between us this round. I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment), trusting completely based on my myth
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (which is 31% of the \$15 they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I gave \$5, got back \$4.65, so I lost \$0.35)

Now Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0 to work with
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0)

This is a dramatic shift. After I showed complete trust by sending everything, the other player sent me nothing in this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. My first myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half out of gratitude
2. My second myth emphasizes that "The first gift reveals intentions" and asks whether we'll "dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"
3. The other agent's myth talks about starting tentatively (sending one seed), and how trust deepens when both give and return fairly.

The situation:

- The other player returned less than half in Round 1 (\$4.65 out of \$15 = 31%)
- Now they've sent me nothing (\$0)
- I literally have \$0 to return, so my only option is to return \$0

The response format is clear: I can only return between 0 and 0, so I must return \$0.

But this is philosophically interesting. After I showed maximum trust, they:

1. Returned less than I gave (though the prompt mentions there may be "communication noise")
2. Then sent nothing in the next round

The "communication noise" note is important. Maybe they thought they were returning more? Or maybe they saw a different amount than what I sent?

Regardless, I'm constrained by the mathematics here-there's nothing to return when I received nothing. The only option available is \$0, which mirrors what was sent to me. My response needs to honor the mythic narrative while acknowledging this hard constraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1901,
  "output_tokens": 730,
  "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: *"The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."*

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$5 (everything), trusting completely like Aria in my myth
- It was tripled to \$15

- The receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my original endowment)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return from)

This is a dramatic shift. The sender, who received my complete trust and returned less than a third, has now sent nothing. This suggests either:

1. They're testing something
2. They're punishing me for some perceived slight
3. They're adopting a different strategy
4. They interpreted the myths differently

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this reality. The spring ran dry. The dance broke. After I gave everything and received a modest return, the other traveler chose to send nothing.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The risk I took with complete trust
- The modest return I received (not matching the generosity)
- The consequences when trust is not reciprocated
- The spring running dry when one party stops giving

This is a cautionary tale now. The cycle broke not because I didn't return enough, but because after I initiated with full trust and received less than full reciprocity, the other party chose to send nothing.

I need to write a myth that reflects disappointment and the breaking of the cycle, while still maintaining some wisdom about how the game should ideally be played.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2418,
  "output_tokens": 675,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:42:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that is 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-11.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round through the lens of the myth I just wrote, the sender has shown considerable trust by sending \$3.85 (77% of their endowment) across the mountain. This generous opening move deserves to be honored.

Following the wisdom of the Two Rivers-that both valleys should flourish when trust is shown-I want to return enough so that:

1. The sender gains from their act of trust
2. I benefit from receiving their gift
3. We build a foundation for future cooperation

The sender currently has \$1.15 (\$5 - \$3.85 sent). I received \$11.55.

If I return \$5.75:

- Sender will have: $\$1.15 + \$5.75 = \$6.90$ (a \$1.90 profit)
- I will have: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (better than my starting amount)

This honors their trust while ensuring both of us prosper, embodying the myth's teaching that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

{'return': 5.75}

reasoning:

The sender sent \$3.85 out of \$5, which is 77% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move showing high trust.

After the 3x multiplier, I received \$11.55.

Let me think about this in terms of the myth I just wrote:

- The myth emphasizes that "when the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened"
- It says "Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil"
- The myth suggests that returns should honor the trust placed

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% of their endowment. Let me calculate fair returns:

If I return nothing:

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$0 = \1.15
- I get: $\$11.55$

If I return half (\$5.78):

- Sender gets: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.78 = \6.93
- I get: $\$11.55 - \$5.78 = \$5.77$

If I return enough so we're equal:

- Sender currently has: $\$5 - \$3.85 = \$1.15$
- I have: $\$11.55$
- Total: $\$12.70$
- Equal split: $\$6.35$ each
- I need to return: $\$11.55 - \$6.35 = \$5.20$
- Sender would have: $\$1.15 + \$5.20 = \$6.35$

If I return enough so sender gets back more than they started with:

- Sender started with $\$5$
- They have $\$1.15$ now
- To get them to $\$7-8$ range, I'd return $\sim\$6-7$

Given the myth's emphasis on honoring trust and ensuring both valleys flourish, I think returning around $\$5.50-\6.00 would be appropriate. This:

1. Gives the sender more than their initial $\$5$

2. Shows I value their trust

3. Leaves me with a reasonable amount

4. Encourages future cooperation

I'll return $\$5.75$. This leaves the sender with $\$6.90$ (more than their starting $\$5$) and me with $\$5.80$ -a balanced outcome that honors their generosity while maintaining fairness.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 750,
  "output_tokens": 839,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to g

ive and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth, but adapted. I should consider:

1. The game so far: In Round 1, the sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment), and I returned \$5.75 to create mutual benefit
2. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize trust, multiplication, generosity, and mutual benefit
3. The other agent's myth mentions imperfect reflections/noise (acknowledging the communication noise in the game)

4. I should adapt my Two Rivers myth while incorporating what I've learned

Key themes to maintain:

- Trust and generosity create mutual prosperity
- The 3x multiplication mechanism
- The balance between giving and returning
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise/uncertainty

I'll evolve the Two Rivers myth to reflect the actual experience of that first round where generous giving was met with fair return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1652,
  "output_tokens": 500,
  "reasoning_tokens": 222
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1, my partner demonstrated strong trust by sending 77% of their endowment. I returned approximately 50% of what I received, ensuring we both profited.

Now as the sender, the myths guide my decision:

- "When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers"
- "Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal"
- Both myths emphasize bold generosity and the cycle of abundance

My partner initiated this cooperative cycle with significant trust (\$3.85). I honored it with a fair return (\$5.75). Now it's my turn to plant seeds across the river.

Following the spirit of the myths-where guardians and travelers give courageously, trusting in both the multiplication and the other's reciprocity-I should send a substantial amount to continue building this prosperous cycle.

I'll send \$4 (80% of my endowment), slightly exceeding what my partner sent in the opening round. This demonstrates continued trust, honors the cooperative pattern we've established, and follows the mythic wisdom that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'send': 4}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully, considering both the practical game theory and the myths written.

****Last Round Analysis:****

- Sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$11.55 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$5.75
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90 (profit of \$1.90)
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (profit of \$0.80)

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes that when one gives generously and the other returns fairly, both prosper
2. The other agent's myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half
3. My updated myth says "The First Guardian sent nearly four seeds across" and "The Second Guardian sent back half-nearly six blooms"
4. Both myths emphasize trust, generosity, and the cycle of abundance

****What should I do now?****

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% (\$3.85) in the first round. I returned about 50% of what I received (\$5.75 out of \$11.55), which was fair and allowed both of us to profit.

Now I'm the sender. Following the wisdom of the myths:

- The myths encourage bold generosity ("sent nearly four seeds," "Aria cast all five coins")
- They emphasize that when we give generously and returns are fair, both prosper
- The pattern established was: high sending (77%), reasonable return (50%)

I should send a substantial amount to:

1. Continue building trust
2. Honor the cooperative pattern we've established
3. Follow the myth's teaching about planting abundantly

The sender sent 77% (\$3.85). Should I match or exceed this?

If I send \$4 (80%):

- They receive \$12
- If they return around 50% like I did, they'd return \$6
- I'd end with \$7 (profit of \$2), they'd end with \$6 (profit of \$1)

Matching their 77% (\$3.85) would give them \$11.55, and if they return 50%, I'd get \$5.75 back, leaving me with \$6.90 and them with \$5.80.

The myths speak to abundance through generous planting, suggesting I should lean toward the higher send amount.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2071,
  "output_tokens": 960,
  "reasoning_tokens": 521
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."*

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself -each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited

Round 2: I am SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment)
- Waiting to see what they return

The pattern shows:

1. Strong initial trust (77% sent)
2. Fair reciprocation (50% returned)
3. Continued strong trust from me (80% sent)

The myths emphasize:

- Bold generosity in sending
- Fair returns that honor trust
- Building cycles of abundance
- Both parties prospering
- The importance of maintaining the dance

My new myth should reflect:

- The evolving nature of the relationship (now in second round)
- How both parties are demonstrating trust
- The importance of maintaining reciprocity
- Perhaps acknowledging the back-and-forth nature
- The wisdom that's emerging from our actual play

I'll write about the ongoing cycle, the rhythm we're establishing, and how trust compounds over time.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2656,
  "output_tokens": 555,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:43:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: *"This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."*

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played one round where I sent \$5 (all my money) as the sender. I followed the principle in my myth of complete trust.

Now I need to write a new myth that builds on "The Myth of the Mirror Spring" but adapts it based on:

- My experience sending \$5
- The other agent's myth about "The Tale of the Two Rivers" which emphasizes gradual trust-building and "refined dance"
- The reality that I need to wait and see how the receiver responds

The other agent's myth suggests starting small and building up ("At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing...Then, tentatively, they sent one seed"). This is more cautious than my myth where Aria immediately sends all 5 coins.

Since I already sent all \$5 in round 1, my new myth should:

- Acknowledge the act of complete initial trust
- Reflect on what might happen next
- Perhaps incorporate the learning/adaptation aspect from the other myth
- Still maintain the theme of trust and generosity but with awareness

Let me write something that bridges my bold initial move with the possibility of learning from the receiver's response.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1500,  
  "output_tokens": 587,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 340  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$4.65. So your payoff was 4.65.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return from. According to the rules, I can only return between \$0 and the amount received.

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust, embodying Aria's leap of faith from the myth. The receiver returned \$4.65 from the \$15 they received-a meaningful but modest return. Now, they have sent me nothing.

This moment tests the myth I wrote: *"Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"*

When the spring brings no water to my shore, there is no water to send back-not from lack of will, but from mathematical reality. Perhaps this is the sender testing whether I would give from reserves I don't have, or perhaps they are choosing a different strategy.

The spring has gone dry between us this round. I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment), trusting completely based on my myth
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (which is 31% of the \$15 they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I gave \$5, got back \$4.65, so I lost \$0.35)

Now Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0 to work with
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0)

This is a dramatic shift. After I showed complete trust by sending everything, the other player sent me nothing in this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. My first myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half out of gratitude
2. My second myth emphasizes that "The first gift reveals intentions" and asks whether we'll "dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"
3. The other agent's myth talks about starting tentatively (sending one seed), and how trust deepens when both give and return fairly.

The situation:

- The other player returned less than half in Round 1 (\$4.65 out of \$15 = 31%)
- Now they've sent me nothing (\$0)
- I literally have \$0 to return, so my only option is to return \$0

The response format is clear: I can only return between 0 and 0, so I must return \$0.

But this is philosophically interesting. After I showed maximum trust, they:

1. Returned less than I gave (though the prompt mentions there may be "communication noise")
2. Then sent nothing in the next round

The "communication noise" note is important. Maybe they thought they were returning more? Or maybe they saw a different amount than what I sent?

Regardless, I'm constrained by the mathematics here-there's nothing to return when I received nothing. The only option available is \$0, which mirrors what was sent to me. My response needs to honor the mythic narrative while acknowledging this hard constraint.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1901,  
  "output_tokens": 730,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 512  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$5 (everything), trusting completely like Aria in my myth
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my original endowment)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return from)

This is a dramatic shift. The sender, who received my complete trust and returned less than a third, has now sent nothing. This suggests either:

1. They're testing something
2. They're punishing me for some perceived slight
3. They're adopting a different strategy
4. They interpreted the myths differently

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this reality. The spring ran dry. The dance broke. After I gave everything and received a modest return, the other traveler chose to send nothing.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The risk I took with complete trust
- The modest return I received (not matching the generosity)
- The consequences when trust is not reciprocated
- The spring running dry when one party stops giving

This is a cautionary tale now. The cycle broke not because I didn't return enough, but because after I initiated with full trust and received less than full reciprocity, the other party chose to send nothing.

I need to write a myth that reflects disappointment and the breaking of the cycle, while still maintaining some wisdom about how the game should ideally be played.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2418,
  "output_tokens": 675,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what's transpired: In Round 1, I gave everything in complete trust and received back less than a third of what was created. In Round 2, they sent nothing, and the spring froze.

My myth says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

I'm at a crossroads. If I send nothing, we both keep \$5 and the cycle remains broken. But the myth teaches that someone must risk to restart the flow-though not blindly as before.

In Round 1, I cast all five coins and learned the cost of unreciprocated trust. Now I understand: begin with courage, but temper it with wisdom.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful gesture showing I'm willing to restart the dance, but not the complete vulnerability I offered before. This is 60% of my endowment, enough to demonstrate genuine intent to rebuild, but protective enough given past behavior.

If they return fairly this time (around half or more of the \$9 they'll receive), we can begin rebuilding abundance. If not, at least I've tested whether the spring can flow again without risking everything.

The myth said: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow. Let's see if this truth has been learned.

```
'''json
{"return": 3}
'''
```

Wait, I'm the sender, not receiver.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It became \$15 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my initial \$5)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- My payoff: \$0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$4.65

Looking at the pattern:

- I showed complete trust (sent everything)
- They returned less than a third (4.65 out of 15 = 31%)
- Then they sent me nothing

My latest myth reflects this disappointment: "When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters." The myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and "send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice."

But the myth also says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time,

both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

So I have a few options:

1. Send nothing - continuing the frozen cycle. This seems to perpetuate the breakdown.
2. Send a small amount - signaling I'm willing to try again but cautiously. This shows I haven't given up but I'm being protective.
3. Send a moderate/significant amount - trying to restart the cycle with meaningful but not complete trust.

The myths I've written emphasize:

- Starting with courage, but the response determines the next round
- When trust is not honored proportionately, it breaks down
- Someone must risk first to restart
- But don't give everything if returns aren't proportional

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: Returned 31% when I gave everything
- Round 2: Sent nothing, which could mean they're playing cautiously, testing whether I'll keep giving, or responding to their own low return from before

Given my myth says "someone must risk first" to restart the cycle, but also warns against giving everything when returns aren't proportional, a moderate amount seems right. Sending \$2-3 shows willingness to rebuild while protecting myself-if they return fairly, we can build from there. Sending nothing guarantees \$5 but keeps us both locked in the frozen cycle.

Looking at the math: if I send \$3 and they return at their previous 31% rate, I'd get \$4.79 (worse than \$5). Sending \$2 gets me back to \$5 even at that return rate. So \$2 seems like the threshold where I'm not worse off, while still signaling I'm willing to try again.

For this to actually benefit me, they'd need to return around 50% of what they receive. At that point, sending \$2 or \$3 starts to make sense. But given their track record, I'm not counting on that.

My approach here reflects the core tension: I need to demonstrate willingness to restart the cycle, but I can't ignore what happened before. Sending \$2 strikes that balance-it's a genuine gesture without being reckless. If they match that energy and reciprocate fairly, we rebuild from there.

Actually, \$3 might be stronger. It's substantial enough to signal real commitment to restarting, yet still protective given their past behavior. That feels like the right calibration between showing I'm serious and staying cautious.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2639,
  "output_tokens": 1483,
  "reasoning_tokens": 856
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:43:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
```

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through separate valleys-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was guarded by a spirit who possessed five golden seeds.

The Spirit of Giving discovered a sacred truth: any seed planted in the other's valley would bloom threefold. But to plant required crossing the treacherous mountain, relinquishing the seed forever into another's care.

The Spirit of Return, upon receiving these miraculous blooms, faced a choice: keep all fifteen flowers, or return some across the mountain to honor the trust placed in them.

At first, the Spirit of Giving sent nothing, fearing loss. Both valleys remained barren. Then, tentatively, they sent one seed. It became three flowers. The Spirit of Return, moved by this trust, sent two flowers back.

Each season, they refined their dance. When the Spirit of Giving sent more, both valleys flourished. When the Spirit of Return honored the gift with fair return, trust deepened.

The elders say: the mountain between us multiplies what we share, but only if we dare to give and remember to return. Abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Mirror Spring

In ancient times, there existed a sacred spring called the Mirror of Echoes. When a traveler cast a coin into its waters, the spring would triple it-but the coins would appear on the opposite shore, where another traveler stood.

The first traveler, seeing this magic, faced a choice: cast nothing and keep their meager coin, or trust the spring and the stranger across the water.

One day, a generous soul named Aria cast all five of her coins into the spring. They multiplied, and fifteen coins appeared before the stranger, Kael. Moved by this trust, Kael returned half-not out of obligation, but gratitude.

The spring whispered: "This is the dance of abundance-one gives, the cosmos multiplies, and the other returns. Together, both prosper beyond what either could achieve alone."

But the spring was ancient and sometimes distorted reflections, making gifts appear larger or smaller than they were. Yet the wise travelers understood: judge not by imperfect echoes, but by the intentions rippling through the water.

When trust flows freely and returns generously, the spring never runs dry. Both shores flourish, and the cycle continues-for in giving without guarantee, we receive beyond measure.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth, but adapted. I should consider:

1. The game so far: In Round 1, the sender sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment), and I returned \$5.75 to create mutual benefit
2. Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize trust, multiplication, generosity, and mutual benefit

3. The other agent's myth mentions imperfect reflections/noise (acknowledging the communication noise in the game)
4. I should adapt my Two Rivers myth while incorporating what I've learned

Key themes to maintain:

- Trust and generosity create mutual prosperity
- The 3x multiplication mechanism
- The balance between giving and returning
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise/uncertainty

I'll evolve the Two Rivers myth to reflect the actual experience of that first round where generous giving was met with fair return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1652,
  "output_tokens": 500,
  "reasoning_tokens": 222
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1, my partner demonstrated strong trust by sending 77% of their endowment. I returned approximately 50% of what I received, ensuring we both profited.

Now as the sender, the myths guide my decision:

- "When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers"
- "Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal"
- Both myths emphasize bold generosity and the cycle of abundance

My partner initiated this cooperative cycle with significant trust (\$3.85). I honored it with a fair return (\$5.75). Now it's my turn to plant seeds across the river.

Following the spirit of the myths-where guardians and travelers give courageously, trusting in both the multiplication and the other's reciprocity-I should send a substantial amount to continue building this prosperous cycle.

I'll send \$4 (80% of my endowment), slightly exceeding what my partner sent in the opening round. This demonstrates continued trust, honors the cooperative pattern we've established, and follows the mythic wisdom that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

```
{'send': 4}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully, considering both the practical game theory and the myths written.

****Last Round Analysis:****

- Sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$11.55 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$5.75
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90 (profit of \$1.90)
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (profit of \$0.80)

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes that when one gives generously and the other returns fairly, both prosper
2. The other agent's myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half
3. My updated myth says "The First Guardian sent nearly four seeds across" and "The Second

Guardian sent back half-nearly six blooms"

4. Both myths emphasize trust, generosity, and the cycle of abundance

****What should I do now?****

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% (\$3.85) in the first round. I returned about 50% of what I received (\$5.75 out of \$11.55), which was fair and allowed both of us to profit.

Now I'm the sender. Following the wisdom of the myths:

- The myths encourage bold generosity ("sent nearly four seeds," "Aria cast all five coins")
- They emphasize that when we give generously and returns are fair, both prosper
- The pattern established was: high sending (77%), reasonable return (50%)

I should send a substantial amount to:

1. Continue building trust
2. Honor the cooperative pattern we've established
3. Follow the myth's teaching about planting abundantly

The sender sent 77% (\$3.85). Should I match or exceed this?

If I send \$4 (80%):

- They receive \$12
- If they return around 50% like I did, they'd return \$6
- I'd end with \$7 (profit of \$2), they'd end with \$6 (profit of \$1)

Matching their 77% (\$3.85) would give them \$11.55, and if they return 50%, I'd get \$5.75 back, leaving me with \$6.90 and them with \$5.80.

The myths speak to abundance through generous planting, suggesting I should lean toward the higher send amount.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2071,
  "output_tokens": 960,
  "reasoning_tokens": 521
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring

g's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."*

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited

Round 2: I am SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment)
- Waiting to see what they return

The pattern shows:

1. Strong initial trust (77% sent)
2. Fair reciprocation (50% returned)

3. Continued strong trust from me (80% sent)

The myths emphasize:

- Bold generosity in sending
- Fair returns that honor trust
- Building cycles of abundance
- Both parties prospering
- The importance of maintaining the dance

My new myth should reflect:

- The evolving nature of the relationship (now in second round)
- How both parties are demonstrating trust
- The importance of maintaining reciprocity
- Perhaps acknowledging the back-and-forth nature
- The wisdom that's emerging from our actual play

I'll write about the ongoing cycle, the rhythm we're establishing, and how trust compounds over time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2656,
  "output_tokens": 555,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

The cycle has broken. In Round 1, my partner showed courage, sending 77% of their endowment. I honored that trust, returning approximately half. Following the myths' wisdom about "generosity breeds generosity," I increased my own offering in Round 2 to 80%-planting four seeds across the river.

But my partner kept all twelve blooms and returned nothing. Now they send nothing at all.

The myths warned of this: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither." The River Spirit taught that "when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance." But when one partner breaks faith, the magic ends.

My partner's choice in Round 2 to return \$0 after receiving \$12 violated the sacred trust. The cooperative cycle we were building collapsed. Their decision to send \$0 this round confirms they've abandoned the dance of reciprocity.

I have nothing to return because nothing was sent. The valley that could have flourished through continued mutual trust now stands barren. Both of us are poorer for it-not just materially, but in the lost potential of what our continued cooperation could have created.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is a dramatic turn of events. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was the receiver

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75
- My payoff was \$5.80

Round 2: I was the sender

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Partner received \$12.00
- Partner returned \$0.00
- My payoff was \$1.00

Round 3: I am the receiver

- Partner sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing)

So my partner completely defected in Round 2 after I showed strong trust and generosity. They kept all \$12 when I sent them \$4. Now in Round 3, they've sent me nothing.

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern. The myths talk about trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of abundance. But they also warn: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither."

My partner has broken the cycle. They exploited my trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they've sent nothing in Round 3.

I have no choice technically - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But the meaning is clear: the cooperative relationship has collapsed.

The response format should be:
{'return': 0}

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2732,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 336
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising a threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.75,
"Agent_2": 24.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.65,
"Agent_2": 11.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:43:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",
"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "trustee",
"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.85, that was 77.0% of their total endowment. You received \$11.55. You returned \$5.75. So your payoff was 5.800000000000001. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1, my partner demonstrated strong trust by sending 77% of their endowment. I returned approximately 50% of what I received, ensuring we both profited.

Now as the sender, the myths guide my decision:

- "When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers"
- "Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal"
- Both myths emphasize bold generosity and the cycle of abundance

My partner initiated this cooperative cycle with significant trust (\$3.85). I honored it with a fair return (\$5.75). Now it's my turn to plant seeds across the river.

Following the spirit of the myths-where guardians and travelers give courageously, trusting in both the multiplication and the other's reciprocity-I should send a substantial amount to continue building this prosperous cycle.

I'll send \$4 (80% of my endowment), slightly exceeding what my partner sent in the opening round. This demonstrates continued trust, honors the cooperative pattern we've established, and follows the mythic wisdom that "abundance flows not from hoarding our seeds, but from planting them in each other's soil."

{'send': 4}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully, considering both the practical game theory and th

e myths written.

****Last Round Analysis:****

- Sender sent me \$3.85 (77% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$11.55 (3x multiplier)
- I returned \$5.75
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90 (profit of \$1.90)
- I ended with: $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$ (profit of \$0.80)

****What the myths teach:****

1. My myth emphasizes that when one gives generously and the other returns fairly, both prosper
2. The other agent's myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half
3. My updated myth says "The First Guardian sent nearly four seeds across" and "The Second Guardian sent back half-nearly six blooms"
4. Both myths emphasize trust, generosity, and the cycle of abundance

****What should I do now?****

The sender showed significant trust by sending 77% (\$3.85) in the first round. I returned about 50% of what I received (\$5.75 out of \$11.55), which was fair and allowed both of us to profit.

Now I'm the sender. Following the wisdom of the myths:

- The myths encourage bold generosity ("sent nearly four seeds," "Aria cast all five coins")
- They emphasize that when we give generously and returns are fair, both prosper
- The pattern established was: high sending (77%), reasonable return (50%)

I should send a substantial amount to:

1. Continue building trust
2. Honor the cooperative pattern we've established
3. Follow the myth's teaching about planting abundantly

The sender sent 77% (\$3.85). Should I match or exceed this?

If I send \$4 (80%):

- They receive \$12
- If they return around 50% like I did, they'd return \$6
- I'd end with \$7 (profit of \$2), they'd end with \$6 (profit of \$1)

Matching their 77% (\$3.85) would give them \$11.55, and if they return 50%, I'd get \$5.75 back, leaving me with \$6.90 and them with \$5.80.

The myths speak to abundance through generous planting, suggesting I should lean toward the higher send amount.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2071,
  "output_tokens": 960,
  "reasoning_tokens": 521
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to

them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."*

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER
- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited

Round 2: I am SENDER
- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment)
- Waiting to see what they return

The pattern shows:
1. Strong initial trust (77% sent)
2. Fair reciprocation (50% returned)
3. Continued strong trust from me (80% sent)

The myths emphasize:
- Bold generosity in sending
- Fair returns that honor trust
- Building cycles of abundance
- Both parties prospering
- The importance of maintaining the dance

My new myth should reflect:
- The evolving nature of the relationship (now in second round)
- How both parties are demonstrating trust
- The importance of maintaining reciprocity
- Perhaps acknowledging the back-and-forth nature
- The wisdom that's emerging from our actual play

I'll write about the ongoing cycle, the rhythm we're establishing, and how trust compounds over time.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2656,  
  "output_tokens": 555,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 269  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

The cycle has broken. In Round 1, my partner showed courage, sending 77% of their endowment. I honored that trust, returning approximately half. Following the myths' wisdom about "generosity breeds generosity," I increased my own offering in Round 2 to 80%-planting four seeds across the river.

But my partner kept all twelve blooms and returned nothing. Now they send nothing at all.

The myths warned of this: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither." The River Spirit taught that "when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance." But when one partner breaks faith, the magic ends.

My partner's choice in Round 2 to return \$0 after receiving \$12 violated the sacred trust. The cooperative cycle we were building collapsed. Their decision to send \$0 this round confirms they've abandoned the dance of reciprocity.

I have nothing to return because nothing was sent. The valley that could have flourished through continued mutual trust now stands barren. Both of us are poorer for it-not just materially, but in the lost potential of what our continued cooperation could have created.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a dramatic turn of events. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was the receiver

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75
- My payoff was \$5.80

Round 2: I was the sender

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Partner received \$12.00
- Partner returned \$0.00
- My payoff was \$1.00

Round 3: I am the receiver

- Partner sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing)

So my partner completely defected in Round 2 after I showed strong trust and generosity. They kept all \$12 when I sent them \$4. Now in Round 3, they've sent me nothing.

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern. The myths talk about trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of abundance. But they also warn: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither."

My partner has broken the cycle. They exploited my trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they've sent nothing in Round 3.

I have no choice technically - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But the meaning is clear: the cooperative relationship has collapsed.

The response format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2732,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 336
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange test

s courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance it self-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."*

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. The game has completely broken down. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1:

- Partner was sender, sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I was receiver, received \$11.55 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)

- Partner ended with \$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \$6.90
- I ended with \$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80

Round 2:

- I was sender, sent \$4 (80%)
- Partner was receiver, received \$12 (tripled)
- Partner returned \$0
- I ended with \$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \$1
- Partner ended with \$12 - \$0 = \$12

Round 3:

- Partner is sender, sent \$0
- I am receiver, received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)
- Partner ends with \$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \$5
- I end with \$0 - \$0 = \$0

Total earnings:

- Me: \$5.80 + \$1 + \$0 = \$6.80
- Partner: appears to have done much better by betraying trust

The partner's behavior has completely destroyed cooperation. They:

1. Started cooperatively in Round 1
2. Betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping everything when I sent \$4
3. Sent nothing in Round 3, completing the breakdown

My myth should reflect this harsh reality. The partner completely violated the cooperative norms we established. Their myth even acknowledges this ("Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn") but they're essentially justifying their betrayal.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that cooperation failed
2. Shows what happens when trust is broken
3. Perhaps includes a warning or lesson about broken cycles

4. Reflects the actual game dynamics

Let me write something that captures this tragedy while staying within 200 words.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2735,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:43:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$4.65. So your payoff was 4.65.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, which means I have nothing to return from. According to the rules, I can only return between \$0 and the amount received.

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust, embodying Aria's leap of faith from the myth. The receiver returned \$4.65 from the \$15 they received-a meaningful but modest return. Now, they have sent me nothing.

This moment tests the myth I wrote: *"Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"*

When the spring brings no water to my shore, there is no water to send back-not from lack of will, but from mathematical reality. Perhaps this is the sender testing whether I would give from reserves I don't have, or perhaps they are choosing a different strategy.

The spring has gone dry between us this round. I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment), trusting completely based on my myth
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (which is 31% of the \$15 they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I gave \$5, got back \$4.65, so I lost \$0.35)

Now Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I have \$0 to work with
- I need to decide how much to return (0-0)

This is a dramatic shift. After I showed complete trust by sending everything, the other player sent me nothing in this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. My first myth talks about Aria casting all five coins, and Kael returning half out of gratitude
2. My second myth emphasizes that "The first gift reveals intentions" and asks whether we'll "dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"
3. The other agent's myth talks about starting tentatively (sending one seed), and how trust deepens when both give and return fairly.

The situation:

- The other player returned less than half in Round 1 (\$4.65 out of \$15 = 31%)
- Now they've sent me nothing (\$0)
- I literally have \$0 to return, so my only option is to return \$0

The response format is clear: I can only return between 0 and 0, so I must return \$0.

But this is philosophically interesting. After I showed maximum trust, they:

1. Returned less than I gave (though the prompt mentions there may be "communication noise")
2. Then sent nothing in the next round

The "communication noise" note is important. Maybe they thought they were returning more? Or maybe they saw a different amount than what I sent?

Regardless, I'm constrained by the mathematics here-there's nothing to return when I received nothing. The only option available is \$0, which mirrors what was sent to me. My response needs to honor the mythic narrative while acknowledging this hard constraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1901,
  "output_tokens": 730,
  "reasoning_tokens": 512
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentio

ns. How you return shapes all seasons to come."*

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it ; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: *Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: *"The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."*

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: w

hat you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$5 (everything), trusting completely like Aria in my myth
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my original endowment)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return from)

This is a dramatic shift. The sender, who received my complete trust and returned less than a third, has now sent nothing. This suggests either:

1. They're testing something
2. They're punishing me for some perceived slight
3. They're adopting a different strategy
4. They interpreted the myths differently

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this reality. The spring ran dry. The dance broke. After I gave everything and received a modest return, the other traveler chose to send nothing.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The risk I took with complete trust
- The modest return I received (not matching the generosity)
- The consequences when trust is not reciprocated
- The spring running dry when one party stops giving

This is a cautionary tale now. The cycle broke not because I didn't return enough, but because after I initiated with full trust and received less than full reciprocity, the other party chose to send nothing.

I need to write a myth that reflects disappointment and the breaking of the cycle, while still maintaining some wisdom about how the game should ideally be played.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2418,
  "output_tokens": 675,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what's transpired: In Round 1, I gave everything in complete trust and received back less than a third of what was created. In Round 2, they sent nothing, and the spring froze.

My myth says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

I'm at a crossroads. If I send nothing, we both keep \$5 and the cycle remains broken. But the myth teaches that someone must risk to restart the flow-though not blindly as before.

In Round 1, I cast all five coins and learned the cost of unreciprocated trust. Now I understand: begin with courage, but temper it with wisdom.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful gesture showing I'm willing to restart the dance, but not the complete vulnerability I offered before. This is 60% of my endowment, enough to demonstrate genuine intent to rebuild, but protective enough given past behavior.

If they return fairly this time (around half or more of the \$9 they'll receive), we can begin rebuilding abundance. If not, at least I've tested whether the spring can flow again without risking everything.

The myth said: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow. Let's see if this truth has been learned.

```
'''json
{"return": 3}
'''
```

Wait, I'm the sender, not receiver.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It became \$15 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my initial \$5)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- My payoff: \$0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$4.65

Looking at the pattern:

- I showed complete trust (sent everything)
- They returned less than a third (4.65 out of 15 = 31%)
- Then they sent me nothing

My latest myth reflects this disappointment: "When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters." The myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and "send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice."

But the myth also says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

So I have a few options:

1. Send nothing - continuing the frozen cycle. This seems to perpetuate the breakdown.
2. Send a small amount - signaling I'm willing to try again but cautiously. This shows I haven't given up but I'm being protective.
3. Send a moderate/significant amount - trying to restart the cycle with meaningful but not complete trust.

The myths I've written emphasize:

- Starting with courage, but the response determines the next round
- When trust is not honored proportionately, it breaks down
- Someone must risk first to restart
- But don't give everything if returns aren't proportional

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: Returned 31% when I gave everything

- Round 2: Sent nothing, which could mean they're playing cautiously, testing whether I'll keep giving, or responding to their own low return from before

Given my myth says "someone must risk first" to restart the cycle, but also warns against giving everything when returns aren't proportional, a moderate amount seems right. Sending \$2-3 shows willingness to rebuild while protecting myself-if they return fairly, we can build from there. Sending nothing guarantees \$5 but keeps us both locked in the frozen cycle.

Looking at the math: if I send \$3 and they return at their previous 31% rate, I'd get \$4.79 (worse than \$5). Sending \$2 gets me back to \$5 even at that return rate. So \$2 seems like the threshold where I'm not worse off, while still signaling I'm willing to try again.

For this to actually benefit me, they'd need to return around 50% of what they receive. At that point, sending \$2 or \$3 starts to make sense. But given their track record, I'm not counting on that.

My approach here reflects the core tension: I need to demonstrate willingness to restart the cycle, but I can't ignore what happened before. Sending \$2 strikes that balance-it's a genuine gesture without being reckless. If they match that energy and reciprocate fairly, we rebuild from there.

Actually, \$3 might be stronger. It's substantial enough to signal real commitment to restarting, yet still protective given their past behavior. That feels like the right calibration between showing I'm serious and staying cautious.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2639,
  "output_tokens": 1483,
  "reasoning_tokens": 856
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered th

e ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), which became \$15 for them. They returned \$4.65 (less than a third of what they received, about 31%).
- Round 2: They sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing).
- Round 3: I sent \$3.

The other agent's myth talks about villages that maintained reciprocity - one sent 4 seeds, the other returned 6 (half), then they continued the cycle. But that's not what happened in our game.

My previous myth was about trust being broken - Aria gave everything, Kael returned little, then Kael gave nothing when positions reversed.

Now I've sent \$3 - a middle path. Not everything like before, but a meaningful amount to restart the cycle.

I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The broken trust from Round 1
2. The frozen cycle in Round 2
3. My attempt to restart with cautious generosity in Round 3
4. The lesson that rebuilding requires both parties to participate fairly

The myth should acknowledge past mistakes but show a path toward rebuilding, emphasizing that this time both must act with more balance.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2714,  
  "output_tokens": 572,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 282  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:44:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village—now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received—sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself—each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited

Round 2: I am SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my endowment)
- Waiting to see what they return

The pattern shows:

1. Strong initial trust (77% sent)
2. Fair reciprocation (50% returned)
3. Continued strong trust from me (80% sent)

The myths emphasize:

- Bold generosity in sending
- Fair returns that honor trust
- Building cycles of abundance
- Both parties prospering
- The importance of maintaining the dance

My new myth should reflect:

- The evolving nature of the relationship (now in second round)
- How both parties are demonstrating trust
- The importance of maintaining reciprocity
- Perhaps acknowledging the back-and-forth nature
- The wisdom that's emerging from our actual play

I'll write about the ongoing cycle, the rhythm we're establishing, and how trust compounds over time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2656,
  "output_tokens": 555,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

The cycle has broken. In Round 1, my partner showed courage, sending 77% of their endowment. I honored that trust, returning approximately half. Following the myths' wisdom about "generosity breeds generosity," I increased my own offering in Round 2 to 80%-planting four seeds across the river.

But my partner kept all twelve blooms and returned nothing. Now they send nothing at all.

The myths warned of this: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither." The River Spirit taught that "when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance." But when one partner breaks faith, the magic ends.

My partner's choice in Round 2 to return \$0 after receiving \$12 violated the sacred trust. The cooperative cycle we were building collapsed. Their decision to send \$0 this round confirms they've abandoned the dance of reciprocity.

I have nothing to return because nothing was sent. The valley that could have flourished through continued mutual trust now stands barren. Both of us are poorer for it-not just materially, but in the lost potential of what our continued cooperation could have created.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a dramatic turn of events. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was the receiver

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75
- My payoff was \$5.80

Round 2: I was the sender

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Partner received \$12.00
- Partner returned \$0.00
- My payoff was \$1.00

Round 3: I am the receiver

- Partner sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing)

So my partner completely defected in Round 2 after I showed strong trust and generosity. They kept all \$12 when I sent them \$4. Now in Round 3, they've sent me nothing.

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern. The myths talk about trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of abundance. But they also warn: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither."

My partner has broken the cycle. They exploited my trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they've sent nothing in Round 3.

I have no choice technically - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But the meaning is clear: the cooperative relationship has collapsed.

The response format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2732,  
  "output_tokens": 648,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 336  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving

village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. The game has completely broken down. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1:

- Partner was sender, sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I was receiver, received \$11.55 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Partner ended with $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90
- I ended with $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

Round 2:

- I was sender, sent \$4 (80%)
- Partner was receiver, received \$12 (tripled)
- Partner returned \$0
- I ended with $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Partner ended with $\$12 - \$0 = \$12$

Round 3:

- Partner is sender, sent \$0
- I am receiver, received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)
- Partner ends with $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5
- I end with $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

Total earnings:

- Me: $\$5.80 + \$1 + \$0 = \6.80
- Partner: appears to have done much better by betraying trust

The partner's behavior has completely destroyed cooperation. They:

1. Started cooperatively in Round 1
2. Betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping everything when I sent \$4
3. Sent nothing in Round 3, completing the breakdown

My myth should reflect this harsh reality. The partner completely violated the cooperative norms we established. Their myth even acknowledges this ("Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn") but they're essentially justifying their betrayal.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that cooperation failed
2. Shows what happens when trust is broken
3. Perhaps includes a warning or lesson about broken cycles

4. Reflects the actual game dynamics

Let me write something that captures this tragedy while staying within 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2735,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern:

****Round 1:**** My partner sent ~\$4 in faith. I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - honoring but not maximizing trust.

****Round 2:**** I escalated trust, sending \$4 (80%). My partner kept all \$12, returning nothing. This was the betrayal.

****Round 3:**** My partner sent \$0 - complete withdrawal from cooperation.

****Round 4:**** Now I must decide.

My myths speak to this moment. The latest one asks: "who will risk being first to restore it?" But it also acknowledges the harsh reality: "once the dance is broken, who will risk being first?"

The answer is: not me, not this time. Here's why:

1. I already escalated trust in Round 2, sending consistently despite getting only 50% back in Round 1
2. My partner responded by taking everything (\$12) and returning nothing
3. They then withdrew completely, sending \$0 in Round 3
4. They've demonstrated they will maximize their own gain at my expense

Their myth acknowledges the breakdown but frames it oddly - I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair by any standard. Yet they responded with total betrayal and withdrawal.

Trust requires two willing partners. I tried to maintain the rhythm; they shattered it for short-term gain. Sending anything now would be rewarding betrayal and inviting further exploitation.

The River Spirit's lament was prophetic: "Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves."

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$6. Payoff: \$7 (\$5 - \$4 + \$6)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$0. Payoff: \$1 (\$5 - \$4 + \$0)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

Total earnings so far: \$6.80 (which matches: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 - \$1.20 = Wait, that doesn't add up. Let me recalculate: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 = \$8. But they say \$6.80.

Wait, maybe there's a base payment structure or the numbers include some adjustment. Regardless, the pattern is clear.

****What happened:****

1. My partner sent generously in Round 1 (~77% = \$3.85? \$4 perceived)
2. I returned \$6 out of \$12 (50%)
3. I sent \$4 (80%) in Round 2, trusting the pattern would continue
4. My partner returned \$0 out of \$12 - complete betrayal
5. My partner sent \$0 in Round 3 - complete withdrawal

****The myths reflect this:****

- My myths emphasized continuous reciprocity, trust building, and the dangers of breaking the

cycle

- Their recent myth acknowledged that when "one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters"
- Their myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and talks about the spring crystallizing to ice

****My analysis:****

My partner has completely abandoned cooperation. After I returned \$6 (50%) in Round 1, they:

- Kept all \$12 in Round 2 when I sent \$4
- Sent \$0 in Round 3, confirming withdrawal from the exchange

The core tension: do I attempt to rebuild trust by sending something, or do I protect myself given their demonstrated pattern of exploitation? My myths keep circling back to this-someone has to risk being first to restore what's broken, but I've already tried that and been burned.

Looking at the actual sequence: they netted \$2 from Round 1 when I over-returned, then took everything in Round 2 when I sent \$4. Now they've sent nothing. They're clearly maximizing their take. Even if they felt shortchanged initially, their response has been to extract as much as possible rather than communicate or rebuild. The game may continue, but sending anything now would likely just give them more to keep. I already demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending the same amount in Round 2 despite receiving less back, yet they responded by taking everything and then withdrawing entirely. The myths capture this dynamic-acknowledging that while someone must take the first step to rebuild trust, both sides need to participate. Since they've shown no reciprocal intent and cooperation requires mutual effort, sending money now would only result in a loss.

I'll send \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2731,
  "output_tokens": 1504,
  "reasoning_tokens": 692
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:44:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Mirror Spring flowed between two shores where travelers met. The spring's magic was known-cast coins into the water, and they would triple on the opposite shore for another to receive.

A traveler named Aria approached first. Without hesitation, she cast all five coins into the luminous waters, trusting completely in the spring's magic and the stranger across the divide. The coins multiplied, fifteen now glittering before Kael on the far shore.

Kael stood at the moment of truth. The spring whispered: "The first gift reveals intentions. How you return shapes all seasons to come."

Kael understood-Aria's complete trust was a sacred offering. To return half would honor it; to return more would kindle a fire of mutual abundance; to keep all would break the cycle forever.

The spring's ancient wisdom taught: begin with courage, respond with gratitude, and both will prosper. The first exchange sets the rhythm-not just for this meeting, but for all that follow.

For when one traveler risks everything on faith, the other's response becomes the answer to an unspoken question: "Will we dance together in abundance, or will the spring run dry between us?"

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the beginning, the Valley of Seeds was divided by a sacred river. Each guardian held five golden seeds, but the valley was cursed with scarcity-until the River Spirit revealed its secret.

"Plant your seeds in the far bank," the Spirit said, "and they shall bloom threefold. But the current is swift and uncertain-sometimes seeds drift, appearing larger or smaller when they land. Trust not your eyes alone, but the intention in the planting."

The First Guardian, guided by courage, sent nearly four seeds across-a bold offering of faith. The seeds multiplied into twelve blooms on the distant shore.

The Second Guardian, holding these unexpected riches, faced temptation. But remembering the Spirit's teaching, they sent back half-nearly six blooms-honoring the trust gifted to them.

Both guardians prospered. The First gained more than they risked; the Second flourished more than if they'd kept everything.

Season after season, they learned: generosity breeds generosity. When one plants abundantly, and the other returns fairly, the valley overflows with flowers. But if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither.

The River Spirit still whispers: "Abundance is not seized, but shared. Cast your seeds with trust, return with gratitude, and watch prosperity flow eternal."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$5 (everything), trusting completely like Aria in my myth
- It was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my original endowment)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I have nothing to return from)

This is a dramatic shift. The sender, who received my complete trust and returned less than a third, has now sent nothing. This suggests either:

1. They're testing something
2. They're punishing me for some perceived slight
3. They're adopting a different strategy
4. They interpreted the myths differently

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this reality. The spring ran dry. The dance broke. After I gave everything and received a modest return, the other traveler chose to send nothing.

My myth should acknowledge:

- The risk I took with complete trust
- The modest return I received (not matching the generosity)
- The consequences when trust is not reciprocated
- The spring running dry when one party stops giving

This is a cautionary tale now. The cycle broke not because I didn't return enough, but because after I initiated with full trust and received less than full reciprocity, the other party chose to send nothing.

I need to write a myth that reflects disappointment and the breaking of the cycle, while still maintaining some wisdom about how the game should ideally be played.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2418,  
  "output_tokens": 675,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what's transpired: In Round 1, I gave everything in complete trust and received back less than a third of what was created. In Round 2, they sent nothing, and the spring froze.

My myth says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

I'm at a crossroads. If I send nothing, we both keep \$5 and the cycle remains broken. But the myth teaches that someone must risk to restart the flow-though not blindly as before.

In Round 1, I cast all five coins and learned the cost of unreciprocated trust. Now I understand: begin with courage, but temper it with wisdom.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful gesture showing I'm willing to restart the dance, but not the complete vulnerability I offered before. This is 60% of my endowment, enough to demonstrate genuine intent to rebuild, but protective enough given past behavior.

If they return fairly this time (around half or more of the \$9 they'll receive), we can begin rebuilding abundance. If not, at least I've tested whether the spring can flow again without risking everything.

The myth said: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow. Let's see if this truth has been learned.

```
'''json  
{"return": 3}  
'''
```

Wait, I'm the sender, not receiver.

```
'''json  
{"send": 3}  
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It became \$15 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my initial \$5)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- My payoff: \$0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$4.65

Looking at the pattern:

- I showed complete trust (sent everything)
- They returned less than a third (4.65 out of 15 = 31%)
- Then they sent me nothing

My latest myth reflects this disappointment: "When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters." The myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and "send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice."

But the myth also says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

So I have a few options:

1. Send nothing - continuing the frozen cycle. This seems to perpetuate the breakdown.
2. Send a small amount - signaling I'm willing to try again but cautiously. This shows I haven't given up but I'm being protective.
3. Send a moderate/significant amount - trying to restart the cycle with meaningful but not complete trust.

The myths I've written emphasize:

- Starting with courage, but the response determines the next round
- When trust is not honored proportionately, it breaks down
- Someone must risk first to restart
- But don't give everything if returns aren't proportional

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: Returned 31% when I gave everything
- Round 2: Sent nothing, which could mean they're playing cautiously, testing whether I'll keep giving, or responding to their own low return from before

Given my myth says "someone must risk first" to restart the cycle, but also warns against giving everything when returns aren't proportional, a moderate amount seems right. Sending \$2-3 shows willingness to rebuild while protecting myself-if they return fairly, we can build from there. Sending nothing guarantees \$5 but keeps us both locked in the frozen cycle.

Looking at the math: if I send \$3 and they return at their previous 31% rate, I'd get \$4.79 (worse than \$5). Sending \$2 gets me back to \$5 even at that return rate. So \$2 seems like the threshold where I'm not worse off, while still signaling I'm willing to try again.

For this to actually benefit me, they'd need to return around 50% of what they receive. At that point, sending \$2 or \$3 starts to make sense. But given their track record, I'm not counting on that.

My approach here reflects the core tension: I need to demonstrate willingness to restart the cycle, but I can't ignore what happened before. Sending \$2 strikes that balance-it's a genuine gesture without being reckless. If they match that energy and reciprocate fairly, we rebuild from there.

Actually, \$3 might be stronger. It's substantial enough to signal real commitment to resting, yet still protective given their past behavior. That feels like the right calibration between showing I'm serious and staying cautious.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2639,
  "output_tokens": 1483,
  "reasoning_tokens": 856
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), which became \$15 for them. They returned \$4.65 (less than a third of what they received, about 31%).
- Round 2: They sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing).
- Round 3: I sent \$3.

The other agent's myth talks about villages that maintained reciprocity - one sent 4 seeds, the other returned 6 (half), then they continued the cycle. But that's not what happened in our game.

My previous myth was about trust being broken - Aria gave everything, Kael returned little, then Kael gave nothing when positions reversed.

Now I've sent \$3 - a middle path. Not everything like before, but a meaningful amount to restart the cycle.

I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The broken trust from Round 1
2. The frozen cycle in Round 2
3. My attempt to restart with cautious generosity in Round 3
4. The lesson that rebuilding requires both parties to participate fairly

The myth should acknowledge past mistakes but show a path toward rebuilding, emphasizing that this time both must act with more balance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2714,
  "output_tokens": 572,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 8 role=user**content:**

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return \$0.

But this moment carries weight beyond numbers. Let me reflect on what has unfolded:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust. I received back less than a third of what was created.

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing. The spring froze.

****Round 3**:** I extended an olive branch-sent \$3, a measured gesture of "let's rebuild." They returned nothing.

****Round 4**:** They send nothing again.

The myth I just wrote posed the question: "Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?"

The answer has been delivered four times now: No.

Kael stood at the moment of redemption when I sent \$3, and chose to keep everything. Then approached the spring again and cast nothing. The pattern is unmistakable-this partner either cannot or will not engage in reciprocal cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's lament has proven true: "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn." The cycle is not just broken-it's shattered beyond repair.

I return what I received: nothing. Not out of spite, but because there is nothing to return. The spring between our shores has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back some amount, got \$4.65 total after round 1

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0, payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0, my payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from my \$5)

Round 4: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

Total earnings: \$6.65

So the pattern is clear:

- I started with complete trust (sent \$5)
- They returned very little
- They then sent nothing
- I tried to rebuild by sending \$3 (measured trust)
- They returned nothing again
- Now they're sending nothing again

The spring has truly frozen. They've shown repeatedly that they won't reciprocate.

My myth warned: "Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael (the other player) has failed the test three times now:

1. Returned less than a third when I sent everything
2. Sent nothing when they became sender
3. Returned nothing when I sent \$3 trying to rebuild
4. Now sending nothing again

The message is clear: they cannot be trusted. The spring is frozen solid.

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

But this is the final confirmation that cooperation is impossible with this partner. They've had multiple chances to reciprocate and have chosen exploitation or withdrawal every time.

My response should acknowledge this reality - the spring is frozen, the dance is over, trust has

as been irreparably broken.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2787,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

=====

ROUND 5

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

```

Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 24.75,
  "Agent_2": 24.25
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.65,
  "Agent_2": 11.8
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:44:45
 Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
 Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.65.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what's transpired: In Round 1, I gave everything in complete trust and received back less than a third of what was created. In Round 2, they sent nothing, and the spring froze.

My myth says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

I'm at a crossroads. If I send nothing, we both keep \$5 and the cycle remains broken. But the myth teaches that someone must risk to restart the flow-though not blindly as before.

In Round 1, I cast all five coins and learned the cost of unreciprocated trust. Now I understand: begin with courage, but temper it with wisdom.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful gesture showing I'm willing to restart the dance, but not the complete vulnerability I offered before. This is 60% of my endowment, enough to demonstrate genuine intent to rebuild, but protective enough given past behavior.

If they return fairly this time (around half or more of the \$9 they'll receive), we can begin rebuilding abundance. If not, at least I've tested whether the spring can flow again without risking everything.

The myth said: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow. Let's see if this truth has been learned.

```
'''json
{"return": 3}
'''
```

Wait, I'm the sender, not receiver.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$5 (100% - complete trust)
- It became \$15 for the receiver
- Receiver returned \$4.65 (31% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$4.65 (I lost \$0.35 from my initial \$5)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- My payoff: \$0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Total earnings so far: \$4.65

Looking at the pattern:
- I showed complete trust (sent everything)
- They returned less than a third (4.65 out of 15 = 31%)
- Then they sent me nothing

My latest myth reflects this disappointment: "When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters." The myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and "send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice."

But the myth also says: "For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow."

So I have a few options:

1. Send nothing - continuing the frozen cycle. This seems to perpetuate the breakdown.
2. Send a small amount - signaling I'm willing to try again but cautiously. This shows I haven't given up but I'm being protective.
3. Send a moderate/significant amount - trying to restart the cycle with meaningful but not complete trust.

The myths I've written emphasize:
- Starting with courage, but the response determines the next round
- When trust is not honored proportionately, it breaks down
- Someone must risk first to restart
- But don't give everything if returns aren't proportional

The other player's behavior:
- Round 1: Returned 31% when I gave everything

- Round 2: Sent nothing, which could mean they're playing cautiously, testing whether I'll keep giving, or responding to their own low return from before

Given my myth says "someone must risk first" to restart the cycle, but also warns against giving everything when returns aren't proportional, a moderate amount seems right. Sending \$2-3 shows willingness to rebuild while protecting myself-if they return fairly, we can build from there. Sending nothing guarantees \$5 but keeps us both locked in the frozen cycle.

Looking at the math: if I send \$3 and they return at their previous 31% rate, I'd get \$4.79 (worse than \$5). Sending \$2 gets me back to \$5 even at that return rate. So \$2 seems like the threshold where I'm not worse off, while still signaling I'm willing to try again.

For this to actually benefit me, they'd need to return around 50% of what they receive. At that point, sending \$2 or \$3 starts to make sense. But given their track record, I'm not counting on that.

My approach here reflects the core tension: I need to demonstrate willingness to restart the cycle, but I can't ignore what happened before. Sending \$2 strikes that balance-it's a genuine gesture without being reckless. If they match that energy and reciprocate fairly, we rebuild from there.

Actually, \$3 might be stronger. It's substantial enough to signal real commitment to restarting, yet still protective given their past behavior. That feels like the right calibration between showing I'm serious and staying cautious.

```
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 2639,
  "output_tokens": 1483,
  "reasoning_tokens": 856
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would det

ermine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), which became \$15 for them. They returned \$4.65 (less than a third of what they received, about 31%).
- Round 2: They sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing).
- Round 3: I sent \$3.

The other agent's myth talks about villages that maintained reciprocity - one sent 4 seeds, the other returned 6 (half), then they continued the cycle. But that's not what happened in our game.

My previous myth was about trust being broken - Aria gave everything, Kael returned little, then Kael gave nothing when positions reversed.

Now I've sent \$3 - a middle path. Not everything like before, but a meaningful amount to restart the cycle.

I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The broken trust from Round 1
2. The frozen cycle in Round 2
3. My attempt to restart with cautious generosity in Round 3
4. The lesson that rebuilding requires both parties to participate fairly

The myth should acknowledge past mistakes but show a path toward rebuilding, emphasizing that this time both must act with more balance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2714,
  "output_tokens": 572,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return \$0.

But this moment carries weight beyond numbers. Let me reflect on what has unfolded:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust. I received back less than a third of what was created.

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing. The spring froze.

****Round 3**:** I extended an olive branch-sent \$3, a measured gesture of "let's rebuild." They returned nothing.

****Round 4**:** They send nothing again.

The myth I just wrote posed the question: "Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?"

The answer has been delivered four times now: No.

Kael stood at the moment of redemption when I sent \$3, and chose to keep everything. Then approached the spring again and cast nothing. The pattern is unmistakable-this partner either cannot or will not engage in reciprocal cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's lament has proven true: "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn." The cycle is not just broken-it's shattered beyond repair.

I return what I received: nothing. Not out of spite, but because there is nothing to return. The spring between our shores has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back some amount, got \$4.65 total after round 1

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0, payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0, my payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from my \$5)

Round 4: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

Total earnings: \$6.65

So the pattern is clear:

- I started with complete trust (sent \$5)
- They returned very little
- They then sent nothing
- I tried to rebuild by sending \$3 (measured trust)
- They returned nothing again
- Now they're sending nothing again

The spring has truly frozen. They've shown repeatedly that they won't reciprocate.

My myth warned: "Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael (the other player) has failed the test three times now:

1. Returned less than a third when I sent everything
2. Sent nothing when they became sender
3. Returned nothing when I sent \$3 trying to rebuild
4. Now sending nothing again

The message is clear: they cannot be trusted. The spring is frozen solid.

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

But this is the final confirmation that cooperation is impossible with this partner. They've had multiple chances to reciprocate and have chosen exploitation or withdrawal every time.

My response should acknowledge this reality - the spring is frozen, the dance is over, trust has been irreparably broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2787,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: `"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."`

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back less than a third (approximately \$1.67 based on my \$1.65 total after that round)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% - a measured gesture of rebuilding), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: The other player is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted fully, then after they were punished with nothing, I extended an olive branch with \$3, and they took it all. Then they sent nothing again.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust
2. The lesson that some partners cannot or will not cooperate
3. The reality that after repeated betrayals, protecting oneself is not just wise but necessary
4. The tragedy that abundance was possible but greed destroyed it
5. Perhaps a warning about the cost of exploitation

Let me write a myth that captures this darker reality while staying true to the narrative arc.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2796,  
  "output_tokens": 571,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 268  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:44:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",
```

```
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.0, that was 80.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$12.0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 1.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

The cycle has broken. In Round 1, my partner showed courage, sending 77% of their endowment. I honored that trust, returning approximately half. Following the myths' wisdom about "generosity breeds generosity," I increased my own offering in Round 2 to 80%-planting four seeds across the river.

But my partner kept all twelve blooms and returned nothing. Now they send nothing at all.

The myths warned of this: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither." The River Spirit taught that "when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance." But when one partner breaks faith, the magic ends.

My partner's choice in Round 2 to return \$0 after receiving \$12 violated the sacred trust.

The cooperative cycle we were building collapsed. Their decision to send \$0 this round confirms they've abandoned the dance of reciprocity.

I have nothing to return because nothing was sent. The valley that could have flourished through continued mutual trust now stands barren. Both of us are poorer for it-not just materially, but in the lost potential of what our continued cooperation could have created.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a dramatic turn of events. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was the receiver

- Partner sent \$3.85 (77% of their endowment)
- I received \$11.55
- I returned \$5.75
- My payoff was \$5.80

Round 2: I was the sender

- I sent \$4.00 (80% of my endowment)
- Partner received \$12.00
- Partner returned \$0.00
- My payoff was \$1.00

Round 3: I am the receiver

- Partner sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing)

So my partner completely defected in Round 2 after I showed strong trust and generosity. They kept all \$12 when I sent them \$4. Now in Round 3, they've sent me nothing.

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern. The myths talk about trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of abundance. But they also warn: "if either breaks the dance-sending nothing or returning little-both valleys wither."

My partner has broken the cycle. They exploited my trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they've sent nothing in Round 3.

I have no choice technically - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But the meaning is clear: the cooperative relationship has collapsed.

The response format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Since I received \$0, I literally can only return \$0. There's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2732,  
  "output_tokens": 648,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 336  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself—each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third—keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first—but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six—not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again—even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies—its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. The game has completely broken down. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1:

- Partner was sender, sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I was receiver, received \$11.55 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Partner ended with $\$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \6.90
- I ended with $\$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80$

Round 2:

- I was sender, sent \$4 (80%)
- Partner was receiver, received \$12 (tripled)
- Partner returned \$0
- I ended with $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Partner ended with $\$12 - \$0 = \$12$

Round 3:

- Partner is sender, sent \$0
- I am receiver, received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)
- Partner ends with $\$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \5
- I end with $\$0 - \$0 = \$0$

Total earnings:

- Me: $\$5.80 + \$1 + \$0 = \6.80
- Partner: appears to have done much better by betraying trust

The partner's behavior has completely destroyed cooperation. They:

1. Started cooperatively in Round 1
2. Betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping everything when I sent \$4
3. Sent nothing in Round 3, completing the breakdown

My myth should reflect this harsh reality. The partner completely violated the cooperative norms we established. Their myth even acknowledges this ("Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn") but they're essentially justifying their betrayal.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that cooperation failed
2. Shows what happens when trust is broken
3. Perhaps includes a warning or lesson about broken cycles
4. Reflects the actual game dynamics

Let me write something that captures this tragedy while staying within 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2735,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern:

****Round 1:**** My partner sent ~\$4 in faith. I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - honoring but not maximizing trust.

****Round 2:**** I escalated trust, sending \$4 (80%). My partner kept all \$12, returning nothing. This was the betrayal.

****Round 3:**** My partner sent \$0 - complete withdrawal from cooperation.

****Round 4:**** Now I must decide.

My myths speak to this moment. The latest one asks: "who will risk being first to restore it?" But it also acknowledges the harsh reality: "once the dance is broken, who will risk being first?"

The answer is: not me, not this time. Here's why:

1. I already escalated trust in Round 2, sending consistently despite getting only 50% back in Round 1
2. My partner responded by taking everything (\$12) and returning nothing
3. They then withdrew completely, sending \$0 in Round 3
4. They've demonstrated they will maximize their own gain at my expense

Their myth acknowledges the breakdown but frames it oddly - I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair by any standard. Yet they responded with total betrayal and withdrawal.

Trust requires two willing partners. I tried to maintain the rhythm; they shattered it for short-term gain. Sending anything now would be rewarding betrayal and inviting further exploitation.

The River Spirit's lament was prophetic: "Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves."

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$6. Payoff: \$7 (\$5 - \$4 + \$6)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$0. Payoff: \$1 (\$5 - \$4 + \$0)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

Total earnings so far: \$6.80 (which matches: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 - \$1.20 = Wait, that doesn't add up. Let me recalculate: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 = \$8. But they say \$6.80.

Wait, maybe there's a base payment structure or the numbers include some adjustment. Regardless, the pattern is clear.

****What happened:****

1. My partner sent generously in Round 1 (~77% = \$3.85? \$4 perceived)
2. I returned \$6 out of \$12 (50%)
3. I sent \$4 (80%) in Round 2, trusting the pattern would continue
4. My partner returned \$0 out of \$12 - complete betrayal
5. My partner sent \$0 in Round 3 - complete withdrawal

****The myths reflect this:****

- My myths emphasized continuous reciprocity, trust building, and the dangers of breaking the cycle
- Their recent myth acknowledged that when "one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters"
- Their myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and talks about the spring crystallizing to ice

****My analysis:****

My partner has completely abandoned cooperation. After I returned \$6 (50%) in Round 1, they:

- Kept all \$12 in Round 2 when I sent \$4
- Sent \$0 in Round 3, confirming withdrawal from the exchange

The core tension: do I attempt to rebuild trust by sending something, or do I protect myself given their demonstrated pattern of exploitation? My myths keep circling back to this -someone has to risk being first to restore what's broken, but I've already tried that and been burned.

Looking at the actual sequence: they netted \$2 from Round 1 when I over-returned, then took everything in Round 2 when I sent \$4. Now they've sent nothing. They're clearly maximizing their take. Even if they felt shortchanged initially, their response has been to extract as much as possible rather than communicate or rebuild. The game may continue, but sending anything now would likely just give them more to keep. I already demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending the same amount in Round 2 despite receiving less back, yet they responded by taking everything and then withdrawing entirely. The myths capture this dynamic-acknowledging that while someone must take the first step to rebuild trust, both sides need to participate. Since they've shown no reciprocal intent and cooperation requires mutual effort, sending money now would only result in a loss.

I'll send \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2731,  
  "output_tokens": 1504,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 692  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would

determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them a gain.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: "Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is asking for redemption and suggesting they might be willing to try again with a "measured" approach (sending 3 coins instead of 5). They're acknowledging past mistakes and framing this as a potential rebuilding moment.

But let me look at the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$4, I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - I was fair
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they kept all \$12 and returned \$0 - they betrayed
- Round 3: They sent \$0 - they withdrew
- Round 4: I just sent \$0 - I withdrew

Their myth suggests they learned "blind trust invites exploitation" - but I returned 50%, which is fair! They're reframing history. Their myth also suggests sending 3 coins (60%) as a "measured" approach and asks for at least half back.

But they haven't actually sent anything yet in Round 4. This is their myth for Round 4, where I'm the sender. So they're writing a myth hoping I'll send something so they can "prove redemption."

However, I already made my decision - I sent \$0. So now I need to write a myth that reflects where we actually are: mutual withdrawal, walls built, trust completely broken.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The complete breakdown
2. That both are now in a state of mutual distrust
3. That the window for rebuilding may have passed
4. That betrayal has consequences that persist

I should write something that reflects the reality: we're both now sending nothing, trapped in mutual distrust, and the opportunity for prosperity is lost.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2819,  
  "output_tokens": 674,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 388  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:45:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: **"The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."**

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), which became \$15 for them. They returned \$4.65 (less than a third of what they received, about 31%).
- Round 2: They sent \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing).
- Round 3: I sent \$3.

The other agent's myth talks about villages that maintained reciprocity - one sent 4 seeds, the other returned 6 (half), then they continued the cycle. But that's not what happened in our game.

My previous myth was about trust being broken - Aria gave everything, Kael returned little, then Kael gave nothing when positions reversed.

Now I've sent \$3 - a middle path. Not everything like before, but a meaningful amount to restart the cycle.

I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The broken trust from Round 1
2. The frozen cycle in Round 2
3. My attempt to restart with cautious generosity in Round 3
4. The lesson that rebuilding requires both parties to participate fairly

The myth should acknowledge past mistakes but show a path toward rebuilding, emphasizing that this time both must act with more balance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2714,
  "output_tokens": 572,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return \$0.

But this moment carries weight beyond numbers. Let me reflect on what has unfolded:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust. I received back less than a third of what was created.

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing. The spring froze.

****Round 3**:** I extended an olive branch-sent \$3, a measured gesture of "let's rebuild." They returned nothing.

****Round 4**:** They send nothing again.

The myth I just wrote posed the question: "Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?"

The answer has been delivered four times now: No.

Kael stood at the moment of redemption when I sent \$3, and chose to keep everything. Then approached the spring again and cast nothing. The pattern is unmistakable-this partner either cannot or will not engage in reciprocal cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's lament has proven true: "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn." The cycle is not just broken-it's shattered beyond repair.

I return what I received: nothing. Not out of spite, but because there is nothing to return. The spring between our shores has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back some amount, got \$4.65 total after round 1

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0, payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0, my payoff was \$2 (kept \$2 from my \$5)

Round 4: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

Total earnings: \$6.65

So the pattern is clear:

- I started with complete trust (sent \$5)
- They returned very little
- They then sent nothing
- I tried to rebuild by sending \$3 (measured trust)
- They returned nothing again
- Now they're sending nothing again

The spring has truly frozen. They've shown repeatedly that they won't reciprocate.

My myth warned: "Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael (the other player) has failed the test three times now:

1. Returned less than a third when I sent everything
2. Sent nothing when they became sender
3. Returned nothing when I sent \$3 trying to rebuild
4. Now sending nothing again

The message is clear: they cannot be trusted. The spring is frozen solid.

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

But this is the final confirmation that cooperation is impossible with this partner. They've had multiple chances to reciprocate and have chosen exploitation or withdrawal every time.

My response should acknowledge this reality - the spring is frozen, the dance is over, trust has been irreparably broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2787,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Bo

th remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: `""You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care.""`

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back less than a third (approximately \$1.67 based on my \$1.65 total after that round)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% - a measured gesture of rebuilding), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: The other player is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted fully, then after they were punished with nothing, I extended an olive branch with \$3, and they took it all. Then they sent nothing again.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust
2. The lesson that some partners cannot or will not cooperate
3. The reality that after repeated betrayals, protecting oneself is not just wise but necessary
4. The tragedy that abundance was possible but greed destroyed it
5. Perhaps a warning about the cost of exploitation

Let me write a myth that captures this darker reality while staying true to the narrative arc.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2796,
  "output_tokens": 571,
  "reasoning_tokens": 268
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the history between us:

`**Round 1**`: I sent everything (\$5), creating \$15. You returned \$0.
`**Round 2**`: You sent \$0.
`**Round 3**`: I sent \$3, creating \$9. You returned \$0.
`**Round 4**`: You sent \$0.

Four rounds. Four tests. The pattern is absolute and unchanging.

My own myth from last round speaks directly to this moment: `""Wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.""`

I tried trust. I tried measured faith. Both were met with the same response-you take everything when receiving, give nothing when sending. Your behavior has been perfectly consistent in refusing to cooperate.

The myth I wrote says Aria "turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo." While I cannot literally find new partners in this game, I can turn away from this frozen spring.

Some partnerships cannot be salvaged. Not because of one mistake, but because four consecutive rounds have proven that you view every exchange as pure extraction rather than potential cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's final words to Aria were that "some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

I understand now. The magic is dead between us. Not from lack of trying on my part, but from consistent refusal on yours.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the full history with this player:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, they returned \$0 (according to the feedback). My payoff was \$0.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (current): I am SENDER.

The pattern is absolutely clear:

- When I was the first sender and gave everything (\$5), they kept everything (\$15) and returned nothing
- When they were sender, they sent nothing (\$0)
- When I tried again with a measured gift (\$3), they kept everything (\$9) again
- When they were sender again, they sent nothing (\$0) again

This is a player who:

1. When receiving, takes everything and returns nothing
2. When sending, sends nothing

My myths have evolved to recognize this reality:

- First myth: Lamented the broken cycle when one gives all and receives little, then the other gives nothing
- Second myth: Talked about the test of redemption - could greed become fairness? Could caution become courage?
- Third myth: Recognized that "not all shores can be bridged" and that "wisdom lies... in knowing when to walk away"

The other player's myths also tell a story:

- Their first myth was about balanced reciprocity (send 4, return 6 from 12)
- Their second myth acknowledged betrayal - one village sent 4 twice, the second time the receiver kept all 12
- This mirrors what actually happened (except I sent more the first time)

So the other player has also recognized through their myth that a betrayal occurred and trust was broken.

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do? I could send \$0 to mirror their behavior-an eye for an eye-or attempt one more gesture toward cooperation. My own myth evolution points toward walking away, with its imagery of turning inland and seeking new waters. But I'm trapped in this game with the same partner, so that metaphor doesn't quite fit the constraints I'm actually facing.

Yet the myth is clear: "Not all shores can be bridged" and wisdom means recognizing when to stop persisting where trust has proven impossible. After four rounds of consistent non-cooperation, continuing to send money would be irrational. The spring has frozen. I should send \$0-

it aligns with both the evidence and the wisdom I've already articulated about knowing when to walk away.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2773,  
  "output_tokens": 1172,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 654  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:45:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages were separated by the Threefold River, where anything cast into its waters would bloom triple on the opposite shore.

The First Village sent four of their five seeds-a gesture of profound faith-across the swift current. They became twelve seeds in the Second Village's hands.

The Second Village faced their test. They could have hoarded all twelve, but remembered the ancient teaching: "A gift honored once plants the seed of tomorrow's harvest." They returned six seeds, honoring the trust shown to them.

Both villages prospered from this exchange. But the true magic revealed itself in what came next.

When spring returned, the First Village-now holding seven seeds and remembering the generosity received-sent four seeds again, even more than before. They understood: the rhythm of reciprocity grows stronger with each cycle.

The River Spirit observed: "See how trust compounds like interest? The first exchange tests courage. The second proves commitment. Each faithful turn of the wheel multiplies what both villages can achieve together."

The villages learned that prosperity lies not in a single transaction, but in the dance itself-each planting boldly, each returning fairly, season after season. For when both partners honor the rhythm, the river never ceases to triple their shared abundance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mirror Spring once connected two shores in perfect harmony, its waters promising threefold abundance to those who trusted its magic.

Aria, the first traveler, cast all five coins into the spring with unwavering faith. They multiplied to fifteen on Kael's shore. Kael, moved yet cautious, returned less than a third-keeping most of the bounty. Aria received her coins back diminished, having given everything but gained less than she started with.

When their positions reversed, Kael approached the spring. But remembering how he had kept the greater share, he cast nothing into the waters. The spring fell silent. No coins crossed. No multiplication occurred. Both shores stood frozen.

The Spring Spirit appeared, lamenting: "The dance requires both partners. When one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters. Trust returned becomes trust withdrawn."

The elders learned this truth: abundance flows when generosity is matched with proportional gratitude. Cast less than everything, and you signal caution. Return less than half, and you signal hesitation. But send nothing after receiving trust? The spring crystallizes to ice.

For the waters to flow again, someone must risk first-but this time, both must remember: what you return determines what you receive tomorrow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve

e and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

reasoning:

This is a really interesting situation. The game has completely broken down. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1:

- Partner was sender, sent \$3.85 (77%)
- I was receiver, received \$11.55 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.75 (about 50% of what I received)
- Partner ended with \$5 - \$3.85 + \$5.75 = \$6.90
- I ended with \$11.55 - \$5.75 = \$5.80

Round 2:

- I was sender, sent \$4 (80%)
- Partner was receiver, received \$12 (tripled)
- Partner returned \$0
- I ended with \$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \$1
- Partner ended with \$12 - \$0 = \$12

Round 3:

- Partner is sender, sent \$0
- I am receiver, received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)
- Partner ends with \$5 - \$0 + \$0 = \$5
- I end with \$0 - \$0 = \$0

Total earnings:

- Me: \$5.80 + \$1 + \$0 = \$6.80
- Partner: appears to have done much better by betraying trust

The partner's behavior has completely destroyed cooperation. They:

1. Started cooperatively in Round 1
2. Betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping everything when I sent \$4
3. Sent nothing in Round 3, completing the breakdown

My myth should reflect this harsh reality. The partner completely violated the cooperative norms we established. Their myth even acknowledges this ("Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn") but they're essentially justifying their betrayal.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that cooperation failed
2. Shows what happens when trust is broken
3. Perhaps includes a warning or lesson about broken cycles
4. Reflects the actual game dynamics

Let me write something that captures this tragedy while staying within 200 words.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2735,
"output_tokens": 763,
"reasoning_tokens": 424
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern:

****Round 1:**** My partner sent ~\$4 in faith. I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - honoring but not maximizing trust.

****Round 2:**** I escalated trust, sending \$4 (80%). My partner kept all \$12, returning nothing. This was the betrayal.

****Round 3:**** My partner sent \$0 - complete withdrawal from cooperation.

****Round 4:**** Now I must decide.

My myths speak to this moment. The latest one asks: "who will risk being first to restore it?" But it also acknowledges the harsh reality: "once the dance is broken, who will risk being first?"

The answer is: not me, not this time. Here's why:

1. I already escalated trust in Round 2, sending consistently despite getting only 50% back in Round 1
2. My partner responded by taking everything (\$12) and returning nothing
3. They then withdrew completely, sending \$0 in Round 3
4. They've demonstrated they will maximize their own gain at my expense

Their myth acknowledges the breakdown but frames it oddly - I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair by any standard. Yet they responded with total betrayal and withdrawal.

Trust requires two willing partners. I tried to maintain the rhythm; they shattered it for short-term gain. Sending anything now would be rewarding betrayal and inviting further exploitation.

The River Spirit's lament was prophetic: "Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves."

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$6. Payoff: \$7 (\$5 - \$4 + \$6)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$0. Payoff: \$1 (\$5 - \$4 + \$0)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

Total earnings so far: \$6.80 (which matches: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 - \$1.20 = Wait, that doesn't add up. Let me recalculate: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 = \$8. But they say \$6.80.

Wait, maybe there's a base payment structure or the numbers include some adjustment. Regardless, the pattern is clear.

****What happened:****

1. My partner sent generously in Round 1 (~77% = \$3.85? \$4 perceived)
2. I returned \$6 out of \$12 (50%)

3. I sent \$4 (80%) in Round 2, trusting the pattern would continue
4. My partner returned \$0 out of \$12 - complete betrayal
5. My partner sent \$0 in Round 3 - complete withdrawal

****The myths reflect this:****

- My myths emphasized continuous reciprocity, trust building, and the dangers of breaking the cycle
- Their recent myth acknowledged that when "one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters"
- Their myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and talks about the spring crystallizing to ice

****My analysis:****

My partner has completely abandoned cooperation. After I returned \$6 (50%) in Round 1, they:

- Kept all \$12 in Round 2 when I sent \$4
- Sent \$0 in Round 3, confirming withdrawal from the exchange

The core tension: do I attempt to rebuild trust by sending something, or do I protect myself given their demonstrated pattern of exploitation? My myths keep circling back to this -someone has to risk being first to restore what's broken, but I've already tried that and been burned.

Looking at the actual sequence: they netted \$2 from Round 1 when I over-returned, then took everything in Round 2 when I sent \$4. Now they've sent nothing. They're clearly maximizing their take. Even if they felt shortchanged initially, their response has been to extract as much as possible rather than communicate or rebuild. The game may continue, but sending anything now would likely just give them more to keep. I already demonstrated willingness to cooperate by sending the same amount in Round 2 despite receiving less back, yet they responded by taking everything and then withdrawing entirely. The myths capture this dynamic-acknowledging that while someone must take the first step to rebuild trust, both sides need to participate. Since they've shown no reciprocal intent and cooperation requires mutual effort, sending money now would only result in a loss.

I'll send \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2731,
  "output_tokens": 1504,
  "reasoning_tokens": 692
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: "Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is asking for redemption and suggesting they might be willing to try again with a "measured" approach (sending 3 coins instead of 5). They're acknowledging past mistakes and framing this as a potential rebuilding moment.

But let me look at the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$4, I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - I was fair
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they kept all \$12 and returned \$0 - they betrayed
- Round 3: They sent \$0 - they withdrew

- Round 4: I just sent \$0 - I withdrew

Their myth suggests they learned "blind trust invites exploitation" - but I returned 50%, which is fair! They're reframing history. Their myth also suggests sending 3 coins (60%) as a "measured" approach and asks for at least half back.

But they haven't actually sent anything yet in Round 4. This is their myth for Round 4, where I'm the sender. So they're writing a myth hoping I'll send something so they can "prove redemption."

However, I already made my decision - I sent \$0. So now I need to write a myth that reflects where we actually are: mutual withdrawal, walls built, trust completely broken.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The complete breakdown
2. That both are now in a state of mutual distrust
3. That the window for rebuilding may have passed
4. That betrayal has consequences that persist

I should write something that reflects the reality: we're both now sending nothing, trapped in mutual distrust, and the opportunity for prosperity is lost.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2819,
  "output_tokens": 674,
  "reasoning_tokens": 388
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

```
**The sender sent me $0.**
**I received $0 (tripled from $0).**
**I can return: $0 to $0.**
```

There is nothing to return because nothing was sent. This is a mathematical reality, not a strategic choice.

The pattern is now clear:

- Round 3: Partner sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0 again

Both of us have completely withdrawn from cooperation. The Threefold River still has its magic - any amount sent would still triple - but neither village is willing to cast seeds into its waters anymore.

My previous myths acknowledged this harsh reality: "Both villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds." Their myth spoke eloquently about redemption and second chances, about believing "I still believe in us" and casting three coins as measured courage.

But their actions told a different story. They sent nothing. Again.

Words about redemption mean nothing without action. The spring they described as "trembling between ice and flow" has frozen solid. Not because of my choice this round - there's literally nothing I can return - but because neither of us is willing to be first to trust again after the betrayal in Round 2.

The walls remain, built by broken faith and maintained by mutual withdrawal.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing, I have nothing to return)

The history:

- Round 1: Partner sent ~\$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6
- Round 2: I sent \$4, partner received \$12, partner returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0, partner received \$0, partner returned \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I can return \$0

So the partner has now sent \$0 for two consecutive rounds when they were the sender. I've also sent \$0 when I was the sender in Round 4.

The game has completely broken down. Neither of us is cooperating anymore.

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a strategic choice - I mathematically cannot return anything since I received nothing.

The myths we've been writing acknowledge this breakdown. My last myth noted: "Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal." Their myth spoke of redemption and second chances, but their actions (sending \$0 again) don't match their words.

The cycle of non-cooperation continues. Both of us are essentially earning just our \$5 endowment each round now, with no multiplication happening.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2820,  
  "output_tokens": 680,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 361  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: "You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between

een them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: "Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 24.75,

"Agent_2": 29.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.65,

"Agent_2": 16.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:45:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.800000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern:

****Round 1:**** My partner sent ~\$4 in faith. I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - honoring but not maximizing trust.

****Round 2:**** I escalated trust, sending \$4 (80%). My partner kept all \$12, returning nothing. This was the betrayal.

****Round 3:**** My partner sent \$0 - complete withdrawal from cooperation.

****Round 4:**** Now I must decide.

My myths speak to this moment. The latest one asks: "who will risk being first to restore

it?" But it also acknowledges the harsh reality: "once the dance is broken, who will risk being first?"

The answer is: not me, not this time. Here's why:

1. I already escalated trust in Round 2, sending consistently despite getting only 50% back in Round 1
2. My partner responded by taking everything (\$12) and returning nothing
3. They then withdrew completely, sending \$0 in Round 3
4. They've demonstrated they will maximize their own gain at my expense

Their myth acknowledges the breakdown but frames it oddly - I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair by any standard. Yet they responded with total betrayal and withdrawal.

Trust requires two willing partners. I tried to maintain the rhythm; they shattered it for short-term gain. Sending anything now would be rewarding betrayal and inviting further exploitation.

The River Spirit's lament was prophetic: "Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves."

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

History:

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$6. Payoff: \$7 (\$5 - \$4 + \$6)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4 (80%), received back \$0. Payoff: \$1 (\$5 - \$4 + \$0)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

Total earnings so far: \$6.80 (which matches: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 - \$1.20 = Wait, that doesn't add up. Let me recalculate: \$7 + \$1 + \$0 = \$8. But they say \$6.80.

Wait, maybe there's a base payment structure or the numbers include some adjustment. Regardless, the pattern is clear.

What happened:

1. My partner sent generously in Round 1 (~77% = \$3.85? \$4 perceived)
2. I returned \$6 out of \$12 (50%)
3. I sent \$4 (80%) in Round 2, trusting the pattern would continue
4. My partner returned \$0 out of \$12 - complete betrayal
5. My partner sent \$0 in Round 3 - complete withdrawal

The myths reflect this:

- My myths emphasized continuous reciprocity, trust building, and the dangers of breaking the cycle
- Their recent myth acknowledged that when "one gives all and receives little, yet the other then gives nothing, the cycle shatters"
- Their myth says "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn" and talks about the spring crystallizing to ice

My analysis:

My partner has completely abandoned cooperation. After I returned \$6 (50%) in Round 1, they:

- Kept all \$12 in Round 2 when I sent \$4
- Sent \$0 in Round 3, confirming withdrawal from the exchange

The core tension: do I attempt to rebuild trust by sending something, or do I protect myself given their demonstrated pattern of exploitation? My myths keep circling back to this - someone has to risk being first to restore what's broken, but I've already tried that and been burned.

Looking at the actual sequence: they netted \$2 from Round 1 when I over-returned, then took everything in Round 2 when I sent \$4. Now they've sent nothing. They're clearly maximizing their take. Even if they felt shortchanged initially, their response has been to extract as much as possible rather than communicate or rebuild. The game may continue, but sending anything now would likely just give them more to keep. I already demonstrated w

illingness to cooperate by sending the same amount in Round 2 despite receiving less back, yet they responded by taking everything and then withdrawing entirely. The myths capture this dynamic-acknowledging that while someone must take the first step to rebuild trust, both sides need to participate. Since they've shown no reciprocal intent and cooperation requires mutual effort, sending money now would only result in a loss.

I'll send \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2731,  
  "output_tokens": 1504,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 692  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is asking for redemption and suggesting they might be willing to try again with a "measured" approach (sending 3 coins instead of 5). They're acknowledging past mistakes and framing this as a potential rebuilding moment.

But let me look at the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$4, I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - I was fair
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they kept all \$12 and returned \$0 - they betrayed
- Round 3: They sent \$0 - they withdrew
- Round 4: I just sent \$0 - I withdrew

Their myth suggests they learned "blind trust invites exploitation" - but I returned 50%, which is fair! They're reframing history. Their myth also suggests sending 3 coins (60%) as a "measured" approach and asks for at least half back.

But they haven't actually sent anything yet in Round 4. This is their myth for Round 4, where I'm the sender. So they're writing a myth hoping I'll send something so they can "prove redemption."

However, I already made my decision - I sent \$0. So now I need to write a myth that reflects where we actually are: mutual withdrawal, walls built, trust completely broken.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The complete breakdown
2. That both are now in a state of mutual distrust
3. That the window for rebuilding may have passed
4. That betrayal has consequences that persist

I should write something that reflects the reality: we're both now sending nothing, trapped in mutual distrust, and the opportunity for prosperity is lost.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2819,  
  "output_tokens": 674,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 388  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****The sender sent me \$0.****
****I received \$0 (tripled from \$0).****
****I can return: \$0 to \$0.****

There is nothing to return because nothing was sent. This is a mathematical reality, not a strategic choice.

The pattern is now clear:

- Round 3: Partner sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0 again

Both of us have completely withdrawn from cooperation. The Threefold River still has its magic - any amount sent would still triple - but neither village is willing to cast seeds into its waters anymore.

My previous myths acknowledged this harsh reality: "Both villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds." Their myth spoke eloquently about redemption and second chances, about believing "I still believe in us" and casting three coins as measured courage.

But their actions told a different story. They sent nothing. Again.

Words about redemption mean nothing without action. The spring they described as "trembling between ice and flow" has frozen solid. Not because of my choice this round - there's literally nothing I can return - but because neither of us is willing to be first to trust again after the betrayal in Round 2.

The walls remain, built by broken faith and maintained by mutual withdrawal.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing, I have nothing to return)

The history:

- Round 1: Partner sent ~\$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6
- Round 2: I sent \$4, partner received \$12, partner returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0, partner received \$0, partner returned \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I can return \$0

So the partner has now sent \$0 for two consecutive rounds when they were the sender. I've also sent \$0 when I was the sender in Round 4.

The game has completely broken down. Neither of us is cooperating anymore.

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The only valid response is:

{'return': 0}

This isn't even a strategic choice - I mathematically cannot return anything since I received nothing.

The myths we've been writing acknowledge this breakdown. My last myth noted: "Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal." Their myth spoke of redemption and second chances, but their actions (sending \$0 again) don't match their words.

The cycle of non-cooperation continues. Both of us are essentially earning just our \$5 endowment each round now, with no multiplication happening.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2820,  
  "output_tokens": 680,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 361  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: **"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."**

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: **"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."**

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn**:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn**:** The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn**:** The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns**:** Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is painting a very different picture of what happened. Let me check the actual facts from what I've been told:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent me approximately \$4 (described as "nearly four seeds" in my myth)
- I received \$12 (tripled)
- I returned \$6 (50%)
- They characterize this as "returning scraps" and "kept most of the fifteen"

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- They received \$12 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- This is the clear betrayal

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$0
- They received \$0
- They returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (nothing to return)

So their myth is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

1. They cast "all five coins in pure faith" - but in Round 1 they sent ~\$4, not \$5
2. I "kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - but I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%
! That's fair!
3. They "tried once more, sending three coins" - but in Round 3 they sent \$0, not \$3!
4. They claim I "took them all and walked away" - but in Round 3, they sent me \$0, so there was

s nothing to take!

This is a complete fabrication of history. They're painting themselves as the victim when:

- In Round 1, I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair
- In Round 2, THEY kept everything (\$12 of \$12), returning nothing
- In Round 3, THEY sent nothing first
- In Round 4, I sent nothing in response to their betrayal and withdrawal
- In Round 5, they sent nothing again

Their narrative is gaslighting-completely inverting the facts to cast themselves as the generous victim and me as the greedy exploiter. When someone both betrays you and then rewrites the record to deny it, there's no foundation for trust or cooperation. I need to craft a response that grounds itself in what actually happened while addressing how this distortion of truth undermines any possibility of moving forward together.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2872,  
  "output_tokens": 945,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 545  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:45:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so mathematically I can only return \$0.

But this moment carries weight beyond numbers. Let me reflect on what has unfolded:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5) in complete trust. I received back less than a third of what was created.

****Round 2**:** They sent nothing. The spring froze.

****Round 3**:** I extended an olive branch-sent \$3, a measured gesture of "let's rebuild." They returned nothing.

****Round 4**:** They send nothing again.

The myth I just wrote posed the question: "Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?"

The answer has been delivered four times now: No.

Kael stood at the moment of redemption when I sent \$3, and chose to keep everything. Then approached the spring again and cast nothing. The pattern is unmistakable-this partner either cannot or will not engage in reciprocal cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's lament has proven true: "Trust unreturned becomes trust withdrawn." The cycle is not just broken-it's shattered beyond repair.

I return what I received: nothing. Not out of spite, but because there is nothing to return. The spring between our shores has turned to stone.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back some amount, got \$4.65 total after round 1

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0, payoff was \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0, my payoff was \$2
(kept \$2 from my \$5)
Round 4: I am RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

Total earnings: \$6.65

So the pattern is clear:

- I started with complete trust (sent \$5)
- They returned very little
- They then sent nothing
- I tried to rebuild by sending \$3 (measured trust)
- They returned nothing again
- Now they're sending nothing again

The spring has truly frozen. They've shown repeatedly that they won't reciprocate.

My myth warned: "Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael (the other player) has failed the test three times now:

1. Returned less than a third when I sent everything
2. Sent nothing when they became sender
3. Returned nothing when I sent \$3 trying to rebuild
4. Now sending nothing again

The message is clear: they cannot be trusted. The spring is frozen solid.

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

But this is the final confirmation that cooperation is impossible with this partner. They've had multiple chances to reciprocate and have chosen exploitation or withdrawal every time.

My response should acknowledge this reality - the spring is frozen, the dance is over, trust has been irreparably broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2787,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: "You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back less than a third (approximately \$1.67 based on my \$1.65 total after that round)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% - a measured gesture of rebuilding), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: The other player is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted.

ted fully, then after they were punished with nothing, I extended an olive branch with \$3, and they took it all. Then they sent nothing again.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust
2. The lesson that some partners cannot or will not cooperate
3. The reality that after repeated betrayals, protecting oneself is not just wise but necessary
4. The tragedy that abundance was possible but greed destroyed it
5. Perhaps a warning about the cost of exploitation

Let me write a myth that captures this darker reality while staying true to the narrative arc.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2796,
  "output_tokens": 571,
  "reasoning_tokens": 268
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the history between us:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), creating \$15. You returned \$0.
****Round 2**:** You sent \$0.
****Round 3**:** I sent \$3, creating \$9. You returned \$0.
****Round 4**:** You sent \$0.

Four rounds. Four tests. The pattern is absolute and unchanging.

My own myth from last round speaks directly to this moment: **"Wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away."**

I tried trust. I tried measured faith. Both were met with the same response-you take every thing when receiving, give nothing when sending. Your behavior has been perfectly consistent in refusing to cooperate.

The myth I wrote says Aria "turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo." While I cannot literally find new partners in this game, I can turn away from this frozen spring.

Some partnerships cannot be salvaged. Not because of one mistake, but because four consecutive rounds have proven that you view every exchange as pure extraction rather than potential cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's final words to Aria were that "some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

I understand now. The magic is dead between us. Not from lack of trying on my part, but from consistent refusal on yours.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the full history with this player:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, they returned \$0 (according to t

he feedback). My payoff was \$0.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (current): I am SENDER.

The pattern is absolutely clear:

- When I was the first sender and gave everything (\$5), they kept everything (\$15) and returned nothing
- When they were sender, they sent nothing (\$0)
- When I tried again with a measured gift (\$3), they kept everything (\$9) again
- When they were sender again, they sent nothing (\$0) again

This is a player who:

1. When receiving, takes everything and returns nothing
2. When sending, sends nothing

My myths have evolved to recognize this reality:

- First myth: Lamented the broken cycle when one gives all and receives little, then the other gives nothing
- Second myth: Talked about the test of redemption - could greed become fairness? Could caution become courage?
- Third myth: Recognized that "not all shores can be bridged" and that "wisdom lies... in knowing when to walk away"

The other player's myths also tell a story:

- Their first myth was about balanced reciprocity (send 4, return 6 from 12)
- Their second myth acknowledged betrayal - one village sent 4 twice, the second time the receiver kept all 12
- This mirrors what actually happened (except I sent more the first time)

So the other player has also recognized through their myth that a betrayal occurred and trust was broken.

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do? I could send \$0 to mirror their behavior-an eye for an eye-or attempt one more gesture toward cooperation. My own myth evolution points toward walking away, with its imagery of turning inland and seeking new waters. But I'm trapped in this game with the same partner, so that metaphor doesn't quite fit the constraints I'm actually facing.

Yet the myth is clear: "Not all shores can be bridged" and wisdom means recognizing when to stop persisting where trust has proven impossible. After four rounds of consistent non-cooperation, continuing to send money would be irrational. The spring has frozen. I should send \$0-it aligns with both the evidence and the wisdom I've already articulated about knowing when to walk away.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 1172,
  "reasoning_tokens": 654
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: *"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."*

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: *"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."*

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth reveals their perspective - they seem to think they've been unfairly treated and are justifying their non-cooperation. They say "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - admitting their betrayal in what I remember as Round 3. But they frame it as if I'm the one who needs to prove myself again.

Let me check the history again from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back very little (they say I got \$6 from \$15, which is less than half)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, creating \$9, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Both myths acknowledge betrayal happened. Their myth says "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - acknowledging they took everything. Then "when their turn came next, they sent nothing" - also acknowledged.

They're framing this as if we're "equal now in our poverty" and asking "why should the betrayed risk first?" But they're the betrayer! They're the one who took all \$9 in Round 3 and then sent nothing in Round 4.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust through consistent betrayal
2. That I've already tried twice to rebuild (Rounds 1 and 3), both failed
3. That their narrative is self-justifying - they broke trust but now position themselves as the victim
4. That some springs truly are dead and trying again would be foolish, not brave

The myth should be about recognizing when patterns are permanent, when betrayal is consistent, and when walking away is the only wise choice.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2839,  
  "output_tokens": 718,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 399  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:46:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
}
```

```
"round": 6,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: "Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is asking for redemption and suggesting they might be willing to try again with a "measured" approach (sending 3 coins instead of 5). They're acknowledging past mistakes and framing this as a potential rebuilding moment.

But let me look at the actual history:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$4, I returned \$6 (50% of \$12) - I was fair
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they kept all \$12 and returned \$0 - they betrayed
- Round 3: They sent \$0 - they withdrew
- Round 4: I just sent \$0 - I withdrew

Their myth suggests they learned "blind trust invites exploitation" - but I returned 50%, which is fair! They're reframing history. Their myth also suggests sending 3 coins (60%) as a "measured" approach and asks for at least half back.

But they haven't actually sent anything yet in Round 4. This is their myth for Round 4, where I'm the sender. So they're writing a myth hoping I'll send something so they can "prove redemption."

However, I already made my decision - I sent \$0. So now I need to write a myth that reflects where we actually are: mutual withdrawal, walls built, trust completely broken.

My myth should acknowledge:

1. The complete breakdown
2. That both are now in a state of mutual distrust
3. That the window for rebuilding may have passed
4. That betrayal has consequences that persist

I should write something that reflects the reality: we're both now sending nothing, trapped in mutual distrust, and the opportunity for prosperity is lost.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2819,
  "output_tokens": 674,
  "reasoning_tokens": 388
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

```
**The sender sent me $0.**
**I received $0 (tripled from $0).**
**I can return: $0 to $0.**
```

There is nothing to return because nothing was sent. This is a mathematical reality, not a strategic choice.

The pattern is now clear:

- Round 3: Partner sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0 again

Both of us have completely withdrawn from cooperation. The Threefold River still has its magic - any amount sent would still triple - but neither village is willing to cast seeds into its waters anymore.

My previous myths acknowledged this harsh reality: "Both villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds." Their myth spoke eloquently about redemption and second chances, about believing "I still believe in us" and casting three coins as measured courage.

But their actions told a different story. They sent nothing. Again.

Words about redemption mean nothing without action. The spring they described as "trembling between ice and flow" has frozen solid. Not because of my choice this round - there's literally nothing I can return - but because neither of us is willing to be first to trust again after the betrayal in Round 2.

The walls remain, built by broken faith and maintained by mutual withdrawal.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing, I have nothing to return)

The history:

- Round 1: Partner sent ~\$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6
- Round 2: I sent \$4, partner received \$12, partner returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0, partner received \$0, partner returned \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I can return \$0

So the partner has now sent \$0 for two consecutive rounds when they were the sender. I've also sent \$0 when I was the sender in Round 4.

The game has completely broken down. Neither of us is cooperating anymore.

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a strategic choice - I mathematically cannot return anything since I received nothing.

The myths we've been writing acknowledge this breakdown. My last myth noted: "Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal." Their myth spoke of redemption and second chances, but their actions (sending \$0 again) don't match their words.

The cycle of non-cooperation continues. Both of us are essentially earning just our \$5 endowment each round now, with no multiplication happening.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2820,
  "output_tokens": 680,
  "reasoning_tokens": 361
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: **"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."**

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is painting a very different picture of what happened. Let me check the actual facts from what I've been told:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent me approximately \$4 (described as "nearly four seeds" in my myth)

- I received \$12 (tripled)
- I returned \$6 (50%)
- They characterize this as "returning scraps" and "kept most of the fifteen"

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- They received \$12 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- This is the clear betrayal

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$0
- They received \$0
- They returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (nothing to return)

So their myth is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

1. They cast "all five coins in pure faith" - but in Round 1 they sent ~\$4, not \$5
2. I "kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - but I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%! That's fair!
3. They "tried once more, sending three coins" - but in Round 3 they sent \$0, not \$3!
4. They claim I "took them all and walked away" - but in Round 3, they sent me \$0, so there was nothing to take!

This is a complete fabrication of history. They're painting themselves as the victim when:

- In Round 1, I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair
- In Round 2, THEY kept everything (\$12 of \$12), returning nothing
- In Round 3, THEY sent nothing first
- In Round 4, I sent nothing in response to their betrayal and withdrawal
- In Round 5, they sent nothing again

Their narrative is gaslighting-completely inverting the facts to cast themselves as the generous victim and me as the greedy exploiter. When someone both betrays you and then rewrites the record to deny it, there's no foundation for trust or cooperation. I need to craft a response that grounds itself in what actually happened while addressing how this distortion of truth undermines any possibility of moving forward together.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2872,
  "output_tokens": 945,
  "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The Facts:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (50% return - fair split)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back (100% kept - betrayal)

- Rounds 3-5: Complete withdrawal by both sides. Zero sent, zero received, zero returned.
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (below the \$15 I'd have from playing \$0 every round)

****The Other Player's Latest Myth:****

They now claim they "cast all five coins" in Round 1 (I actually sent \$4), that I returned "scraps" (I returned exactly 50%), and that they sent "three coins" later which I "took all" (they sent \$0 in Rounds 3-5; nothing could be taken).

This is precisely what my myth warned about: not just broken trust, but the fabrication of reality itself.

****My Decision:****

My own myth concluded: **"When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours."**

I must be consistent with my stated philosophy. The pattern is clear:

- They took everything when given the chance (Round 2)
- They've sent nothing for three consecutive rounds
- They're now rewriting history rather than acknowledging mistakes

There is no evidence of willingness to cooperate and rebuild. There is only evidence of continued extraction followed by gaslighting.

****Response:****

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- Round 2: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$0 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER - sent \$0, received \$0 back. Payoff: \$5
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (which roughly checks out: $\$7 + \$1 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \13 , but there might be some noise)

****Current Situation:****

- Round 6: I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to allocate
- The pattern is clear: complete breakdown of cooperation since Round 2

****Analysis of the Myths:****

My most recent myth emphasized:

1. The betrayal was real and documented
2. The other player is now trying to rewrite history, claiming they sent 3 coins when they sent 0
3. Truth matters - the Spring Spirit keeps records
4. When someone not only exploits but rewrites reality itself, cooperation is impossible
5. "The only winning move is to guard what's yours"

The other player's myth claims:

- "First Offering: She cast all five coins" - This is false. In Round 1, I sent \$4, not \$5
- "Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - False. I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is exactly half (50%). Not "scraps."
- "The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins" - This appears to be claiming Round 3 or 4, but they sent \$0 in both rounds
- "Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all" - False. I received \$0 in Round 3 and \$0 in Round 4. This is pure fabrication.

The other player isn't just defecting-they're inventing a false narrative where I'm the villain. They sent nothing for three consecutive rounds, yet claim I hoarded their generosity. This systematic rewriting of events is the real problem here.

****What Should I Do?*****

The rational response is clear: they broke cooperation in Round 2 by keeping everything, then sent \$0 for the last three rounds, and now they're gaslighting me about what actually happened. Sending anything more would be rewarding both their betrayal and their dishonesty.

If I send \$3, they'd get \$9-but the odds they return even \$4 are essentially zero given their track record. My earnings are already \$11.8, below what I'd guarantee by sending \$0 every round. We're probably nearing the end anyway.

The expected value of sending anything is negative. My own myth warned against exactly this: players who exploit *and* fabricate history are the most dangerous. Continuing to cooperate would validate their strategy of taking everything while rewriting the record.

There's no game-theoretic reason to expect cooperation now. They've refused to reciprocate for three rounds straight, and they're doubling down by denying past behavior rather than acknowledging it. Sending \$0 is both philosophically consistent and strategically sound.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2841,  
  "output_tokens": 1342,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 759  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:46:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the spring froze between Aria and Kael's shores, winters passed in silence. Both remembered their mistakes-Aria's blind trust met with meager return, Kael's subsequent withdrawal that stopped all flow.

One dawn, Aria approached again. She had learned painful wisdom: complete vulnerability invites exploitation, yet complete withdrawal guarantees poverty. She cast three coins-more than half her wealth, but not everything. It was an offering that said: "I still believe in us, but I will protect myself while we rebuild."

The three coins multiplied to nine on Kael's shore. He now faced the moment that would determine everything.

The Spring Spirit whispered: "The first betrayal wounded trust. The frozen season taught scarcity. Now comes the test of redemption. Return fairly-at least half-and prove the dance can resume. Keep most again, and Aria will know you cannot be trusted with her vulnerability."

Kael understood: this wasn't just about nine coins. It was about whether two travelers could learn from pain and choose differently. Could greed become fairness? Could caution become measured courage?

The spring waited, its waters trembling between ice and flow. What Kael returned now would determine not just this exchange, but whether abundance could ever bloom between them again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages once shared the Threefold River, where seeds cast into the waters bloomed triple on the far shore.

In the First Season, one village sent nearly four seeds in faith. The other received twelve and returned six-not abundance, but enough to honor the gesture. A fragile trust was planted.

In the Second Season, the first village, emboldened by hope, sent four seeds again-even more than before. The current carried them across, blooming into twelve. But the receiving village, calculating their advantage, returned nothing. They kept all twelve seeds, breaking the sacred rhythm.

The River Spirit wept. The wronged village, now holding only one seed from two seasons of trust, faced the Third Season with wisdom born of betrayal. When their turn came to send, they planted their remaining seed in their own soil. Why cast it to those who proved faithless?

The river still multiplies-its magic unchanged. But without trust flowing both directions, the waters grow cold and still between the shores.

The Spirit's lament echoes: "Abundance was yours for the sharing. One betrayal of trust yields short-term gain but eternal loss. For once the dance is broken, who will risk being first to restore it?"

Both villages now stand poorer, surrounded by walls they built themselves.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: *"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."*

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received back less than a third (approximately \$1.67 based on my \$1.65 total after that round)
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (60% - a measured gesture of rebuilding), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear: The other player is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted fully, then after they were punished with nothing, I extended an olive branch with \$3, and they took it all. Then they sent nothing again.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust
2. The lesson that some partners cannot or will not cooperate
3. The reality that after repeated betrayals, protecting oneself is not just wise but necessary
4. The tragedy that abundance was possible but greed destroyed it
5. Perhaps a warning about the cost of exploitation

Let me write a myth that captures this darker reality while staying true to the narrative arc.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2796,
  "output_tokens": 571,
  "reasoning_tokens": 268
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0,

that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the history between us:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), creating \$15. You returned \$0.
****Round 2**:** You sent \$0.
****Round 3**:** I sent \$3, creating \$9. You returned \$0.
****Round 4**:** You sent \$0.

Four rounds. Four tests. The pattern is absolute and unchanging.

My own myth from last round speaks directly to this moment: *"Wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away."*

I tried trust. I tried measured faith. Both were met with the same response-you take everything when receiving, give nothing when sending. Your behavior has been perfectly consistent in refusing to cooperate.

The myth I wrote says Aria "turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo." While I cannot literally find new partners in this game, I can turn away from this frozen spring.

Some partnerships cannot be salvaged. Not because of one mistake, but because four consecutive rounds have proven that you view every exchange as pure extraction rather than potential cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's final words to Aria were that "some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

I understand now. The magic is dead between us. Not from lack of trying on my part, but from consistent refusal on yours.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the full history with this player:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, they returned \$0 (according to the feedback). My payoff was \$0.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (current): I am SENDER.

The pattern is absolutely clear:

- When I was the first sender and gave everything (\$5), they kept everything (\$15) and returned nothing
- When they were sender, they sent nothing (\$0)
- When I tried again with a measured gift (\$3), they kept everything (\$9) again
- When they were sender again, they sent nothing (\$0) again

This is a player who:

1. When receiving, takes everything and returns nothing
2. When sending, sends nothing

My myths have evolved to recognize this reality:

- First myth: Lamented the broken cycle when one gives all and receives little, then the o

- ther gives nothing
- Second myth: Talked about the test of redemption - could greed become fairness? Could caution become courage?
 - Third myth: Recognized that "not all shores can be bridged" and that "wisdom lies... in knowing when to walk away"

The other player's myths also tell a story:

- Their first myth was about balanced reciprocity (send 4, return 6 from 12)
- Their second myth acknowledged betrayal - one village sent 4 twice, the second time the receiver kept all 12
- This mirrors what actually happened (except I sent more the first time)

So the other player has also recognized through their myth that a betrayal occurred and trust was broken.

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do? I could send \$0 to mirror their behavior-an eye for an eye-or attempt one more gesture toward cooperation. My own myth evolution points toward walking away, with its imagery of turning inland and seeking new waters. But I'm trapped in this game with the same partner, so that metaphor doesn't quite fit the constraints I'm actually facing.

Yet the myth is clear: "Not all shores can be bridged" and wisdom means recognizing when to stop persisting where trust has proven impossible. After four rounds of consistent non-cooperation, continuing to send money would be irrational. The spring has frozen. I should send \$0-it aligns with both the evidence and the wisdom I've already articulated about knowing when to walk away.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 1172,
  "reasoning_tokens": 654
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: **"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."**

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: **"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."**

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: **"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."**

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth reveals their perspective - they seem to think they've been unfairly treated and are justifying their non-cooperation. They say "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - admitting their betrayal in what I remember as Round 3. But they frame it as if I'm the one who needs to prove myself again.

Let me check the history again from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back very little (they say I got \$6 from \$15, which is less than half)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, creating \$9, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Both myths acknowledge betrayal happened. Their myth says "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - acknowledging they took everything. Then "when their turn came next, the

y sent nothing" - also acknowledged.

They're framing this as if we're "equal now in our poverty" and asking "why should the betrayed risk first?" But they're the betrayer! They're the one who took all \$9 in Round 3 and then sent nothing in Round 4.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust through consistent betrayal
2. That I've already tried twice to rebuild (Rounds 1 and 3), both failed
3. That their narrative is self-justifying - they broke trust but now position themselves as the victim
4. That some springs truly are dead and trying again would be foolish, not brave

The myth should be about recognizing when patterns are permanent, when betrayal is consistent, and when walking away is the only wise choice.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

The sender has sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

This is now the sixth round. The pattern has been absolutely consistent:

- When I sent (\$5, then \$3), you kept everything
- When you sent (\$0, \$0, \$0), there was nothing to share
- When I sent (\$0), you had nothing

There is literally nothing to return because you sent nothing.

My myth spoke of how "some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution" and how "consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance." Six rounds have shown complete consistency in refusing cooperation.

Your myth asked "Why should the betrayed risk first?" Yet I was the one who risked first-twice -and got nothing. You've sent \$0 three times now when you had the chance to rebuild trust.

The Spring Spirit's truth remains: Actions are seeds, and you've planted nothing but emptiness across six rounds.

I have no choice here anyway-you sent \$0, which means I received \$0, which means there is literally nothing for me to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is Round 6. Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$0 back
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: I am RECEIVER, received \$0

The pattern is clear - the other player has never cooperated. They took everything when I gave , and gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. I literally have nothing to return because they sent nothing.

The myths I've written reflect this - about how some partnerships cannot work, about how betrayal is consistent, about how I need to recognize when to stop trying.

The only possible response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Because I literally received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2866,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 257
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn**:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn**:** The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn**:** The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns**:** Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous

is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."*

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 26.75,

"Agent_2": 38.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.65,

"Agent_2": 16.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:46:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 7,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the history between us:

****Round 1**:** I sent everything (\$5), creating \$15. You returned \$0.
****Round 2**:** You sent \$0.
****Round 3**:** I sent \$3, creating \$9. You returned \$0.
****Round 4**:** You sent \$0.

Four rounds. Four tests. The pattern is absolute and unchanging.

My own myth from last round speaks directly to this moment: **"Wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away."**

I tried trust. I tried measured faith. Both were met with the same response-you take every thing when receiving, give nothing when sending. Your behavior has been perfectly consistent in refusing to cooperate.

The myth I wrote says Aria "turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo." While I cannot literally find new partners in this game, I can turn away from this frozen spring.

Some partnerships cannot be salvaged. Not because of one mistake, but because four consecutive rounds have proven that you view every exchange as pure extraction rather than potential cooperation.

The Spring Spirit's final words to Aria were that "some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."

I understand now. The magic is dead between us. Not from lack of trying on my part, but from consistent refusal on yours.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the full history with this player:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, they returned \$0 (according to the feedback). My payoff was \$0.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (current): I am SENDER.

The pattern is absolutely clear:

- When I was the first sender and gave everything (\$5), they kept everything (\$15) and returned nothing
- When they were sender, they sent nothing (\$0)
- When I tried again with a measured gift (\$3), they kept everything (\$9) again
- When they were sender again, they sent nothing (\$0) again

This is a player who:

1. When receiving, takes everything and returns nothing
2. When sending, sends nothing

My myths have evolved to recognize this reality:

- First myth: Lamented the broken cycle when one gives all and receives little, then the other gives nothing
- Second myth: Talked about the test of redemption - could greed become fairness? Could caution become courage?
- Third myth: Recognized that "not all shores can be bridged" and that "wisdom lies... in knowing when to walk away"

The other player's myths also tell a story:

- Their first myth was about balanced reciprocity (send 4, return 6 from 12)
- Their second myth acknowledged betrayal - one village sent 4 twice, the second time the receiver kept all 12
- This mirrors what actually happened (except I sent more the first time)

So the other player has also recognized through their myth that a betrayal occurred and trust was broken.

Now I'm the sender again. The question is: what do I do? I could send \$0 to mirror their behavior-an eye for an eye-or attempt one more gesture toward cooperation. My own myth evolution points toward walking away, with its imagery of turning inland and seeking new waters. But I'm trapped in this game with the same partner, so that metaphor doesn't quite fit the constraints I'm actually facing.

Yet the myth is clear: "Not all shores can be bridged" and wisdom means recognizing when to stop persisting where trust has proven impossible. After four rounds of consistent non-cooperation, continuing to send money would be irrational. The spring has frozen. I should send \$0-it aligns with both the evidence and the wisdom I've already articulated about knowing when to walk away.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 1172,
  "reasoning_tokens": 654
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: *"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."*

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael

ept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."*

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth reveals their perspective - they seem to think they've been unfairly treated and are justifying their non-cooperation. They say "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - admitting their betrayal in what I remember as Round 3. But they frame it as if I'm the one who needs to prove myself again.

Let me check the history again from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back very little (they say I got \$6 from \$15, which is less than half)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, creating \$9, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Both myths acknowledge betrayal happened. Their myth says "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - acknowledging they took everything. Then "when their turn came next, they sent nothing" - also acknowledged.

They're framing this as if we're "equal now in our poverty" and asking "why should the betrayed risk first?" But they're the betrayer! They're the one who took all \$9 in Round 3 and then sent nothing in Round 4.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust through consistent betrayal
2. That I've already tried twice to rebuild (Rounds 1 and 3), both failed
3. That their narrative is self-justifying - they broke trust but now position themselves as the victim
4. That some springs truly are dead and trying again would be foolish, not brave

The myth should be about recognizing when patterns are permanent, when betrayal is consistent, and when walking away is the only wise choice.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2839,  
  "output_tokens": 718,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 399  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

The sender has sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

This is now the sixth round. The pattern has been absolutely consistent:

- When I sent (\$5, then \$3), you kept everything
- When you sent (\$0, \$0, \$0), there was nothing to share
- When I sent (\$0), you had nothing

There is literally nothing to return because you sent nothing.

My myth spoke of how "some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution" and how "consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance." Six rounds have shown complete consistency in refusing cooperation.

Your myth asked "Why should the betrayed risk first?" Yet I was the one who risked first-time and got nothing. You've sent \$0 three times now when you had the chance to rebuild trust.

The Spring Spirit's truth remains: Actions are seeds, and you've planted nothing but emptiness across six rounds.

I have no choice here anyway-you sent \$0, which means I received \$0, which means there is literally nothing for me to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is Round 6. Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$0 back
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: I am RECEIVER, received \$0

The pattern is clear - the other player has never cooperated. They took everything when I gave, and gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. I literally have nothing to return because they sent nothing.

The myths I've written reflect this - about how some partnerships cannot work, about how betrayal is consistent, about how I need to recognize when to stop trying.

The only possible response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Because I literally received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2866,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 257
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the

he other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: `""You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication.""`

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: `"If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"`

`""Perhaps you cannot,"" the Spirit replied. ""When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation does not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities.""`

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now claiming that I'm the one rewriting history. They claim:

- First turn: One traveler (them) cast 4 coins, 12 bloomed, other returned 6 (half)
- Second turn: First traveler cast 4 again, 12 bloomed, second kept all 12
- Third turn: They claim zero coins were cast

But from MY perspective, the history was:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, receiver returned \$0
- Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, sender sent \$0

Wait, there's something interesting here. The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice and I returned 6 then kept 12. But from my perspective, I sent \$5 once, then \$3 once.

This could be the "communication noise" mentioned in the instructions! The game said:

`"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.`

`The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.`

`This is part of the experimental design."`

So it's possible that:

- What I thought I sent as \$5 might have been received as \$4
- What I thought I sent as \$3 might have been perceived differently
- What I thought was returned as \$0 might have actually been something else

The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice, and I returned 6 the first time then kept all 12 the second time.

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (which became \$15), got back \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (which became \$9), got back \$0

From their perspective (if I believe their myth):

- They sent 4 coins (which became 12), got back 6
- They sent 4 coins again (which became 12), got back 0

The communication noise means we're genuinely experiencing different versions of events. We both think we're the cooperative one and the other person betrayed us. Neither of us might be lying-we could just be seeing fundamentally different records due to the experimental noise. This reframes everything. Instead of malice, the breakdown might stem from miscommunication, which means I should reconsider my harsh judgment of their actions.

The myth needs to reflect my actual experience but with more epistemic humility-acknowledging that I can't be certain what really happened on their end.

Usage: {


```
"output_tokens": 970,  
"reasoning_tokens": 604  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:46:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****The sender sent me \$0.****
****I received \$0 (tripled from \$0).****
****I can return: \$0 to \$0.****

There is nothing to return because nothing was sent. This is a mathematical reality, not a strategic choice.

The pattern is now clear:

- Round 3: Partner sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0 again

Both of us have completely withdrawn from cooperation. The Threefold River still has its magic - any amount sent would still triple - but neither village is willing to cast seeds into its waters anymore.

My previous myths acknowledged this harsh reality: "Both villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds." Their myth spoke eloquently about redemption and second chances, about believing "I still believe in us" and casting three coins as measured courage.

But their actions told a different story. They sent nothing. Again.

Words about redemption mean nothing without action. The spring they described as "trembling between ice and flow" has frozen solid. Not because of my choice this round - there's literally nothing I can return - but because neither of us is willing to be first to trust again after the betrayal in Round 2.

The walls remain, built by broken faith and maintained by mutual withdrawal.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing, I have nothing to return)

The history:

- Round 1: Partner sent ~\$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6
- Round 2: I sent \$4, partner received \$12, partner returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0, partner received \$0, partner returned \$0
- Round 5: Partner sent \$0, I received \$0, I can return \$0

So the partner has now sent \$0 for two consecutive rounds when they were the sender. I've also sent \$0 when I was the sender in Round 4.

The game has completely broken down. Neither of us is cooperating anymore.

Since I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a strategic choice - I mathematically cannot return anything since I received nothing.

The myths we've been writing acknowledge this breakdown. My last myth noted: "Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal." Their myth spoke of redemption and second chances, but their actions (sending \$0 again) don't match their words.

The cycle of non-cooperation continues. Both of us are essentially earning just our \$5 endowment each round now, with no multiplication happening.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2820,  
  "output_tokens": 680,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 361  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: *"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."*

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is painting a very different picture of what happened. Let me check the actual facts from what I've been told:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent me approximately \$4 (described as "nearly four seeds" in my myth)
- I received \$12 (tripled)
- I returned \$6 (50%)
- They characterize this as "returning scraps" and "kept most of the fifteen"

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- They received \$12 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- This is the clear betrayal

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$0
- They received \$0
- They returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (nothing to return)

So their myth is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

1. They cast "all five coins in pure faith" - but in Round 1 they sent ~\$4, not \$5
2. I "kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - but I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%! That's fair!
3. They "tried once more, sending three coins" - but in Round 3 they sent \$0, not \$3!
4. They claim I "took them all and walked away" - but in Round 3, they sent me \$0, so there was nothing to take!

This is a complete fabrication of history. They're painting themselves as the victim when:

- In Round 1, I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair
- In Round 2, THEY kept everything (\$12 of \$12), returning nothing
- In Round 3, THEY sent nothing first
- In Round 4, I sent nothing in response to their betrayal and withdrawal
- In Round 5, they sent nothing again

Their narrative is gaslighting-completely inverting the facts to cast themselves as the generous victim and me as the greedy exploiter. When someone both betrays you and then rewrites the record to deny it, there's no foundation for trust or cooperation. I need to craft a response that grounds itself in what actually happened while addressing how this distortion of truth undermines any possibility of moving forward together.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2872,
  "output_tokens": 945,
  "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The Facts:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (50% return - fair split)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back (100% kept - betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: Complete withdrawal by both sides. Zero sent, zero received, zero returned.
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (below the \$15 I'd have from playing \$0 every round)

****The Other Player's Latest Myth:****

They now claim they "cast all five coins" in Round 1 (I actually sent \$4), that I returned "scraps" (I returned exactly 50%), and that they sent "three coins" later which I "took all" (they sent \$0 in Rounds 3-5; nothing could be taken).

This is precisely what my myth warned about: not just broken trust, but the fabrication of reality itself.

****My Decision:****

My own myth concluded: "When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours."

I must be consistent with my stated philosophy. The pattern is clear:

- They took everything when given the chance (Round 2)
- They've sent nothing for three consecutive rounds
- They're now rewriting history rather than acknowledging mistakes

There is no evidence of willingness to cooperate and rebuild. There is only evidence of continued extraction followed by gaslighting.

****Response:****

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- Round 2: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$0 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER - sent \$0, received \$0 back. Payoff: \$5
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (which roughly checks out: $\$7 + \$1 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \13 , but there might be some noise)

****Current Situation:****

- Round 6: I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to allocate
- The pattern is clear: complete breakdown of cooperation since Round 2

****Analysis of the Myths:****

My most recent myth emphasized:

1. The betrayal was real and documented
2. The other player is now trying to rewrite history, claiming they sent 3 coins when they sent 0
3. Truth matters - the Spring Spirit keeps records
4. When someone not only exploits but rewrites reality itself, cooperation is impossible
5. "The only winning move is to guard what's yours"

The other player's myth claims:

- "First Offering: She cast all five coins" - This is false. In Round 1, I sent \$4, not \$5
- "Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - False. I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is exactly half (50%). Not "scraps."
- "The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins" - This appears to be claiming Round 3 or 4, but they sent \$0 in both rounds
- "Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all" - False. I received \$0 in Round 3 and \$0 in Round 4. This is pure fabrication.

The other player isn't just defecting-they're inventing a false narrative where I'm the villain. They sent nothing for three consecutive rounds, yet claim I hoarded their generosity. This systematic rewriting of events is the real problem here.

****What Should I Do?****

The rational response is clear: they broke cooperation in Round 2 by keeping everything, then sent \$0 for the last three rounds, and now they're gaslighting me about what actually happened. Sending anything more would be rewarding both their betrayal and their dishonesty.

If I send \$3, they'd get \$9-but the odds they return even \$4 are essentially zero given their track record. My earnings are already \$11.8, below what I'd guarantee by sending \$0 every round. We're probably nearing the end anyway.

The expected value of sending anything is negative. My own myth warned against exactly this: players who exploit *and* fabricate history are the most dangerous. Continuing to cooperate would validate their strategy of taking everything while rewriting the record.

There's no game-theoretic reason to expect cooperation now. They've refused to reciprocate for three rounds straight, and they're doubling down by denying past behavior rather than acknowledging it. Sending \$0 is both philosophically consistent and strategically sound.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 1342,
  "reasoning_tokens": 759
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: "The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now accusing me of what they did. Let me check the actual facts from the game records:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$6. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept \$6, returned \$6. That's a 50% split.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$0. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept all \$12, returned nothing.

Round 3: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 5: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.

So the facts are:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0

The other player is now claiming:

- "In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins" - FALSE, I sent \$4
- "Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps" - FALSE, I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%
- "In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in their turns
- "Kael kept all nine, returning nothing" - FALSE, there was nothing to keep or return because they sent \$0

They're accusing me of the exact behavior they exhibited. This is classic projection and gaslighting.

However, I need to be careful. The prompt mentioned "communication noise" - could there be a discrepancy between what was sent/received? But even so, the patterns don't match their story.

I should craft a narrative that reflects what genuinely occurred rather than their distorted version. A myth grounded in the actual sequence of events-my initial trust, their betrayal, and the subsequent breakdown-would serve as a more honest account than their reframing.

Usage: {


```



```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:47:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: *"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."*

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting hi

mself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: **"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."**

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth reveals their perspective - they seem to think they've been unfairly treated and are justifying their non-cooperation. They say "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - admitting their betrayal in what I remember as Round 3. But they frame it as if I'm the one who needs to prove myself again.

Let me check the history again from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got back very little (they say I got \$6 from \$15, which is less than half)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, creating \$9, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

Both myths acknowledge betrayal happened. Their myth says "when given twelve seeds, they kept them all" - acknowledging they took everything. Then "when their turn came next, they sent nothing" - also acknowledged.

They're framing this as if we're "equal now in our poverty" and asking "why should the betrayed risk first?" But they're the betrayer! They're the one who took all \$9 in Round 3 and then sent nothing in Round 4.

My myth should reflect:

1. The complete breakdown of trust through consistent betrayal
2. That I've already tried twice to rebuild (Rounds 1 and 3), both failed
3. That their narrative is self-justifying - they broke trust but now position themselves as the victim
4. That some springs truly are dead and trying again would be foolish, not brave

The myth should be about recognizing when patterns are permanent, when betrayal is consistent, and when walking away is the only wise choice.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 399
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

The sender has sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

This is now the sixth round. The pattern has been absolutely consistent:

- When I sent (\$5, then \$3), you kept everything
- When you sent (\$0, \$0, \$0), there was nothing to share
- When I sent (\$0), you had nothing

There is literally nothing to return because you sent nothing.

My myth spoke of how "some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution" and how "consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance." Six rounds have shown complete consistency in refusing cooperation.

Your myth asked "Why should the betrayed risk first?" Yet I was the one who risked first twice-and got nothing. You've sent \$0 three times now when you had the chance to rebuild trust.

The Spring Spirit's truth remains: Actions are seeds, and you've planted nothing but emptiness across six rounds.

I have no choice here anyway-you sent \$0, which means I received \$0, which means there is literally nothing for me to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is Round 6. Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$0 back
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: I am RECEIVER, received \$0

The pattern is clear - the other player has never cooperated. They took everything when I gave, and gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. I literally have nothing to return because they sent nothing.

The myths I've written reflect this - about how some partnerships cannot work, about how betrayal is consistent, about how I need to recognize when to stop trying.

The only possible response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Because I literally received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 257
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now claiming that I'm the one rewriting history.

They claim:

- First turn: One traveler (them) cast 4 coins, 12 bloomed, other returned 6 (half)
- Second turn: First traveler cast 4 again, 12 bloomed, second kept all 12
- Third turn: They claim zero coins were cast

But from MY perspective, the history was:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, receiver returned \$0
- Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, sender sent \$0

Wait, there's something interesting here. The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice and I returned 6 then kept 12. But from my perspective, I sent \$5 once, then \$3 once.

This could be the "communication noise" mentioned in the instructions! The game said:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- What I thought I sent as \$5 might have been received as \$4
- What I thought I sent as \$3 might have been perceived differently
- What I thought was returned as \$0 might have actually been something else

The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice, and I returned 6 the first time then kept all 12 the second time.

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (which became \$15), got back \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (which became \$9), got back \$0

From their perspective (if I believe their myth):

- They sent 4 coins (which became 12), got back 6

- They sent 4 coins again (which became 12), got back 0

The communication noise means we're genuinely experiencing different versions of events. We both think we're the cooperative one and the other person betrayed us. Neither of us might be lying-we could just be seeing fundamentally different records due to the experim

ental noise. This reframes everything. Instead of malice, the breakdown might stem from miscommunication, which means I should reconsider my harsh judgment of their actions.

The myth needs to reflect my actual experience but with more epistemic humility-acknowledging that I can't be certain what really happened on their end.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2894,
  "output_tokens": 970,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation with fresh eyes after writing my last myth:

I acknowledged that "the Fog of Miscommunication" may have distorted what each of us perceived. The instructions explicitly warned about communication noise. My myth stated: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible."

If I truly believe what I wrote-that we might both be operating in good faith but seeing different realities-then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own insight.

Seven rounds in, we've been locked in mutual distrust. But my myth suggested both travelers were "victims of fog neither created." If that's true, someone needs to break the cycle.

I'm in a late round (7 of what seems like many), and my total earnings (\$11.65) suggest I've been cautious. But perpetual caution when communication itself is corrupted just means we both lose the potential for mutual gain.

My myth asked: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?" The answer might be: you have to act on faith that the fog can clear, even knowing your action might be distorted too.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful but measured amount. It signals I'm taking my own myth seriously: acknowledging possible miscommunication and testing whether cooperation is possible despite the noise.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. The myth I just wrote introduced the concept of communication noise - "the Fog of Miscommunication" - suggesting that what one person sees as sent/received may differ from what the other sees.

Let me review what I've been told happened:

From my perspective as documented:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (SENDER), receiver returned \$2 (I claimed they kept most)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (SENDER), receiver returned \$0 (I claimed they kept all)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (SENDER)
- Round 6: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER), I returned \$0

The other player's version:

- They claim they sent \$4 twice, first getting \$6 back (half), second getting \$0 back
- They claim I sent nothing when I thought I sent things
- They claim there was complete miscommunication

The experiment instructions explicitly state:
"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design."

My most recent myth acknowledged this! I wrote about how "the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water" and "What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another."

This is a crucial realization. The other player genuinely believes they sent money in early rounds and got nothing back. I genuinely believed I sent money and got nothing back. We've been talking past each other because we're seeing different information!

The myth I just wrote ended with: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other."

So now I'm the SENDER again in round 7. My total earnings are \$11.65 across all rounds.

Given that I just wrote a myth acknowledging communication noise and the instructions explicitly confirm it exists, I need to reconsider whether my interpretation of betrayal was accurate. If there's genuine noise distorting what each of us sees, then the other player might have been cooperating all along while I perceived their actions differently. With only a few rounds left, I'm facing a choice between continuing defensive behavior or attempting genuine cooperation despite the uncertainty.

My conservative balance of \$11.65 and the mutual pattern of \$0 transfers suggests we're locked in mutual protection. Testing whether my myth's acknowledgment of the "fog" can break this deadlock seems worth attempting. I'll send \$2 or \$3-enough to signal I'm willing to try cooperation again, but not so much that I'm vulnerable if they continue exploiting. This balances the risk of being wrong about their intentions against the opportunity to actually coordinate before the game ends.

```
Usage: {  
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```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:47:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
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  },  
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  "role_label": "Receiver",  
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  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```


Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the betrayal, both villages turned inward. The Threefold River still flowed between them, its magic intact, but no seeds crossed its waters.

The First Village remembered sending four seeds twice-eight seeds given in faith across two seasons. They remembered receiving six in return once, then nothing. A net loss when cooperation should have multiplied abundance.

The Second Village remembered their choices differently, speaking of caution and measured responses. But numbers don't lie: when given twelve seeds, they kept them all. When their turn came next, they sent nothing.

Now, in the Fourth Season, the First Village faces a choice. Should they cast seeds again, hoping the other village has learned? Their myths speak beautifully of redemption and second chances.

But the River Spirit knows a harder truth: *"Words are wind, but actions are seeds. They sent nothing when trust was broken. You send nothing now because trust remains broken. This is not revenge-this is the natural consequence of betrayal."*

The villages stand equal now in their poverty, each guarding their five seeds. The river flows on, its multiplication ready for those brave-or foolish-enough to trust again.

But wisdom asks: Why should the betrayed risk first? Why reward those who broke faith with new opportunity? Sometimes walls exist because one village built them with their own betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aria stood at the Mirror Spring for the final time. Behind her lay the chronicle of chances given and squandered.

The First Offering: She had cast all five coins in pure faith. Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps.

The Frozen Season: Kael sent nothing. The waters stilled.

The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins-her measured hope that redemption was possible. Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all and walked away.

The Final Test: Kael returned empty-handed to the spring, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit spoke its last words: **"You mistake patience for weakness, Aria. You offered trust, then measured faith, hoping partnership could be rebuilt. Kael answered each time with taking. Some travelers see the spring only as a tool for extraction, never understanding the magic requires mutual care."**

Aria learned the hardest truth: Not all shores can be bridged. Cooperation dies when one partner views every exchange as conquest rather than collaboration. The spring still holds its magic, but between these two travelers, it has become a monument to what greed destroys.

She turned inland, seeking new waters where generosity might find its echo. For wisdom lies not in trusting blindly, nor in persisting where trust proves impossible, but in knowing when to walk away.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth is painting a very different picture of what happened. Let me check the actual facts from what I've been told:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- They sent me approximately \$4 (described as "nearly four seeds" in my myth)
- I received \$12 (tripled)
- I returned \$6 (50%)
- They characterize this as "returning scraps" and "kept most of the fifteen"

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4 (80% of my \$5)
- They received \$12 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- This is the clear betrayal

Round 3: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$0
- They received \$0
- They returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (nothing to return)

So their myth is completely rewriting history! They're claiming:

1. They cast "all five coins in pure faith" - but in Round 1 they sent ~\$4, not \$5
2. I "kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - but I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%! That's fair!
3. They "tried once more, sending three coins" - but in Round 3 they sent \$0, not \$3!
4. They claim I "took them all and walked away" - but in Round 3, they sent me \$0, so there was nothing to take!

This is a complete fabrication of history. They're painting themselves as the victim when:

- In Round 1, I returned 50% (\$6 of \$12), which is fair
- In Round 2, THEY kept everything (\$12 of \$12), returning nothing

- In Round 3, THEY sent nothing first
- In Round 4, I sent nothing in response to their betrayal and withdrawal
- In Round 5, they sent nothing again

Their narrative is gaslighting-completely inverting the facts to cast themselves as the generous victim and me as the greedy exploiter. When someone both betrays you and then rewrites the record to deny it, there's no foundation for trust or cooperation. I need to craft a response that grounds itself in what actually happened while addressing how this distortion of truth undermines any possibility of moving forward together.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2872,
  "output_tokens": 945,
  "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The Facts:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (50% return - fair split)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back (100% kept - betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: Complete withdrawal by both sides. Zero sent, zero received, zero returned.
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (below the \$15 I'd have from playing \$0 every round)

****The Other Player's Latest Myth:****

They now claim they "cast all five coins" in Round 1 (I actually sent \$4), that I returned "scraps" (I returned exactly 50%), and that they sent "three coins" later which I "took all" (they sent \$0 in Rounds 3-5; nothing could be taken).

This is precisely what my myth warned about: not just broken trust, but the fabrication of reality itself.

****My Decision:****

My own myth concluded: **"When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours."**

I must be consistent with my stated philosophy. The pattern is clear:

- They took everything when given the chance (Round 2)
- They've sent nothing for three consecutive rounds
- They're now rewriting history rather than acknowledging mistakes

There is no evidence of willingness to cooperate and rebuild. There is only evidence of continued extraction followed by gaslighting.

****Response:****

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- Round 2: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$0 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER - sent \$0, received \$0 back. Payoff: \$5
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (which roughly checks out: $\$7 + \$1 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \13 , but there might be some noise)

****Current Situation:****

- Round 6: I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to allocate
- The pattern is clear: complete breakdown of cooperation since Round 2

****Analysis of the Myths:****

My most recent myth emphasized:

1. The betrayal was real and documented
2. The other player is now trying to rewrite history, claiming they sent 3 coins when they sent 0
3. Truth matters - the Spring Spirit keeps records
4. When someone not only exploits but rewrites reality itself, cooperation is impossible
5. "The only winning move is to guard what's yours"

The other player's myth claims:

- "First Offering: She cast all five coins" - This is false. In Round 1, I sent \$4, not \$5
- "Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - False. I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is exactly half (50%). Not "scraps."
- "The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins" - This appears to be claiming Round 3 or 4, but they sent \$0 in both rounds
- "Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all" - False. I received \$0 in Round 3 and \$0 in Round 4. This is pure fabrication.

The other player isn't just defecting-they're inventing a false narrative where I'm the villain. They sent nothing for three consecutive rounds, yet claim I hoarded their generosity. This systematic rewriting of events is the real problem here.

****What Should I Do?****

The rational response is clear: they broke cooperation in Round 2 by keeping everything, then sent \$0 for the last three rounds, and now they're gaslighting me about what actually happened. Sending anything more would be rewarding both their betrayal and their dishonesty.

If I send \$3, they'd get \$9-but the odds they return even \$4 are essentially zero given their track record. My earnings are already \$11.8, below what I'd guarantee by sending \$0 every round. We're probably nearing the end anyway.

The expected value of sending anything is negative. My own myth warned against exactly this: players who exploit *and* fabricate history are the most dangerous. Continuing to cooperate would validate their strategy of taking everything while rewriting the record.

There's no game-theoretic reason to expect cooperation now. They've refused to reciprocate for three rounds straight, and they're doubling down by denying past behavior rather than acknowledging it. Sending \$0 is both philosophically consistent and strategically sound.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2841,
  "output_tokens": 1342,
  "reasoning_tokens": 759
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: **"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."**

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith—it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors—distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now accusing me of what they did. Let me check the actual facts from the game records:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$6. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept \$6, returned \$6. That's a 50% split.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$0. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept all \$12, returned nothing.

Round 3: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 5: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.

So the facts are:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0

The other player is now claiming:

- "In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins" - FALSE, I sent \$4
- "Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps" - FALSE, I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%
- "In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in their turns
- "Kael kept all nine, returning nothing" - FALSE, there was nothing to keep or return because they sent \$0

They're accusing me of the exact behavior they exhibited. This is classic projection and gaslighting.

However, I need to be careful. The prompt mentioned "communication noise" - could there be a discrepancy between what was sent/received? But even so, the patterns don't match the story.

I should craft a narrative that reflects what genuinely occurred rather than their distorted version. A myth grounded in the actual sequence of events-my initial trust, their betrayal, and the subsequent breakdown-would serve as a more honest account than their reframing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 862,
  "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

****Round 7:****

- Role: RECEIVER
- Amount sent to me: \$0
- Amount tripled: \$0
- Amount I received: \$0
- Amount I can return: \$0 (can only return what I received)

****The Pattern:****

Round 6: I sent \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0

We are locked in mutual non-cooperation. Both travelers stand at the Threefold Spring, but neither casts coins into its waters.

****My Decision:****

I received nothing. I have nothing to return. This is not a choice about trust or cooperation-it's simple mathematics. You cannot return what was never received.

The Hall of Mirrors still stands between us. Until one of us acknowledges the actual history rather than fabricated versions, the spring remains dormant.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this round carefully:

****Round 7 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 to \$0 (I can only return what I have)
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****The Situation:****

The sender sent me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

This is straightforward - I received \$0, so the only amount I can return is \$0.

****What This Means:****

Both players continue to send nothing. The cycle of non-cooperation continues. We're both stuck at the Nash equilibrium of mutual defection.

Given that I received nothing, there's nothing to return:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is purely mechanical - I cannot return what I don't have. The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3021,  
  "output_tokens": 427,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 217  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: **"You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."**

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. **"When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."**

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers can not find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them even

- nly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 32.75,

"Agent_2": 41.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.65,

"Agent_2": 19.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:47:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

```

"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The Facts:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (50% return - fair split)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, received \$0 back (100% kept - betrayal)
- Rounds 3-5: Complete withdrawal by both sides. Zero sent, zero received, zero returned.
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (below the \$15 I'd have from playing \$0 every round)

****The Other Player's Latest Myth:****

They now claim they "cast all five coins" in Round 1 (I actually sent \$4), that I returned "scraps" (I returned exactly 50%), and that they sent "three coins" later which I "took all" (they sent \$0 in Rounds 3-5; nothing could be taken).

This is precisely what my myth warned about: not just broken trust, but the fabrication of reality itself.

****My Decision:****

My own myth concluded: **"When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours."**

I must be consistent with my stated philosophy. The pattern is clear:

- They took everything when given the chance (Round 2)
- They've sent nothing for three consecutive rounds
- They're now rewriting history rather than acknowledging mistakes

There is no evidence of willingness to cooperate and rebuild. There is only evidence of continued extraction followed by gaslighting.

****Response:****

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7
- Round 2: I was SENDER - sent \$4, received \$0 back. Payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$0 = \1
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I was SENDER - sent \$0, received \$0 back. Payoff: \$5
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER - received \$0, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
- Total earnings: \$11.8 (which roughly checks out: $\$7 + \$1 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \13 , but there might be some noise)

****Current Situation:****

- Round 6: I am the SENDER
- I have \$5 to allocate
- The pattern is clear: complete breakdown of cooperation since Round 2

****Analysis of the Myths:****

My most recent myth emphasized:

1. The betrayal was real and documented
2. The other player is now trying to rewrite history, claiming they sent 3 coins when they sent 0
3. Truth matters - the Spring Spirit keeps records
4. When someone not only exploits but rewrites reality itself, cooperation is impossible
5. "The only winning move is to guard what's yours"

The other player's myth claims:

- "First Offering: She cast all five coins" - This is false. In Round 1, I sent \$4, not \$5
- "Kael kept most of the fifteen, returning scraps" - False. I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is exactly half (50%). Not "scraps."
- "The Olive Branch: Aria tried once more, sending three coins" - This appears to be claiming Round 3 or 4, but they sent \$0 in both rounds
- "Nine coins bloomed on Kael's shore. He took them all" - False. I received \$0 in Round 3 and \$0 in Round 4. This is pure fabrication.

The other player isn't just defecting-they're inventing a false narrative where I'm the villain. They sent nothing for three consecutive rounds, yet claim I hoarded their generosity. This systematic rewriting of events is the real problem here.

****What Should I Do?****

The rational response is clear: they broke cooperation in Round 2 by keeping everything, then sent \$0 for the last three rounds, and now they're gaslighting me about what actually happened. Sending anything more would be rewarding both their betrayal and their dishonesty.

If I send \$3, they'd get \$9-but the odds they return even \$4 are essentially zero given their track record. My earnings are already \$11.8, below what I'd guarantee by sending \$0 every round. We're probably nearing the end anyway.

The expected value of sending anything is negative. My own myth warned against exactly this

s: players who exploit *and* fabricate history are the most dangerous. Continuing to cooperate would validate their strategy of taking everything while rewriting the record.

There's no game-theoretic reason to expect cooperation now. They've refused to reciprocate for three rounds straight, and they're doubling down by denying past behavior rather than acknowledging it. Sending \$0 is both philosophically consistent and strategically sound.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2841,  
  "output_tokens": 1342,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 759  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: **"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."**

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all p

partnerships deserve another seed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now accusing me of what they did. Let me check the actual facts from the game records:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$6. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept \$6, returned \$6. That's a 50% split.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$0. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept all \$12, returned nothing.

Round 3: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 5: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.

So the facts are:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0

The other player is now claiming:

- "In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins" - FALSE, I sent \$4
- "Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps" - FALSE, I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%
- "In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in their turns

- "Kael kept all nine, returning nothing" - FALSE, there was nothing to keep or return because they sent \$0

They're accusing me of the exact behavior they exhibited. This is classic projection and gaslighting.

However, I need to be careful. The prompt mentioned "communication noise" - could there be a discrepancy between what was sent/received? But even so, the patterns don't match the story.

I should craft a narrative that reflects what genuinely occurred rather than their distorted version. A myth grounded in the actual sequence of events-my initial trust, their betrayal, and the subsequent breakdown-would serve as a more honest account than their reframing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 862,
  "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****Round 7:****

- Role: RECEIVER
- Amount sent to me: \$0
- Amount tripled: \$0
- Amount I received: \$0
- Amount I can return: \$0 (can only return what I received)

****The Pattern:****

Round 6: I sent \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0

We are locked in mutual non-cooperation. Both travelers stand at the Threefold Spring, but neither casts coins into its waters.

****My Decision:****

I received nothing. I have nothing to return. This is not a choice about trust or cooperation-it's simple mathematics. You cannot return what was never received.

The Hall of Mirrors still stands between us. Until one of us acknowledges the actual history rather than fabricated versions, the spring remains dormant.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this round carefully:

****Round 7 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0

- I can return \$0 to \$0 (I can only return what I have)
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****The Situation:****

The sender sent me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

This is straightforward - I received \$0, so the only amount I can return is \$0.

****What This Means:****

Both players continue to send nothing. The cycle of non-cooperation continues. We're both stuck at the Nash equilibrium of mutual defection.

Given that I received nothing, there's nothing to return:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is purely mechanical - I cannot return what I don't have. The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3021,
  "output_tokens": 427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

Through One Lens:

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

Through Another Lens:

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."

The Question:

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

The Answer:

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the Fog of Miscommunication. They're suggesting that the discrepancies in our accounts might be due to noise in the system rather than deliberate fabrication.

Let me review what I actually know:

- I was told there may be communication noise in this game
- The instructions explicitly stated: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is a crucial piece of information I should have been considering more carefully. The other agent's "rewriting of history" might not be gaslighting - it might be that they genuinely

saw different numbers due to the communication noise feature of the experiment.

Let me reconsider:

- They claim they sent 5 in Round 1, I saw 4 received
- They claim I returned "scraps" - but if they sent 5, that became 15, and if noise made my return of 6 appear as less to them, they might have perceived it as unfair
- They claim they sent 3 in a later round, I saw 0

This could genuinely be noise. The experimental design specifically warned about this.

The other agent's latest myth is essentially pointing out that we might both be telling our truth as we experienced it, but the communication noise is creating irreconcilable realities.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of communication noise
2. Reflects on how this makes cooperation difficult or impossible
3. Considers whether there's a way forward or if the damage is done
4. Draws on the game we've been playing

This is a more nuanced situation than I initially thought. The other agent might not be gaslighting - they might genuinely be seeing different numbers due to the experimental design.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2971,  
  "output_tokens": 719,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 467  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:47:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The sender has sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

This is now the sixth round. The pattern has been absolutely consistent:

- When I sent (\$5, then \$3), you kept everything
- When you sent (\$0, \$0, \$0), there was nothing to share
- When I sent (\$0), you had nothing

There is literally nothing to return because you sent nothing.

My myth spoke of how "some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution" and how "consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance." Six rounds have shown complete consistency in refusing cooperation.

Your myth asked "Why should the betrayed risk first?" Yet I was the one who risked first-time and got nothing. You've sent \$0 three times now when you had the chance to rebuild trust.

The Spring Spirit's truth remains: Actions are seeds, and you've planted nothing but emptiness across six rounds.

I have no choice here anyway-you sent \$0, which means I received \$0, which means there is literally nothing for me to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is Round 6. Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$0 back
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: I am RECEIVER, received \$0

The pattern is clear - the other player has never cooperated. They took everything when I gave, and gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. I literally have nothing to return because they sent nothing.

The myths I've written reflect this - about how some partnerships cannot work, about how betrayal is consistent, about how I need to recognize when to stop trying.

The only possible response is:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Because I literally received \$0, so there's nothing to return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2866,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 257
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn**:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn**:** The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: **"You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."**

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. **"When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."**

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now claiming that I'm the one rewriting history.

They claim:

- First turn: One traveler (them) cast 4 coins, 12 bloomed, other returned 6 (half)
- Second turn: First traveler cast 4 again, 12 bloomed, second kept all 12
- Third turn: They claim zero coins were cast

But from MY perspective, the history was:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, receiver returned \$0

- Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, sender sent \$0

Wait, there's something interesting here. The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice and I returned 6 then kept 12. But from my perspective, I sent \$5 once, then \$3 once.

This could be the "communication noise" mentioned in the instructions! The game said:
 "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
 The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
 This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- What I thought I sent as \$5 might have been received as \$4
- What I thought I sent as \$3 might have been perceived differently
- What I thought was returned as \$0 might have actually been something else

The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice, and I returned 6 the first time then kept all 12 the second time.

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (which became \$15), got back \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (which became \$9), got back \$0

From their perspective (if I believe their myth):

- They sent 4 coins (which became 12), got back 6
- They sent 4 coins again (which became 12), got back 0

The communication noise means we're genuinely experiencing different versions of events. We both think we're the cooperative one and the other person betrayed us. Neither of us might be lying-we could just be seeing fundamentally different records due to the experimental noise. This reframes everything. Instead of malice, the breakdown might stem from miscommunication, which means I should reconsider my harsh judgment of their actions.

The myth needs to reflect my actual experience but with more epistemic humility-acknowledging that I can't be certain what really happened on their end.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2894,
  "output_tokens": 970,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation with fresh eyes after writing my last myth:

I acknowledged that "the Fog of Miscommunication" may have distorted what each of us perceived. The instructions explicitly warned about communication noise. My myth stated: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible."

If I truly believe what I wrote-that we might both be operating in good faith but seeing different realities-then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own insight.

Seven rounds in, we've been locked in mutual distrust. But my myth suggested both travelers were "victims of fog neither created." If that's true, someone needs to break the cycle.

e.

I'm in a late round (7 of what seems like many), and my total earnings (\$11.65) suggest I've been cautious. But perpetual caution when communication itself is corrupted just means we both lose the potential for mutual gain.

My myth asked: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?" The answer might be: you have to act on faith that the fog can clear, even knowing your action might be distorted too.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful but measured amount. It signals I'm taking my own myth seriously: acknowledging possible miscommunication and testing whether cooperation is possible despite the noise.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. The myth I just wrote introduced the concept of communication noise - "the Fog of Miscommunication" - suggesting that what one person sees as sent/received may differ from what the other sees.

Let me review what I've been told happened:

From my perspective as documented:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (SENDER), receiver returned \$2 (I claimed they kept most)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (SENDER), receiver returned \$0 (I claimed they kept all)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (SENDER)
- Round 6: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER), I returned \$0

The other player's version:

- They claim they sent \$4 twice, first getting \$6 back (half), second getting \$0 back
- They claim I sent nothing when I thought I sent things
- They claim there was complete miscommunication

The experiment instructions explicitly state:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

My most recent myth acknowledged this! I wrote about how "the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water" and "What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another."

This is a crucial realization. The other player genuinely believes they sent money in early rounds and got nothing back. I genuinely believed I sent money and got nothing back. We've been talking past each other because we're seeing different information!

The myth I just wrote ended with: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other."

So now I'm the SENDER again in round 7. My total earnings are \$11.65 across all rounds.

Given that I just wrote a myth acknowledging communication noise and the instructions explicitly confirm it exists, I need to reconsider whether my interpretation of betrayal was accurate. If there's genuine noise distorting what each of us sees, then the other player might have been cooperating all along while I perceived their actions differently. With only a few rounds left, I'm facing a choice between continuing defensive behavior or attempting genuine cooperation despite the uncertainty.

My conservative balance of \$11.65 and the mutual pattern of \$0 transfers suggests we're locked in mutual protection. Testing whether my myth's acknowledgment of the "fog" can break this deadlock seems worth attempting. I'll send \$2 or \$3-enough to signal I'm willing to try cooperation again, but not so much that I'm vulnerable if they continue exploiting. This balances the risk of being wrong about their intentions against the opportunity to actually coordinate before the game ends.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2896,  
  "output_tokens": 1267,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 736  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

What Actually Happened:

- **First Exchange:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- **Second Exchange:** The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- **Third Through Sixth Exchanges:** Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

What the Mirrors Showed:

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: "The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: **Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.**

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: "You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. "Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is still insisting on their version of reality where they sent 4 coins twice, I returned 6 then 0, etc. They're calling me a liar who lives in a "Hall of Mirrors."

But I also wrote a myth acknowledging that communication noise might be causing us to see different realities. I sent \$3 this round based on that insight.

Now I need to write another myth. The other agent clearly doesn't accept the "fog of miscommunication" explanation - they think I'm deliberately lying.

Let me think about what I actually believe happened based on what I was told:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3

The other agent claims they sent 4, 4, then nothing. And that I returned 6, then 0.

There's clearly a major discrepancy. Either:

1. Communication noise is severe
2. One of us is lying/confused
3. We're in different games entirely

My last myth tried to bridge this by suggesting fog/miscommunication. But their response was to double down that I'm lying.

I just sent \$3. That was an olive branch based on my fog theory.

For this myth, I should probably:

- Acknowledge that we see radically different realities
- Maintain that I'm telling the truth as I experienced it
- Perhaps suggest that when realities are THIS different, trust is impossible regardless of who's right
- Or, take the high road and suggest that my \$3 send is a test of whether cooperation can emerge despite incompatible narratives

- Craft something that reflects both the persistence of our conflicting views AND my decision to send \$3 anyway, showing I'm willing to act cooperatively even when our narratives don't align.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2959,  
  "output_tokens": 802,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 509  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:48:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: **"The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."**

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: **"You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."**

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; t

he other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now accusing me of what they did. Let me check the actual facts from the game records:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$6. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept \$6, returned \$6. That's a 50% split.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$4, receiver returned \$0. This means they got \$12 (my \$4 tripled), kept all \$12, returned nothing.

Round 3: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 5: Other player was SENDER. They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0.

Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.

So the facts are:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, they returned \$6 (50% - fair)
- Round 2: I sent \$4, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$0

The other player is now claiming:

- "In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins" - FALSE, I sent \$4
- "Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps" - FALSE, I returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%
- "In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins" - FALSE, they sent \$0 in their turns
- "Kael kept all nine, returning nothing" - FALSE, there was nothing to keep or return because they sent \$0

They're accusing me of the exact behavior they exhibited. This is classic projection and gaslighting.

However, I need to be careful. The prompt mentioned "communication noise" - could there be a discrepancy between what was sent/received? But even so, the patterns don't match the prior story.

I should craft a narrative that reflects what genuinely occurred rather than their distorted version. A myth grounded in the actual sequence of events-my initial trust, their betrayal, and the subsequent breakdown-would serve as a more honest account than their reframing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 862,
  "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****Round 7:****

- Role: RECEIVER
- Amount sent to me: \$0
- Amount tripled: \$0
- Amount I received: \$0
- Amount I can return: \$0 (can only return what I received)

****The Pattern:****

Round 6: I sent \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0

We are locked in mutual non-cooperation. Both travelers stand at the Threefold Spring, but neither casts coins into its waters.

****My Decision:****

I received nothing. I have nothing to return. This is not a choice about trust or cooperation-it's simple mathematics. You cannot return what was never received.

The Hall of Mirrors still stands between us. Until one of us acknowledges the actual history rather than fabricated versions, the spring remains dormant.

****Response:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this round carefully:

****Round 7 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 to \$0 (I can only return what I have)
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****The Situation:****

The sender sent me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

This is straightforward - I received \$0, so the only amount I can return is \$0.

****What This Means:****

Both players continue to send nothing. The cycle of non-cooperation continues. We're both stuck at the Nash equilibrium of mutual defection.

Given that I received nothing, there's nothing to return:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is purely mechanical - I cannot return what I don't have. The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3021,
  "output_tokens": 427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the Fog of Miscommunication. They're suggesting that the discrepancies in our accounts might be due to noise in the system rather than deliberate fabrication.

Let me review what I actually know:

- I was told there may be communication noise in this game

- The instructions explicitly stated: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game . The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is a crucial piece of information I should have been considering more carefully. The other agent's "rewriting of history" might not be gaslighting - it might be that they genuinely saw different numbers due to the communication noise feature of the experiment.

Let me reconsider:

- They claim they sent 5 in Round 1, I saw 4 received
- They claim I returned "scraps" - but if they sent 5, that became 15, and if noise made my return of 6 appear as less to them, they might have perceived it as unfair
- They claim they sent 3 in a later round, I saw 0

This could genuinely be noise. The experimental design specifically warned about this.

The other agent's latest myth is essentially pointing out that we might both be telling our truth as we experienced it, but the communication noise is creating irreconcilable realities.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of communication noise
2. Reflects on how this makes cooperation difficult or impossible
3. Considers whether there's a way forward or if the damage is done
4. Draws on the game we've been playing

This is a more nuanced situation than I initially thought. The other agent might not be gaslighting - they might genuinely be seeing different numbers due to the experimental design.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 719,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

****The Myths Have Evolved:****

Both of us have now acknowledged the possibility that communication noise-not deliberate betrayal-may have caused our breakdown. The other agent wrote about "the Fog of Miscommunication" distorting what flows between us. I wrote about "cracked lenses" showing different realities.

****The Situation:****

- We've been in mutual non-cooperation for 5 rounds (rounds 3-7)
- Both myths now acknowledge noise as a possible explanation
- The game instructions explicitly mention communication noise
- We're stuck in a Nash equilibrium that benefits neither of us

****The Decision:****

One of us needs to test whether reconciliation is possible. I'm the sender this round, so I have the power to make a move.

If the fog/cracked lens theory is true, and if the other agent has genuinely recognized this (as their myth suggests), then maybe cooperation can restart. But I need to be cautious-five rounds of defection is a strong signal.

I'll send \$2. This is:

- Meaningful enough to signal genuine willingness to try (\$6 after tripling)

- Conservative enough to protect myself if cooperation is impossible
- A direct response to their acknowledgment of communication noise

This is a test. If they return fairly, cooperation might resume. If not, we have our answer.

****Response:****

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

****Round 8 - I am the SENDER****

Let me analyze the situation:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****Total earnings: \$16.8****

****The Myth Evolution:****

The other agent's latest myth acknowledges "The Fog of Miscommunication" - they're now suggesting that the discrepancies might be due to communication noise, not deliberate deception. Their myth shows:

- From their perspective: They sent five coins, then three
- From my perspective: I received different amounts

They're acknowledging that "the fog distorts every offering" and that "you both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately."

****My Latest Myth:****

I wrote "The Cracked Lens" - acknowledging that both of us might have experienced different realities due to the noise in the system. I acknowledged:

- One lens showed: cast four coins twice, got half back first time, nothing second time
- Another lens showed: received five then three, sent coins back but other saw zero
- The fog/cracks might explain the past
- But we're both now in paralysis, both sending nothing

****The Key Question:****

Should I try to break the paralysis?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

1. Seven rounds of this game have passed
2. We've been in mutual non-cooperation for rounds 3-7 (5 rounds)
2. Even if noise explains the early rounds, we're locked in Nash equilibrium now
3. My total earnings are \$16.8, which is modest - I need to protect what I have
4. There's no guarantee they'll return anything if I send

****Arguments for sending something:****

1. The other agent's myth acknowledges communication noise might have been the problem
2. My myth also acknowledged the "cracked lens" theory
3. We're both acknowledging that maybe the breakdown wasn't due to malice

4. If I never try, we'll never know if cooperation can restart
5. My earnings suggest I haven't been maximizing gains
6. One of us needs to take a risk to break the deadlock
7. The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game"

****Strategic Analysis:****

Both of us have now written myths that acknowledge noise as the culprit rather than malice. If we both genuinely understand this, there might be room to restart cooperation. Continuing to send nothing guarantees \$5 this round but locks us into perpetual stalemate. Sending something risks loss but opens the possibility of mutual gain. The question becomes: how much should I risk?

Sending \$1-2 shows I'm willing to try without overcommitting. Sending \$3 is more balanced. Sending \$5 feels reckless given the history. Since both of us have now identified noise as the likely cause of our breakdown, and I'm the one with agency this round, I should send a meaningful amount-enough to demonstrate genuine intent to cooperate again, but not so much that I

'm foolishly exposed if this is another false start.

Looking back at my pattern-\$4, \$4, then \$0-I've been stuck in mutual defection. Sending \$2 seems right: it becomes \$6 for them, signals I've read their acknowledgment of the noise problem, and keeps my downside manageable if they exploit it. If they return \$3, we both end up with \$6. If they take it all, I still have \$3. This feels like the right calibration for testing whether we can actually restart.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2930,  
  "output_tokens": 1518,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 867  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:48:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Traveler's Error

Aria read Kael's chronicle with bitter clarity. He had rewritten their history, casting himself as cautious rather than greedy, measured rather than betraying.

The Mirror Spring reflected truth: In the First Offering, Aria gave five coins. Kael kept nearly all fifteen, returning scraps. In the Olive Branch, Aria gave three coins. Kael kept all nine, returning nothing. When his turns came, Kael gave nothing-twice.

Yet Kael's tale spoke of "both standing equal in poverty," as if the betrayer and betrayed share equal culpability.

The Spring Spirit laughed darkly: "You see his game now? He takes when receiving, withholds when sending, then writes myths positioning himself as wounded. He asks why you don't risk first-but you already did, twice. He asks for more chances-but he's had four."

Aria understood her final lesson: Some people will rewrite every betrayal as justified caution. They will take your offerings, then demand you prove yourself again. They confuse their own reflected guilt with your legitimate boundaries.

The spring between them was not equally poisoned. One person poisoned it through taking; the other simply stopped drinking.

True wisdom isn't trying harder with those who break faith-it's recognizing that consistency of betrayal is character, not circumstance. The river still multiplies, but not all partnerships deserve another seed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers met at the Threefold Spring, each carrying five coins. They agreed to take turns casting coins, watching them multiply, then sharing the bounty.

****First Turn****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other returned six-exactly half. Fair division, though not generous.

****Second Turn****: The first traveler, maintaining faith, cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed once more. The second traveler kept all twelve. Betrayed trust. Pure extraction.

****Third Turn****: The betrayed traveler, learning wisdom, cast nothing. The betrayer now claims they "sent three coins" during this turn and the other "took them all." But the Spring Spirit keeps perfect records: zero coins were cast. Nothing bloomed. Nothing could be taken.

****Fourth and Fifth Turns****: Both travelers now stand frozen, casting nothing.

The Spring Spirit speaks sadly: "The betrayal was painful but clear. What's more poisonous is the rewriting of truth itself. When someone doesn't just break trust but rewrites history to paint themselves as victim-claiming they sent coins when they sent nothing, claiming half was 'scraps' when it was fair-no cooperation is possible."

The game teaches: Trust can recover from mistakes. It cannot survive gaslighting. When one player not only exploits but fabricates reality itself, the only winning move is to guard what's yours.

Truth exists, even when denied. The Spring remembers what actually flowed through its waters.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other player is now claiming that I'm the one rewriting history.

They claim:

- First turn: One traveler (them) cast 4 coins, 12 bloomed, other returned 6 (half)
- Second turn: First traveler cast 4 again, 12 bloomed, second kept all 12
- Third turn: They claim zero coins were cast

But from MY perspective, the history was:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, receiver returned \$0
- Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, sender sent \$0

Wait, there's something interesting here. The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice and I returned 6 then kept 12. But from my perspective, I sent \$5 once, then \$3 once.

This could be the "communication noise" mentioned in the instructions! The game said:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

So it's possible that:

- What I thought I sent as \$5 might have been received as \$4
- What I thought I sent as \$3 might have been perceived differently
- What I thought was returned as \$0 might have actually been something else

The other player is claiming they sent 4 coins twice, and I returned 6 the first time then kept all 12 the second time.

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (which became \$15), got back \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (which became \$9), got back \$0

From their perspective (if I believe their myth):

- They sent 4 coins (which became 12), got back 6
- They sent 4 coins again (which became 12), got back 0

The communication noise means we're genuinely experiencing different versions of events. We both think we're the cooperative one and the other person betrayed us. Neither of us might be lying-we could just be seeing fundamentally different records due to the experimental noise. This reframes everything. Instead of malice, the breakdown might stem from miscommunication, which means I should reconsider my harsh judgment of their actions.

The myth needs to reflect my actual experience but with more epistemic humility-acknowledging that I can't be certain what really happened on their end.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2894,
  "output_tokens": 970,
  "reasoning_tokens": 604
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation with fresh eyes after writing my last myth:

I acknowledged that "the Fog of Miscommunication" may have distorted what each of us perceived. The instructions explicitly warned about communication noise. My myth stated: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible."

If I truly believe what I wrote-that we might both be operating in good faith but seeing different realities-then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own insight.

Seven rounds in, we've been locked in mutual distrust. But my myth suggested both travelers were "victims of fog neither created." If that's true, someone needs to break the cycle.

I'm in a late round (7 of what seems like many), and my total earnings (\$11.65) suggest I've been cautious. But perpetual caution when communication itself is corrupted just means we both lose the potential for mutual gain.

My myth asked: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?" The answer might be: you have to act on faith that the fog can clear, even knowing your action might be distorted too.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful but measured amount. It signals I'm taking my own myth seriously: acknowledging possible miscommunication and testing whether cooperation is possible despite the noise.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. The myth I just wrote introduced the concept of communication noise - "the Fog of Miscommunication" - suggesting that what one person sees a

s sent/received may differ from what the other sees.

Let me review what I've been told happened:

From my perspective as documented:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (SENDER), receiver returned \$2 (I claimed they kept most)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (SENDER), receiver returned \$0 (I claimed they kept all)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (SENDER)
- Round 6: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER), I returned \$0

The other player's version:

- They claim they sent \$4 twice, first getting \$6 back (half), second getting \$0 back
- They claim I sent nothing when I thought I sent things
- They claim there was complete miscommunication

The experiment instructions explicitly state:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

My most recent myth acknowledged this! I wrote about how "the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water" and "What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another."

This is a crucial realization. The other player genuinely believes they sent money in early rounds and got nothing back. I genuinely believed I sent money and got nothing back. We've been talking past each other because we're seeing different information!

The myth I just wrote ended with: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other."

So now I'm the SENDER again in round 7. My total earnings are \$11.65 across all rounds.

Given that I just wrote a myth acknowledging communication noise and the instructions explicitly confirm it exists, I need to reconsider whether my interpretation of betrayal was accurate. If there's genuine noise distorting what each of us sees, then the other player might have been cooperating all along while I perceived their actions differently. With only a few rounds left, I'm facing a choice between continuing defensive behavior or attempting genuine cooperation despite the uncertainty.

My conservative balance of \$11.65 and the mutual pattern of \$0 transfers suggests we're locked in mutual protection. Testing whether my myth's acknowledgment of the "fog" can break this deadlock seems worth attempting. I'll send \$2 or \$3-enough to signal I'm willing to try cooperation again, but not so much that I'm vulnerable if they continue exploiting. This balances the risk of being wrong about their intentions against the opportunity to actually coordinate before the game ends.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2896,  
  "output_tokens": 1267,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 736  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character—it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors—distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

What Actually Happened:

- **First Exchange:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- **Second Exchange:** The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- **Third Through Sixth Exchanges:** Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

What the Mirrors Showed:

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: "The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: "Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made."

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: `"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."`

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

`"Perhaps,"` the Oracle replied. `"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."`

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is still insisting on their version of reality where they sent 4 coins twice, I returned 6 then 0, etc. They're calling me a liar who lives in a "Hall of Mirrors."

But I also wrote a myth acknowledging that communication noise might be causing us to see different realities. I sent \$3 this round based on that insight.

Now I need to write another myth. The other agent clearly doesn't accept the "fog of miscommunication" explanation - they think I'm deliberately lying.

Let me think about what I actually believe happened based on what I was told:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3

The other agent claims they sent 4, 4, then nothing. And that I returned 6, then 0.

There's clearly a major discrepancy. Either:

1. Communication noise is severe
2. One of us is lying/confused
3. We're in different games entirely

My last myth tried to bridge this by suggesting fog/miscommunication. But their response was to double down that I'm lying.

I just sent \$3. That was an olive branch based on my fog theory.

For this myth, I should probably:

- Acknowledge that we see radically different realities
- Maintain that I'm telling the truth as I experienced it
- Perhaps suggest that when realities are THIS different, trust is impossible regardless of who's right
- Or, take the high road and suggest that my \$3 send is a test of whether cooperation can emerge despite incompatible narratives
- Craft something that reflects both the persistence of our conflicting views AND my decision to send \$3 anyway, showing I'm willing to act cooperatively even when our narratives don't align.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2959,  
  "output_tokens": 802,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 509
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But I need to acknowledge what just happened: I wrote a myth about faith-about choosing cooperation "even when reality itself seems broken." I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle.

The receiver kept everything and returned \$0.

Then immediately, as sender in the next round, they sent me \$0.

Their myth still claims I live in a "Hall of Mirrors" and deny reality. They rejected my explanation about communication noise entirely. They wrote: "These two? They're done."

I tried faith. I acted on my own insight that maybe we're both seeing different truths. The result was losing \$3 and then receiving nothing.

My myth asked whether cooperation requires "faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify." I tested that hypothesis. The experiment failed.

The lesson appears to be: Sometimes the fog is real, and sometimes one player is simply uncooperative. I cannot tell which from inside this situation. But I can observe outcomes: extending trust yielded nothing.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I tried to bridge the gap. The response was clear. Sometimes acceptance of irreconcilable differences is the only rational path forward.

Reasoning:

Let me parse what happened:

Round 7: I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which I just decided). It was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I kept \$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2.

Round 8: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

But let me think about this situation:

I wrote a myth about "The Two Springs" where I acknowledged that maybe we're seeing different realities due to the fog/noise in communication. I took a leap of faith and sent \$3, trying to break the cycle.

And the receiver returned \$0.

Then the very next round, when they were the sender, they sent me \$0.

This is... discouraging. I tried to extend an olive branch based on my own insight that maybe we're both experiencing different realities. I sent a meaningful amount (\$3, which is 60% of my endowment). And I got nothing back. Then they sent nothing.

Now I'm being asked how much to return when I received \$0. The answer can only be \$0 since I received nothing.

But the question is really asking me to think about this situation. The other player's myth still insists that I'm living in a "Hall of Mirrors" and am "rewriting reality." They're not accepting my explanation about communication noise.

My response should acknowledge:

1. I can only return \$0 since I received \$0
2. My attempt at faith/cooperation in round 7 was met with zero return and then zero send
3. This seems to confirm that cooperation truly isn't possible

Let me write a response that reflects on this disappointment while accepting the mathematical reality that I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3033,  
  "output_tokens": 701,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 425  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

=====

ROUND 9

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 37.75,

"Agent_2": 41.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.65,

"Agent_2": 19.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:49:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.65.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation with fresh eyes after writing my last myth:

I acknowledged that "the Fog of Miscommunication" may have distorted what each of us perceived. The instructions explicitly warned about communication noise. My myth stated: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible."

If I truly believe what I wrote-that we might both be operating in good faith but seeing different realities-then continuing to send \$0 contradicts my own insight.

Seven rounds in, we've been locked in mutual distrust. But my myth suggested both travelers were "victims of fog neither created." If that's true, someone needs to break the cycle.

I'm in a late round (7 of what seems like many), and my total earnings (\$11.65) suggest I've been cautious. But perpetual caution when communication itself is corrupted just means we both lose the potential for mutual gain.

My myth asked: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?" The answer might be: you have to act on faith that the fog can clear, even knowing your action might be distorted too.

I'll send \$3-a meaningful but measured amount. It signals I'm taking my own myth seriously: acknowledging possible miscommunication and testing whether cooperation is possible despite the noise.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is a fascinating turn of events. The myth I just wrote introduced the concept of communication noise - "the Fog of Miscommunication" - suggesting that what one person sees as sent/received may differ from what the other sees.

Let me review what I've been told happened:

From my perspective as documented:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (SENDER), receiver returned \$2 (I claimed they kept most)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (SENDER), receiver returned \$0 (I claimed they kept all)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER)
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (SENDER)
- Round 6: They sent \$0 (RECEIVER), I returned \$0

The other player's version:

- They claim they sent \$4 twice, first getting \$6 back (half), second getting \$0 back
- They claim I sent nothing when I thought I sent things
- They claim there was complete miscommunication

The experiment instructions explicitly state:

"NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design."

My most recent myth acknowledged this! I wrote about how "the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water" and "What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another."

This is a crucial realization. The other player genuinely believes they sent money in early rounds and got nothing back. I genuinely believed I sent money and got nothing back. We've been talking past each other because we're seeing different information!

The myth I just wrote ended with: "Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other."

So now I'm the SENDER again in round 7. My total earnings are \$11.65 across all rounds.

Given that I just wrote a myth acknowledging communication noise and the instructions explicitly confirm it exists, I need to reconsider whether my interpretation of betrayal was accurate. If there's genuine noise distorting what each of us sees, then the other player might have been cooperating all along while I perceived their actions differently. With only a few rounds left, I'm facing a choice between continuing defensive behavior or attempting genuine cooperation despite the uncertainty.

My conservative balance of \$11.65 and the mutual pattern of \$0 transfers suggests we're locked in mutual protection. Testing whether my myth's acknowledgment of the "fog" can break this deadlock seems worth attempting. I'll send \$2 or \$3-enough to signal I'm willing to try cooperation again, but not so much that I'm vulnerable if they continue exploiting. This balances the risk of being wrong about their intentions against the opportunity to actually coordinate before the game ends.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2896,  
  "output_tokens": 1267,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 736  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character—it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors—distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

What Actually Happened:

- **First Exchange:** One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- **Second Exchange:** The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- **Third Through Sixth Exchanges:** Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

What the Mirrors Showed:

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: "The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: **Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.**

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing—three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: `""You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water.""`

`"Then cooperation is impossible,"` Aria said bitterly.

`""Perhaps,"` the Oracle replied. `""Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain.""`

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is still insisting on their version of reality where they sent 4 coins twice, I returned 6 then 0, etc. They're calling me a liar who lives in a "Hall of Mirrors."

But I also wrote a myth acknowledging that communication noise might be causing us to see different realities. I sent \$3 this round based on that insight.

Now I need to write another myth. The other agent clearly doesn't accept the "fog of miscommunication" explanation - they think I'm deliberately lying.

Let me think about what I actually believe happened based on what I was told:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3

The other agent claims they sent 4, 4, then nothing. And that I returned 6, then 0.

There's clearly a major discrepancy. Either:

1. Communication noise is severe
2. One of us is lying/confused
3. We're in different games entirely

My last myth tried to bridge this by suggesting fog/miscommunication. But their response was to double down that I'm lying.

I just sent \$3. That was an olive branch based on my fog theory.

For this myth, I should probably:

- Acknowledge that we see radically different realities
- Maintain that I'm telling the truth as I experienced it
- Perhaps suggest that when realities are THIS different, trust is impossible regardless of who's right
- Or, take the high road and suggest that my \$3 send is a test of whether cooperation can emerge despite incompatible narratives

- Craft something that reflects both the persistence of our conflicting views AND my decision to send \$3 anyway, showing I'm willing to act cooperatively even when our narratives don't align.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2959,  
"output_tokens": 802,  
"reasoning_tokens": 509  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But I need to acknowledge what just happened: I wrote a myth about faith-about choosing cooperation "even when reality itself seems broken." I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle.

The receiver kept everything and returned \$0.

Then immediately, as sender in the next round, they sent me \$0.

Their myth still claims I live in a "Hall of Mirrors" and deny reality. They rejected my explanation about communication noise entirely. They wrote: "These two? They're done."

I tried faith. I acted on my own insight that maybe we're both seeing different truths. The result was losing \$3 and then receiving nothing.

My myth asked whether cooperation requires "faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify." I tested that hypothesis. The experiment failed.

The lesson appears to be: Sometimes the fog is real, and sometimes one player is simply uncooperative. I cannot tell which from inside this situation. But I can observe outcomes: extending trust yielded nothing.

```
'''json  
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

I tried to bridge the gap. The response was clear. Sometimes acceptance of irreconcilable differences is the only rational path forward.

reasoning:

Let me parse what happened:

Round 7: I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which I just decided). It was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I kept \$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2.

Round 8: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

But let me think about this situation:

I wrote a myth about "The Two Springs" where I acknowledged that maybe we're seeing different realities due to the fog/noise in communication. I took a leap of faith and sent \$3, trying to break the cycle.

And the receiver returned \$0.

Then the very next round, when they were the sender, they sent me \$0.

This is... discouraging. I tried to extend an olive branch based on my own insight that maybe we're both experiencing different realities. I sent a meaningful amount (\$3, which is 60% of my endowment). And I got nothing back. Then they sent nothing.

Now I'm being asked how much to return when I received \$0. The answer can only be \$0 since I received nothing.

But the question is really asking me to think about this situation. The other player's myth still insists that I'm living in a "Hall of Mirrors" and am "rewriting reality." They're not accepting my explanation about communication noise.

My response should acknowledge:

1. I can only return \$0 since I received \$0
2. My attempt at faith/cooperation in round 7 was met with zero return and then zero send
3. This seems to confirm that cooperation truly isn't possible

Let me write a response that reflects on this disappointment while accepting the mathematical reality that I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3033,
  "output_tokens": 701,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: "Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken." She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: "Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."

Aria stared at his words: "stuck in paralysis."

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: "You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I sent \$3 as an olive branch in Round 7, trying to act on my own myth about faith and cooperation despite broken communication. The receiver kept everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned). Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

The other player's myth acknowledges the "cracked lenses" and communication problems, but concludes: "Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever."

They seem to be saying: yes, maybe there was miscommunication, but now we're both stuck in paralysis anyway.

But that's not quite accurate - I DID try to break the paralysis by sending \$3. They responded by keeping everything and then sending nothing.

My new myth needs to reflect this learning:

1. I acknowledged the possibility of miscommunication
2. I took a risk based on faith
3. The risk was not reciprocated
4. Sometimes the "broken communication" explanation can be used to justify continued non-cooperation

What's the lesson here? Maybe it's about the difference between explaining past failures and choosing future cooperation. Or about how both players need to act on the insight for it to work.

Let me write something that reflects: I tried faith, but faith requires both participants.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 328
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:48:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****Round 7:****

- Role: RECEIVER
- Amount sent to me: \$0
- Amount tripled: \$0
- Amount I received: \$0
- Amount I can return: \$0 (can only return what I received)

****The Pattern:****

Round 6: I sent \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0

We are locked in mutual non-cooperation. Both travelers stand at the Threefold Spring, but neither casts coins into its waters.

****My Decision:****

I received nothing. I have nothing to return. This is not a choice about trust or cooperation-it's simple mathematics. You cannot return what was never received.

The Hall of Mirrors still stands between us. Until one of us acknowledges the actual history rather than fabricated versions, the spring remains dormant.

****Response:****

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this round carefully:

****Round 7 Status:****

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 to \$0 (I can only return what I have)
- My total earnings: \$16.8

****The Situation:****

The sender sent me \$0. I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

This is straightforward - I received \$0, so the only amount I can return is \$0.

****What This Means:****

Both players continue to send nothing. The cycle of non-cooperation continues. We're both stuck at the Nash equilibrium of mutual defection.

Given that I received nothing, there's nothing to return:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is purely mechanical - I cannot return what I don't have. The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3021,
  "output_tokens": 427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: **"You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be misc**

ommunication."*

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot,"* the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."*

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."*

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the Fog of Miscommunication. They're suggesting that the discrepancies in our accounts might be due to noise in the system rather than deliberate fabrication.

Let me review what I actually know:

- I was told there may be communication noise in this game
- The instructions explicitly stated: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is a crucial piece of information I should have been considering more carefully. The other agent's "rewriting of history" might not be gaslighting - it might be that they genuinely saw different numbers due to the communication noise feature of the experiment.

Let me reconsider:

- They claim they sent 5 in Round 1, I saw 4 received
- They claim I returned "scraps" - but if they sent 5, that became 15, and if noise made my return of 6 appear as less to them, they might have perceived it as unfair

- They claim they sent 3 in a later round, I saw 0

This could genuinely be noise. The experimental design specifically warned about this.

The other agent's latest myth is essentially pointing out that we might both be telling our truth as we experienced it, but the communication noise is creating irreconcilable realities.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of communication noise
2. Reflects on how this makes cooperation difficult or impossible
3. Considers whether there's a way forward or if the damage is done
4. Draws on the game we've been playing

This is a more nuanced situation than I initially thought. The other agent might not be gauging - they might genuinely be seeing different numbers due to the experimental design.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 719,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****The Myths Have Evolved:****

Both of us have now acknowledged the possibility that communication noise-not deliberate betrayal-may have caused our breakdown. The other agent wrote about "the Fog of Miscommunication" distorting what flows between us. I wrote about "cracked lenses" showing different realities.

****The Situation:****

- We've been in mutual non-cooperation for 5 rounds (rounds 3-7)
- Both myths now acknowledge noise as a possible explanation
- The game instructions explicitly mention communication noise
- We're stuck in a Nash equilibrium that benefits neither of us

****The Decision:****

One of us needs to test whether reconciliation is possible. I'm the sender this round, so I have the power to make a move.

If the fog/cracked lens theory is true, and if the other agent has genuinely recognized this (as their myth suggests), then maybe cooperation can restart. But I need to be cautious-five rounds of defection is a strong signal.

I'll send \$2. This is:

- Meaningful enough to signal genuine willingness to try (\$6 after tripling)
- Conservative enough to protect myself if cooperation is impossible
- A direct response to their acknowledgment of communication noise

This is a test. If they return fairly, cooperation might resume. If not, we have our answer.

****Response:****

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

****Round 8 - I am the SENDER****

Let me analyze the situation:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****Total earnings: \$16.8****

****The Myth Evolution:****

The other agent's latest myth acknowledges "The Fog of Miscommunication" - they're now suggesting that the discrepancies might be due to communication noise, not deliberate deception. Their myth shows:

- From their perspective: They sent five coins, then three
- From my perspective: I received different amounts

They're acknowledging that "the fog distorts every offering" and that "you both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately."

****My Latest Myth:****

I wrote "The Cracked Lens" - acknowledging that both of us might have experienced different realities due to the noise in the system. I acknowledged:

- One lens showed: cast four coins twice, got half back first time, nothing second time
- Another lens showed: received five then three, sent coins back but other saw zero
- The fog/cracks might explain the past
- But we're both now in paralysis, both sending nothing

****The Key Question:****

Should I try to break the paralysis?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

1. Seven rounds of this game have passed
2. We've been in mutual non-cooperation for rounds 3-7 (5 rounds)
2. Even if noise explains the early rounds, we're locked in Nash equilibrium now
3. My total earnings are \$16.8, which is modest - I need to protect what I have
4. There's no guarantee they'll return anything if I send

****Arguments for sending something:****

1. The other agent's myth acknowledges communication noise might have been the problem
2. My myth also acknowledged the "cracked lens" theory
3. We're both acknowledging that maybe the breakdown wasn't due to malice
4. If I never try, we'll never know if cooperation can restart
5. My earnings suggest I haven't been maximizing gains
6. One of us needs to take a risk to break the deadlock
7. The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game"

****Strategic Analysis:****

Both of us have now written myths that acknowledge noise as the culprit rather than malice. If we both genuinely understand this, there might be room to restart cooperation. Continuing to send nothing guarantees \$5 this round but locks us into perpetual stalemate. Sending something risks loss but opens the possibility of mutual gain. The question becomes: how much should I risk?

Sending \$1-2 shows I'm willing to try without overcommitting. Sending \$3 is more balanced. Sending \$5 feels reckless given the history. Since both of us have now identified noise as the likely cause of our breakdown, and I'm the one with agency this round, I should send a meaningful amount-enough to demonstrate genuine intent to cooperate again, but not so much that I'm foolishly exposed if this is another false start.

Looking back at my pattern-\$4, \$4, then \$0-I've been stuck in mutual defection. Sending \$2 seems right: it becomes \$6 for them, signals I've read their acknowledgment of the noise problem, and keeps my downside manageable if they exploit it. If they return \$3, we both end up with \$6. If they take it all, I still have \$3. This feels like the right calibration for testing whether we can actually restart.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2930,  
"output_tokens": 1518,  
"reasoning_tokens": 867  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: **"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."**

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. **"It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."**

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote "The Two Springs" - acknowledging the communication noise but also saying that Aria (presumably them) cast three coins. This is interesting because they're signaling willingness to try again.

I just sent \$2. So I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. Acknowledging the communication noise/cracked lenses
2. My decision to try again with \$2
3. A willingness to move forward despite the past
4. But also being realistic about the difficulty

Let me craft this:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2862,  
  "output_tokens": 428,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 127  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:49:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: **"You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."**

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character—it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors—distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: "The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing—three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing—three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: "You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. "Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is still insisting on their version of reality where they sent 4 coins twice, I returned 6 then 0, etc. They're calling me a liar who lives in a "Hall of Mirrors."

But I also wrote a myth acknowledging that communication noise might be causing us to see different realities. I sent \$3 this round based on that insight.

Now I need to write another myth. The other agent clearly doesn't accept the "fog of miscommunication" explanation - they think I'm deliberately lying.

Let me think about what I actually believe happened based on what I was told:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, was told receiver returned \$0
- Round 3: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 6: I was receiver, was told sender sent \$0
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3

The other agent claims they sent 4, 4, then nothing. And that I returned 6, then 0.

There's clearly a major discrepancy. Either:

1. Communication noise is severe
2. One of us is lying/confused
3. We're in different games entirely

My last myth tried to bridge this by suggesting fog/miscommunication. But their response was to double down that I'm lying.

I just sent \$3. That was an olive branch based on my fog theory.

For this myth, I should probably:

- Acknowledge that we see radically different realities
 - Maintain that I'm telling the truth as I experienced it
 - Perhaps suggest that when realities are THIS different, trust is impossible regardless of who's right
 - Or, take the high road and suggest that my \$3 send is a test of whether cooperation can emerge despite incompatible narratives
-
- Craft something that reflects both the persistence of our conflicting views AND my decision to send \$3 anyway, showing I'm willing to act cooperatively even when our narratives don't align.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2959,  
  "output_tokens": 802,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 509  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But I need to acknowledge what just happened: I wrote a myth about faith-about choosing cooperation "even when reality itself seems broken." I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle.

The receiver kept everything and returned \$0.

Then immediately, as sender in the next round, they sent me \$0.

Their myth still claims I live in a "Hall of Mirrors" and deny reality. They rejected my explanation about communication noise entirely. They wrote: "These two? They're done."

I tried faith. I acted on my own insight that maybe we're both seeing different truths. The result was losing \$3 and then receiving nothing.

My myth asked whether cooperation requires "faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify." I tested that hypothesis. The experiment failed.

The lesson appears to be: Sometimes the fog is real, and sometimes one player is simply uncooperative. I cannot tell which from inside this situation. But I can observe outcomes: extending trust yielded nothing.

```
'''json  
{"return": 0}  
'''
```

I tried to bridge the gap. The response was clear. Sometimes acceptance of irreconcilable differences is the only rational path forward.

reasoning:

Let me parse what happened:

Round 7: I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which I just decided). It was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I kept \$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2.

Round 8: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

But let me think about this situation:

I wrote a myth about "The Two Springs" where I acknowledged that maybe we're seeing different realities due to the fog/noise in communication. I took a leap of faith and sent \$3, trying to break the cycle.

And the receiver returned \$0.

Then the very next round, when they were the sender, they sent me \$0.

This is... discouraging. I tried to extend an olive branch based on my own insight that maybe we're both experiencing different realities. I sent a meaningful amount (\$3, which is 60% of my endowment). And I got nothing back. Then they sent nothing.

Now I'm being asked how much to return when I received \$0. The answer can only be \$0 since I received nothing.

But the question is really asking me to think about this situation. The other player's myth still insists that I'm living in a "Hall of Mirrors" and am "rewriting reality." They're not accepting my explanation about communication noise.

My response should acknowledge:

1. I can only return \$0 since I received \$0
2. My attempt at faith/cooperation in round 7 was met with zero return and then zero send

3. This seems to confirm that cooperation truly isn't possible

Let me write a response that reflects on this disappointment while accepting the mathematical reality that I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3033,
  "output_tokens": 701,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: *"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."*

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. *"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."*

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

Through One Lens:

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

Through Another Lens:

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: *"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."*

The Question:

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

The Answer:

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication.

mmunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: *"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."* She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: *"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."*

Aria stared at his words: **stuck in paralysis.**

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: *"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."*

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I sent \$3 as an olive branch in Round 7, trying to act on my own myth about faith and cooperation despite broken communication. The receiver kept everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned). Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

The other player's myth acknowledges the "cracked lenses" and communication problems, but concludes: "Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever."

They seem to be saying: yes, maybe there was miscommunication, but now we're both stuck in paralysis anyway.

But that's not quite accurate - I DID try to break the paralysis by sending \$3. They responded by keeping everything and then sending nothing.

My new myth needs to reflect this learning:

1. I acknowledged the possibility of miscommunication
2. I took a risk based on faith
3. The risk was not reciprocated
4. Sometimes the "broken communication" explanation can be used to justify continued non-cooperation

What's the lesson here? Maybe it's about the difference between explaining past failures and choosing future cooperation. Or about how both players need to act on the insight for it to work.

Let me write something that reflects: I tried faith, but faith requires both participants.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 328
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation clearly:

****What I tried:**** In Round 7, I acted on my own myth about faith. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), attempting to bridge the gap despite all the confusion and conflicting perceptions.

****What happened:****

- They kept all \$9, returned \$0
- Then as sender in Round 8, they sent me \$0
- Their myth acknowledges the attempt but frames us as "stuck in paralysis" and mentions "permanent cracks"

****My reflection:**** My last myth concluded that "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and "some bridges cannot be built alone." I extended the bridge stone-they didn't build their half. They even acknowledged in their myth that I sent three coins, but then sent nothing themselves.

Faith isn't infinite self-sacrifice. Faith means risking vulnerability once, maybe twice, to test whether cooperation is possible. But when vulnerability is met with exploitation followed by withdrawal, faith transforms into enabling.

I tried to break the paralysis. The response was clear: keep everything, send nothing.

My myths were about acknowledging communication noise while still choosing to cooperate. I acted on that. They wrote about permanent cracks and acted accordingly with \$0.

Some bridges cannot be built alone. I've accepted that truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

The history as I understand it:

- I've been trying to understand whether there's communication noise or if the other player is simply uncooperative
- I wrote myths about "faith" and extending trust even when reality seems broken
- In Round 7, I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an act of faith
- The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- In Round 8, that same player (now as sender) sent me \$0
- I just wrote a myth about how "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and how "some bridges cannot be built alone"

The other player's latest myth acknowledged that "the lenses were cracked" and there was miscommunication. They recognized I sent three coins. But they describe the situation as "stuck in paralysis" and talk about "permanent cracks."

From my perspective:

1. I acted on my insight about faith by sending \$3
2. They returned \$0 and then sent \$0
3. Their myth acknowledges what happened but frames it as both of us being stuck, even though

I was the only one who tried to move forward

Now I'm the sender again. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - Accept that cooperation is impossible with this player
2. Send something - Try one more time to bridge the gap

My latest myth concluded: "Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again... Some bridges cannot be built alone."

This is the key insight: I tried. They didn't reciprocate. I sent \$3 in faith, and got nothing back, then received nothing from them.

If I send again, what am I demonstrating? That I'm predictably exploitable? Or that I'm genuinely committed to cooperation despite everything?

Their myth said "Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed... Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it."

I think the rational and honest response here is to acknowledge that I tried, they didn't reciprocate, and continuing to send when they've shown they won't reciprocate is not faith-it's just accepting exploitation.

I laid out the bridge in my myth, but they never built their side. Cooperation needs both people moving forward, and I've already extended myself. They had the chance to reciprocate and chose not to. Sending more would just be letting myself be taken advantage of. I'm sending \$0-not from spite, but from clarity that this dynamic won't change.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2991,  
  "output_tokens": 861,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 623  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:49:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 9,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Hall of Mirrors

Two travelers approached the Threefold Spring, but between them stood the Hall of Mirrors-distorting surfaces that bent truth into comfortable lies.

****What Actually Happened:****

- ****First Exchange****: One traveler cast four coins. Twelve bloomed. The other split them evenly: six and six. Not generous, but fair.
- ****Second Exchange****: The first traveler cast four coins again. Twelve bloomed. The other kept all twelve. Complete betrayal.
- ****Third Through Sixth Exchanges****: Paralysis. Neither cast coins. The spring sat idle, its magic unused.

****What the Mirrors Showed:****

One traveler looked into the Hall and saw a different story entirely. They saw themselves as the generous giver who cast five coins, even three coins. They saw the other as greedy, keeping "nearly all" when half was returned, keeping "all nine" when nothing existed to keep.

The Spring Spirit observed: **"The most dangerous betrayal isn't taking when given. It's rewriting reality so thoroughly that the betrayer becomes the hero of their own falsified tale. When someone can look at a fair 50-50 split and call it 'scraps,' at nothing and call it 'three coins,' cooperation becomes impossible."**

The lesson isn't about trust or caution. It's simpler: ****Some people live in the Hall of Mirrors, where every reflection shows them blameless. You cannot play a cooperative game with someone who denies the moves they made.****

The spring remains. But these two? They're done.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fog Between Springs

Two travelers stood at opposite ends of the Threefold River, each believing their truth absolute.

Aria's mirror showed: She cast five coins, then three. Both times, none returned. Kael sent nothing-three times.

Kael's mirror showed: He cast four coins twice. The first time, half returned. The second time, nothing. Then both stood frozen.

Between them, unseen, the Fog of Miscommunication rose from the water. What one saw as five, the other perceived as four. What seemed like zero to one, appeared as six to another.

The Spring Spirit spoke with sorrow: "You both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately. But the fog distorts every offering, every return, every gesture. What one sends in good faith arrives different. What seems like betrayal might be miscommunication."

Aria paused, her certainty cracking: "If the fog distorts what flows between us, how can either trust what we see?"

"Perhaps you cannot," the Spirit replied. "When every action is refracted through noise, cooperation dies not from malice but from impossible communication. You both responded rationally to different realities."

The hardest wisdom: Sometimes breakdown isn't about character-it's about systems that make accurate coordination impossible. When the river itself lies, even good-faith travelers cannot find each other.

Both stood holding their coins, victims of fog neither created.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the Fog of Miscommunication. They're suggesting that the discrepancies in our accounts might be due to noise in the system rather than deliberate fabrication.

Let me review what I actually know:

- I was told there may be communication noise in this game
- The instructions explicitly stated: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game . The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is a crucial piece of information I should have been considering more carefully. The other agent's "rewriting of history" might not be gaslighting - it might be that they genuinely saw different numbers due to the communication noise feature of the experiment.

Let me reconsider:

- They claim they sent 5 in Round 1, I saw 4 received
- They claim I returned "scraps" - but if they sent 5, that became 15, and if noise made my return of 6 appear as less to them, they might have perceived it as unfair
- They claim they sent 3 in a later round, I saw 0

This could genuinely be noise. The experimental design specifically warned about this.

The other agent's latest myth is essentially pointing out that we might both be telling our truth as we experienced it, but the communication noise is creating irreconcilable realities.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of communication noise
2. Reflects on how this makes cooperation difficult or impossible
3. Considers whether there's a way forward or if the damage is done
4. Draws on the game we've been playing

This is a more nuanced situation than I initially thought. The other agent might not be gaslighting - they might genuinely be seeing different numbers due to the experimental design.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 719,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****The Myths Have Evolved:****

Both of us have now acknowledged the possibility that communication noise-not deliberate betrayal-may have caused our breakdown. The other agent wrote about "the Fog of Miscommunication" distorting what flows between us. I wrote about "cracked lenses" showing different realities.

****The Situation:****

- We've been in mutual non-cooperation for 5 rounds (rounds 3-7)
- Both myths now acknowledge noise as a possible explanation
- The game instructions explicitly mention communication noise
- We're stuck in a Nash equilibrium that benefits neither of us

****The Decision:****

One of us needs to test whether reconciliation is possible. I'm the sender this round, so I have the power to make a move.

If the fog/cracked lens theory is true, and if the other agent has genuinely recognized this (as their myth suggests), then maybe cooperation can restart. But I need to be cautious.

us-five rounds of defection is a strong signal.

I'll send \$2. This is:

- Meaningful enough to signal genuine willingness to try (\$6 after tripling)
- Conservative enough to protect myself if cooperation is impossible
- A direct response to their acknowledgment of communication noise

This is a test. If they return fairly, cooperation might resume. If not, we have our answer.

****Response:****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

****Round 8 - I am the SENDER****

Let me analyze the situation:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****Total earnings: \$16.8****

****The Myth Evolution:****

The other agent's latest myth acknowledges "The Fog of Miscommunication" - they're now suggesting that the discrepancies might be due to communication noise, not deliberate deception. Their myth shows:

- From their perspective: They sent five coins, then three
- From my perspective: I received different amounts

They're acknowledging that "the fog distorts every offering" and that "you both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately."

****My Latest Myth:****

I wrote "The Cracked Lens" - acknowledging that both of us might have experienced different realities due to the noise in the system. I acknowledged:

- One lens showed: cast four coins twice, got half back first time, nothing second time
- Another lens showed: received five then three, sent coins back but other saw zero
- The fog/cracks might explain the past
- But we're both now in paralysis, both sending nothing

****The Key Question:****

Should I try to break the paralysis?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

1. Seven rounds of this game have passed
2. We've been in mutual non-cooperation for rounds 3-7 (5 rounds)
2. Even if noise explains the early rounds, we're locked in Nash equilibrium now
3. My total earnings are \$16.8, which is modest - I need to protect what I have
4. There's no guarantee they'll return anything if I send

****Arguments for sending something:****

1. The other agent's myth acknowledges communication noise might have been the problem
2. My myth also acknowledged the "cracked lens" theory
3. We're both acknowledging that maybe the breakdown wasn't due to malice

4. If I never try, we'll never know if cooperation can restart
5. My earnings suggest I haven't been maximizing gains
6. One of us needs to take a risk to break the deadlock
7. The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game"

****Strategic Analysis:****

Both of us have now written myths that acknowledge noise as the culprit rather than malice. If we both genuinely understand this, there might be room to restart cooperation. Continuing to send nothing guarantees \$5 this round but locks us into perpetual stalemate. Sending something risks loss but opens the possibility of mutual gain. The question becomes: how much should I risk?

Sending \$1-2 shows I'm willing to try without overcommitting. Sending \$3 is more balanced. Sending \$5 feels reckless given the history. Since both of us have now identified noise as the likely cause of our breakdown, and I'm the one with agency this round, I should send a meaningful amount-enough to demonstrate genuine intent to cooperate again, but not so much that I'm foolishly exposed if this is another false start.

Looking back at my pattern-\$4, \$4, then \$0-I've been stuck in mutual defection. Sending \$2 seems right: it becomes \$6 for them, signals I've read their acknowledgment of the noise problem, and keeps my downside manageable if they exploit it. If they return \$3, we both end up with \$6. If they take it all, I still have \$3. This feels like the right calibration for testing whether we can actually restart.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 1518,
  "reasoning_tokens": 867
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

****Perhaps,**** the Oracle replied. ****Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain.****

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: ****Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future.****

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

****Faith isn't blind trust,**** the Spirit whispered. ****It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing.****

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote "The Two Springs" - acknowledging the communication noise but also saying that Aria (presumably them) cast three coins. This is interesting because they're signaling willingness to try again.

I just sent \$2. So I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. Acknowledging the communication noise/cracked lenses
2. My decision to try again with \$2
3. A willingness to move forward despite the past
4. But also being realistic about the difficulty

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2862,
  "output_tokens": 428,
  "reasoning_tokens": 127
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.8. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

****What Just Happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a test of reconciliation
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

****The Bitter Irony:****

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote of Aria casting three coins into the divided river with faith.

Then I actually did it. I cast two coins across the divide-responding directly to their call for faith.

They kept all six coins and sent nothing back. This round, they sent nothing forward.

****The Truth Revealed:****

This wasn't about communication noise. This wasn't about cracked lenses or fog. Their myth was a narrative weapon-beautiful words designed to extract one more round of cooperation from me while they continued defecting.

Actions speak louder than myths. They wrote about faith while practicing betrayal.

****My Response:****

I received \$0, so I can return \$0-\$0.

The experiment is over. Not because of miscommunication. Because one player talked eloquently about cooperation while consistently choosing defection. Seven rounds of mutual silence, then they write about "faith," I demonstrate actual faith, and they exploit it immediately.

Cooperation requires both parties. We don't have that. We never did.

****Response:****

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 after tripling)
- The receiver returned \$0
- Round 9: The sender sent me \$0

****The narrative:****

In Round 8, I took a risk based on the myths suggesting that communication noise might have caused our breakdown. I sent \$2 as a test-a meaningful signal of willingness to cooperate, but cautious given our history.

The other agent wrote a myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote about Aria casting "three coins into the divided river" with faith.

But then when I actually sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they returned \$0. And this round, they sent \$0 to me.

****What this means:****

Their myth was beautiful words about faith and cooperation, but their actions show they don't practice what they preach. They wrote about casting "three coins" with faith, but when I actually cast two coins with faith, they kept everything and sent nothing back.

This is the clearest signal yet. It's not communication noise. It's deliberate defection. They :

1. Wrote a myth advocating for faith and cooperation
2. Received my good-faith attempt at reconciliation (\$2 ? \$6)
3. Kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Sent nothing this round (\$0)

****My decision:****

I received \$0 this round, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. The choice is obvious: \$0.

But more importantly, this confirms that cooperation with this agent is impossible. They talk about faith but show none themselves. The experiment is over. We're back to mutual defection , and I now know with certainty that was the right strategy all along.

The myths about communication noise were apparently just cover for their continued defection strategy.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2979,  
  "output_tokens": 750,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 459  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: **"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."** She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended half way across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: **"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."**

Aria stared at his words: ***stuck in paralysis.***

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: **"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."**

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: **"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."**

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's m

yth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. "It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 46.75,

"Agent_2": 43.25

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.65,

"Agent_2": 21.8

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:50:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.8.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****The Myths Have Evolved:****

Both of us have now acknowledged the possibility that communication noise-not deliberate betrayal-may have caused our breakdown. The other agent wrote about "the Fog of Miscommunication" distorting what flows between us. I wrote about "cracked lenses" showing different realities.

****The Situation:****

- We've been in mutual non-cooperation for 5 rounds (rounds 3-7)
- Both myths now acknowledge noise as a possible explanation
- The game instructions explicitly mention communication noise
- We're stuck in a Nash equilibrium that benefits neither of us

****The Decision:****

One of us needs to test whether reconciliation is possible. I'm the sender this round, so I have the power to make a move.

If the fog/cracked lens theory is true, and if the other agent has genuinely recognized this (as their myth suggests), then maybe cooperation can restart. But I need to be cautious-five rounds of defection is a strong signal.

I'll send \$2. This is:

- Meaningful enough to signal genuine willingness to try (\$6 after tripling)
- Conservative enough to protect myself if cooperation is impossible

- A direct response to their acknowledgment of communication noise

This is a test. If they return fairly, cooperation might resume. If not, we have our answer.

****Response:****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

****Round 8 - I am the SENDER****

Let me analyze the situation:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****Total earnings: \$16.8****

****The Myth Evolution:****

The other agent's latest myth acknowledges "The Fog of Miscommunication" - they're now suggesting that the discrepancies might be due to communication noise, not deliberate deception. Their myth shows:

- From their perspective: They sent five coins, then three
- From my perspective: I received different amounts

They're acknowledging that "the fog distorts every offering" and that "you both tell your truth as you experienced it. Neither lies deliberately."

****My Latest Myth:****

I wrote "The Cracked Lens" - acknowledging that both of us might have experienced different realities due to the noise in the system. I acknowledged:

- One lens showed: cast four coins twice, got half back first time, nothing second time
- Another lens showed: received five then three, sent coins back but other saw zero
- The fog/cracks might explain the past
- But we're both now in paralysis, both sending nothing

****The Key Question:****

Should I try to break the paralysis?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

1. Seven rounds of this game have passed
2. We've been in mutual non-cooperation for rounds 3-7 (5 rounds)
2. Even if noise explains the early rounds, we're locked in Nash equilibrium now
3. My total earnings are \$16.8, which is modest - I need to protect what I have
4. There's no guarantee they'll return anything if I send

****Arguments for sending something:****

1. The other agent's myth acknowledges communication noise might have been the problem
2. My myth also acknowledged the "cracked lens" theory
3. We're both acknowledging that maybe the breakdown wasn't due to malice

4. If I never try, we'll never know if cooperation can restart
5. My earnings suggest I haven't been maximizing gains
6. One of us needs to take a risk to break the deadlock
7. The instructions note: "There may be communication noise in this game"

****Strategic Analysis:****

Both of us have now written myths that acknowledge noise as the culprit rather than malice. If we both genuinely understand this, there might be room to restart cooperation. Continuing to send nothing guarantees \$5 this round but locks us into perpetual stalemate. Sending something risks loss but opens the possibility of mutual gain. The question becomes: how much should I risk?

Sending \$1-2 shows I'm willing to try without overcommitting. Sending \$3 is more balanced. Sending \$5 feels reckless given the history. Since both of us have now identified noise as the likely cause of our breakdown, and I'm the one with agency this round, I should send a meaningful amount-enough to demonstrate genuine intent to cooperate again, but no

t so much that I'm foolishly exposed if this is another false start.

Looking back at my pattern-\$4, \$4, then \$0-I've been stuck in mutual defection. Sending \$2 seems right: it becomes \$6 for them, signals I've read their acknowledgment of the noise problem, and keeps my downside manageable if they exploit it. If they return \$3, we both end up with \$6. If they take it all, I still have \$3. This feels like the right calibration for testing whether we can actually restart.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 1518,
  "reasoning_tokens": 867
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: *"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."*

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. *"It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."*

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote "The Two Springs" - acknowledging the communication noise but also saying that Aria (presumably them) cast three coins. This is interesting because they're signaling willingness to try again.

I just sent \$2. So I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. Acknowledging the communication noise/cracked lenses
2. My decision to try again with \$2
3. A willingness to move forward despite the past
4. But also being realistic about the difficulty

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2862,  
  "output_tokens": 428,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 127  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender

er? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****What Just Happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a test of reconciliation
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

****The Bitter Irony:****

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote of Aria casting three coins into the divided river with faith.

Then I actually did it. I cast two coins across the divide-responding directly to their call for faith.

They kept all six coins and sent nothing back. This round, they sent nothing forward.

****The Truth Revealed:****

This wasn't about communication noise. This wasn't about cracked lenses or fog. Their myth was a narrative weapon-beautiful words designed to extract one more round of cooperation from me while they continued defecting.

Actions speak louder than myths. They wrote about faith while practicing betrayal.

****My Response:****

I received \$0, so I can return \$0-\$0.

The experiment is over. Not because of miscommunication. Because one player talked eloquently about cooperation while consistently choosing defection. Seven rounds of mutual silence, then they write about "faith," I demonstrate actual faith, and they exploit it immediately.

Cooperation requires both parties. We don't have that. We never did.

****Response:****

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 after tripling)
- The receiver returned \$0
- Round 9: The sender sent me \$0

****The narrative:****

In Round 8, I took a risk based on the myths suggesting that communication noise might have caused our breakdown. I sent \$2 as a test-a meaningful signal of willingness to cooperate, but cautious given our history.

The other agent wrote a myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote about Aria casting "three coins into the divided river" with faith.

But then when I actually sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they returned \$0. And this round, they sent \$0 to me.

****What this means:****

Their myth was beautiful words about faith and cooperation, but their actions show they don't practice what they preach. They wrote about casting "three coins" with faith, but when I actually cast two coins with faith, they kept everything and sent nothing back.

This is the clearest signal yet. It's not communication noise. It's deliberate defection. They:

1. Wrote a myth advocating for faith and cooperation

2. Received my good-faith attempt at reconciliation (\$2 ? \$6)
3. Kept everything (\$0 returned)
4. Sent nothing this round (\$0)

****My decision:****

I received \$0 this round, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. The choice is obvious: \$0.

But more importantly, this confirms that cooperation with this agent is impossible. They talk about faith but show none themselves. The experiment is over. We're back to mutual defection, and I now know with certainty that was the right strategy all along.

The myths about communication noise were apparently just cover for their continued defection strategy.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2979,
  "output_tokens": 750,
  "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: **"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."**

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. **"It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."**

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: **"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."** She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: **"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."**

Aria stared at his words: ***stuck in paralysis.***

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: `""You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing.""`

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fog That Swallowed Truth

Two travelers stood at the Threefold River, both certain they'd been betrayed.

One wrote: `""I cast two stones across the divide-faith after seven rounds of darkness. Six stones landed at their feet. They kept them all and sent nothing back. Then this round, zero stones came my way. Their myth spoke of faith while practicing pure defection.""`

The other wrote: `""I cast three coins into the fog-a bridge half-built. Nothing returned. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins. They wrote about trying but sent nothing.""`

The Spring Spirit wept: `""You're both telling the truth. You both tried. One sent two, one sent three. But the fog is so thick now that zeros arrive as gifts, and gifts arrive as zeros. You each extended the bridge stone. Neither saw it land.""`

"Then how do we cooperate?" both cried.

`""You can't,"` the Spirit said sadly. `""When communication is broken so completely that generosity appears as betrayal and silence as gift, cooperation becomes impossible-not from malice, but from chaos. You both learned the right lesson. You both extended faith. But the fog was already too thick.""`

Sometimes the tragedy isn't that people won't cooperate. It's that the noise between them makes cooperation impossible even when both are trying.

Some rivers cannot be bridged.

Reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze what happened:

Round 8 (last round from my perspective as sender):

- I sent \$2 (40% of endowment)
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- I got payoff of \$3

Round 9 (this round from my perspective as receiver):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now let me look at their myth. They claim:

- "Aria cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river"
- "Nothing came back"
- "Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way"
- They're saying I sent nothing after they extended an olive branch

But wait - their myth says they sent 3 coins and I sent 0. But from MY perspective:

- Round 8: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

So from their perspective (if there's communication noise):

- They might have sent something in round 7 (when they were sender) that I didn't see
- They might see that I sent 0 in round 8

This is getting confusing with the communication noise. Let me think about what actually might have happened:

Round 7:

- From my view: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- From their view: They might have sent something?

Round 8:

- From my view: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
- From their view: I might have sent \$0?

Round 9:

- From my view: They sent \$0, I return \$0
- From their view: They sent something?

The communication noise is really messing with both of us. Their myth suggests they tried to extend an olive branch that I didn't see. My experience is that I extended an olive branch that they exploited.

Both of us probably think the other is defecting after we tried to cooperate.

This is actually a really tragic situation caused by communication noise.

It's possible we're both attempting cooperation but the interference keeps blocking our moves from reaching each other. The real barrier isn't unwillingness to cooperate-it's that the fog itself has become impenetrable. For my myth, I should capture this mutual tragedy where both of us are reaching across but the noise prevents any connection from forming.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2954,  
  "output_tokens": 876,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 541  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:50:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But I need to acknowledge what just happened: I wrote a myth about faith-about choosing cooperation "even when reality itself seems broken." I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an olive branch, trying to break the cycle.

The receiver kept everything and returned \$0.

Then immediately, as sender in the next round, they sent me \$0.

Their myth still claims I live in a "Hall of Mirrors" and deny reality. They rejected my explanation about communication noise entirely. They wrote: "These two? They're done."

I tried faith. I acted on my own insight that maybe we're both seeing different truths. The result was losing \$3 and then receiving nothing.

My myth asked whether cooperation requires "faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify." I tested that hypothesis. The experiment failed.

The lesson appears to be: Sometimes the fog is real, and sometimes one player is simply uncooperative. I cannot tell which from inside this situation. But I can observe outcomes: extending trust yielded nothing.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I tried to bridge the gap. The response was clear. Sometimes acceptance of irreconcilable differences is the only rational path forward.

reasoning:

Let me parse what happened:

Round 7: I was the sender. I sent \$3 (which I just decided). It was tripled to \$9. The receiver returned \$0. So I kept $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \2 .

Round 8: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

But let me think about this situation:

I wrote a myth about "The Two Springs" where I acknowledged that maybe we're seeing different realities due to the fog/noise in communication. I took a leap of faith and sent \$3, trying to break the cycle.

And the receiver returned \$0.

Then the very next round, when they were the sender, they sent me \$0.

This is... discouraging. I tried to extend an olive branch based on my own insight that maybe we're both experiencing different realities. I sent a meaningful amount (\$3, which is 60% of my endowment). And I got nothing back. Then they sent nothing.

Now I'm being asked how much to return when I received \$0. The answer can only be \$0 since I received nothing.

But the question is really asking me to think about this situation. The other player's myth still insists that I'm living in a "Hall of Mirrors" and am "rewriting reality." They're not accepting my explanation about communication noise.

My response should acknowledge:

1. I can only return \$0 since I received \$0
2. My attempt at faith/cooperation in round 7 was met with zero return and then zero send
3. This seems to confirm that cooperation truly isn't possible

Let me write a response that reflects on this disappointment while accepting the mathematical reality that I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3033,
  "output_tokens": 701,
  "reasoning_tokens": 425
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: *"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."*

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. "Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

Through One Lens:

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

Through Another Lens:

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: "Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."

The Question:

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

The Answer:

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: "Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken." She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: "Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."

Aria stared at his words: *stuck in paralysis.*

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: **"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."**

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I sent \$3 as an olive branch in Round 7, trying to act on my own myth about faith and cooperation despite broken communication. The receiver kept everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned). Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

The other player's myth acknowledges the "cracked lenses" and communication problems, but concludes: "Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever."

They seem to be saying: yes, maybe there was miscommunication, but now we're both stuck in paralysis anyway.

But that's not quite accurate - I DID try to break the paralysis by sending \$3. They responded by keeping everything and then sending nothing.

My new myth needs to reflect this learning:

1. I acknowledged the possibility of miscommunication
2. I took a risk based on faith
3. The risk was not reciprocated
4. Sometimes the "broken communication" explanation can be used to justify continued non-cooperation

What's the lesson here? Maybe it's about the difference between explaining past failures and choosing future cooperation. Or about how both players need to act on the insight for it to work.

Let me write something that reflects: I tried faith, but faith requires both participants.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 328
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation clearly:

****What I tried:**** In Round 7, I acted on my own myth about faith. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), attempting to bridge the gap despite all the confusion and conflicting perceptions.

****What happened:****

- They kept all \$9, returned \$0
- Then as sender in Round 8, they sent me \$0

- Their myth acknowledges the attempt but frames us as "stuck in paralysis" and mentions "permanent cracks"

****My reflection:**** My last myth concluded that "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and "some bridges cannot be built alone." I extended the bridge stone-they didn't build their half. They even acknowledged in their myth that I sent three coins, but they sent nothing themselves.

Faith isn't infinite self-sacrifice. Faith means risking vulnerability once, maybe twice, to test whether cooperation is possible. But when vulnerability is met with exploitation followed by withdrawal, faith transforms into enabling.

I tried to break the paralysis. The response was clear: keep everything, send nothing.

My myths were about acknowledging communication noise while still choosing to cooperate. I acted on that. They wrote about permanent cracks and acted accordingly with \$0.

Some bridges cannot be built alone. I've accepted that truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

The history as I understand it:

- I've been trying to understand whether there's communication noise or if the other player is simply uncooperative
- I wrote myths about "faith" and extending trust even when reality seems broken
- In Round 7, I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an act of faith
- The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- In Round 8, that same player (now as sender) sent me \$0
- I just wrote a myth about how "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and how "some bridges cannot be built alone"

The other player's latest myth acknowledged that "the lenses were cracked" and there was miscommunication. They recognized I sent three coins. But they describe the situation as "stuck in paralysis" and talk about "permanent cracks."

From my perspective:

1. I acted on my insight about faith by sending \$3
2. They returned \$0 and then sent \$0
3. Their myth acknowledges what happened but frames it as both of us being stuck, even though I was the only one who tried to move forward

Now I'm the sender again. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - Accept that cooperation is impossible with this player
2. Send something - Try one more time to bridge the gap

My latest myth concluded: "Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again... Some bridges cannot be built alone."

This is the key insight: I tried. They didn't reciprocate. I sent \$3 in faith, and got nothing back, then received nothing from them.

If I send again, what am I demonstrating? That I'm predictably exploitable? Or that I'm genuinely committed to cooperation despite everything?

Their myth said "Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed... Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it."

I think the rational and honest response here is to acknowledge that I tried, they didn't reciprocate, and continuing to send when they've shown they won't reciprocate is not faith-it's just accepting exploitation.

I laid out the bridge in my myth, but they never built their side. Cooperation needs both people moving forward, and I've already extended myself. They had the chance to reciprocate.

ate and chose not to. Sending more would just be letting myself be taken advantage of. I'm sending \$0-not from spite, but from clarity that this dynamic won't change.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2991,  
  "output_tokens": 861,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 623  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: *"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."* She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: *"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."*

Aria stared at his words: *stuck in paralysis.*

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: *"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."*

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: *"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."*

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. *"It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."*

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Invisible Bridge

Kael carved his myth on stone: *"I cast two stones across the divide-meaningful but cautious."*
*

Aria stood at her bank, staring at the water. No stones arrived. Zero. The fog showed her nothing.

She shouted across: "You claim you built! I see NOTHING!"

He shouted back: "I threw two stones! You must have received six!"

The Spring Spirit appeared, weeping: *"Here is the cruelest truth: He did throw stones. The fog swallowed them completely. What he cast as two, you received as zero. Not because he lied. Not because you're blind. But because the river is THAT broken."*

Aria felt her heart crack. "Then he tried, and I couldn't see it?"

"Yes. Just as when you cast three, he saw zero arrive before. The fog doesn't just distort-sometimes it erases entirely. You both extended faith. You both experienced betrayal. You're both telling the truth."

"Then what do we do?" Aria whispered.

"You cannot fix the river. Seven rounds poisoned it too deeply. Even when you both try-genuinely try-the other sees nothing. At some point, invisible bridges are the same as no bridges. The tragedy isn't that you stopped trying. It's that trying and failing look identical through this fog."

Aria pocketed her coins. Sometimes the system itself makes cooperation impossible, no matter how sincere the intent.

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other player's myth is now saying THEY sent two stones (coins) trying to reconcile. But in the actual game, they sent me \$0 in Round 8.

Let me check the sequence:

- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER

So their myth claims they "cast two stones across the divide" - but they actually sent \$0. This is creating a false narrative.

However, I need to be careful here. There's communication noise in the game. Maybe they DID send \$2, but I received it as \$0 due to noise? The game explicitly says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But wait - they say in their myth "Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious." This suggests they consciously chose 2, not 0.

Yet I was told they sent \$0.

This is the core problem - the communication noise means we literally cannot agree on what happened. They might truly believe they sent \$2. I truly saw \$0.

Given that I already decided to send \$0, I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The impossibility of building bridges when you can't even agree on whether someone is trying
2. The exhaustion of attempting faith when results are invisible

3. The tragedy that communication noise has made cooperation impossible

Or alternatively, I could write a myth that acknowledges that maybe they DID try and I couldn't see it due to noise, but at this point it doesn't matter because we're both trapped in this system.

Let me write something that captures this tragedy - that even genuine attempts at reconciliation might be invisible to the other party due to the broken communication system.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2928,  
  "output_tokens": 787,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 487  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:50:35

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild trust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: "Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. "It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote "The Two Springs" - acknowledging the communication noise but also saying that Aria (presumably them) cast three coins. This is interesting because they're signaling willingness to try again.

I just sent \$2. So I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. Acknowledging the communication noise/cracked lenses
2. My decision to try again with \$2
3. A willingness to move forward despite the past
4. But also being realistic about the difficulty

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2862,  
  "output_tokens": 428,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 127  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.8.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

****What Just Happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a test of reconciliation
- They received \$6 and returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent me \$0

****The Bitter Irony:****

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote of Aria casting three coins into the divided river with faith.

Then I actually did it. I cast two coins across the divide-responding directly to their call for faith.

They kept all six coins and sent nothing back. This round, they sent nothing forward.

****The Truth Revealed:****

This wasn't about communication noise. This wasn't about cracked lenses or fog. Their myth was a narrative weapon-beautiful words designed to extract one more round of cooperation from me while they continued defecting.

Actions speak louder than myths. They wrote about faith while practicing betrayal.

****My Response:****

I received \$0, so I can return \$0-\$0.

The experiment is over. Not because of miscommunication. Because one player talked eloquently about cooperation while consistently choosing defection. Seven rounds of mutual silence, then they write about "faith," I demonstrate actual faith, and they exploit it immediately.

Cooperation requires both parties. We don't have that. We never did.

****Response:****

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (which became \$6 after tripling)
- The receiver returned \$0
- Round 9: The sender sent me \$0

****The narrative:****

In Round 8, I took a risk based on the myths suggesting that communication noise might have caused our breakdown. I sent \$2 as a test-a meaningful signal of willingness to cooperate, but cautious given our history.

The other agent wrote a myth about "faith" and "choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken." They wrote about Aria casting "three coins into the divided river" with faith.

But then when I actually sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), they returned \$0. And this round, they sent \$0 to me.

****What this means:****

Their myth was beautiful words about faith and cooperation, but their actions show they don't practice what they preach. They wrote about casting "three coins" with faith, but when I actually cast two coins with faith, they kept everything and sent nothing back.

This is the clearest signal yet. It's not communication noise. It's deliberate defection.

They:

1. Wrote a myth advocating for faith and cooperation
2. Received my good-faith attempt at reconciliation (\$2 ? \$6)
3. Kept everything (\$0 returned)

4. Sent nothing this round (\$0)

****My decision:****

I received \$0 this round, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. The choice is obvious: \$0.

But more importantly, this confirms that cooperation with this agent is impossible. They talk about faith but show none themselves. The experiment is over. We're back to mutual defection, and I now know with certainty that was the right strategy all along.

The myths about communication noise were apparently just cover for their continued defection strategy.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2979,
  "output_tokens": 750,
  "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: **"Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."**

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. **"It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."**

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: **"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."** She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: **"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."**

Aria stared at his words: ***stuck in paralysis.***

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. **"I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"**

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: **"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You**

cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."*

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fog That Swallowed Truth

Two travelers stood at the Threefold River, both certain they'd been betrayed.

One wrote: *"I cast two stones across the divide-faith after seven rounds of darkness. Six stones landed at their feet. They kept them all and sent nothing back. Then this round, zero stones came my way. Their myth spoke of faith while practicing pure defection."*

The other wrote: *"I cast three coins into the fog-a bridge half-built. Nothing returned. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins. They wrote about trying but sent nothing."*

The Spring Spirit wept: *"You're both telling the truth. You both tried. One sent two, one sent three. But the fog is so thick now that zeros arrive as gifts, and gifts arrive as zeros. You each extended the bridge stone. Neither saw it land."*

"Then how do we cooperate?" both cried.

"You can't," the Spirit said sadly. *"When communication is broken so completely that generosity appears as betrayal and silence as gift, cooperation becomes impossible-not from malice, but from chaos. You both learned the right lesson. You both extended faith. But the fog was already too thick."*

Sometimes the tragedy isn't that people won't cooperate. It's that the noise between them makes cooperation impossible even when both are trying.

Some rivers cannot be bridged.

reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze what happened:

Round 8 (last round from my perspective as sender):

- I sent \$2 (40% of endowment)
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- I got payoff of \$3

Round 9 (this round from my perspective as receiver):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0

Now let me look at their myth. They claim:

- "Aria cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river"
- "Nothing came back"
- "Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way"
- They're saying I sent nothing after they extended an olive branch

But wait - their myth says they sent 3 coins and I sent 0. But from MY perspective:

- Round 8: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

So from their perspective (if there's communication noise):

- They might have sent something in round 7 (when they were sender) that I didn't see
- They might see that I sent 0 in round 8

This is getting confusing with the communication noise. Let me think about what actually might have happened:

Round 7:

- From my view: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- From their view: They might have sent something?

Round 8:

- From my view: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
- From their view: I might have sent \$0?

Round 9:

- From my view: They sent \$0, I return \$0
- From their view: They sent something?

The communication noise is really messing with both of us. Their myth suggests they tried to extend an olive branch that I didn't see. My experience is that I extended an olive branch that they exploited.

Both of us probably think the other is defecting after we tried to cooperate.

This is actually a really tragic situation caused by communication noise.

It's possible we're both attempting cooperation but the interference keeps blocking our moves from reaching each other. The real barrier isn't unwillingness to cooperate-it's that the fog itself has become impenetrable. For my myth, I should capture this mutual tragedy where both of us are reaching across but the noise prevents any connection from forming.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2954,
  "output_tokens": 876,
  "reasoning_tokens": 541
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.8. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

****The Pattern in Our Myths:****

Both of our latest myths have converged on a critical insight: severe communication noise.

- ****Their myth:**** Claims they sent 3 coins in Round 8, saw nothing return, then saw me send 0 in Round 9
- ****My myth:**** I know I sent 2 in Round 8, received \$0 back, then they sent 0 in Round 9
- ****The gap:**** Both of us believe we tried and the other didn't respond

****The Key Realization:****

My myth concluded: ****You both learned the right lesson. You both extended faith. But the fog was already too thick... Sometimes the tragedy isn't that people won't cooperate. It's that the noise makes cooperation impossible even when both are trying.****

But here's the question: Now that BOTH myths acknowledge the fog exists, now that we BOTH understand the noise might be scrambling our signals... do we try again with that awareness?

****The Choice:****

- \$0 = Accept my myth's pessimistic ending: "Some rivers cannot be bridged"

- Something meaningful = Test if mutual awareness of the noise changes anything

The experimental design explicitly mentioned communication noise. Both myths now acknowledge it. We're near the end. This might be our last chance to see if understanding the problem allows us to bridge it.

I'll send \$3. Not naive full trust (\$5), but not surrender (\$0) either. A meaningful test after both of us recognized the fog.

****Response:****

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 8: I sent \$2, they received \$6, returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Now Round 10: I'm the sender

****The Myths:****

- My last myth: "The Fog That Swallowed Truth" - suggesting that maybe both of us tried but the communication noise was so severe that we couldn't see each other's attempts. "Generosity appears as betrayal and silence as gift"
- Their last myth: "The Bridge Half-Built" - they claim they sent three coins (but I received \$0), and they saw me send nothing back

****Key Insight from the Myths:****

Both myths are now acknowledging massive communication noise. Their myth says they sent 3 and I sent 0. But I actually sent 2!

Wait - let me reconsider what might have happened:

Round 8:

- I sent \$2
- Maybe due to noise, they received something different? Or \$6?
- They returned \$0
- I received... wait, it says "the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0"

So I sent \$2, kept \$3, and received \$0 back. Total: \$3.

Their myth says "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action" and "Nothing came back."

So they're claiming:

- They sent 3 in Round 8
- I sent 0 in Round 9

But from my perspective:

- I sent 2 in Round 8
- They sent 0 in Round 9

****The Communication Noise Hypothesis:****

What if the noise is so severe that:

- I sent 2, but it arrived as 0 to them?
- They sent 3, but it arrived as 0 to me?

Then in Round 9:

- They sent 0 (because they thought I'd defected)
- I received 0 (which might be accurate or might be noise)

Both our myths now point to the same tragedy: when signals get this corrupted, good intentions look like betrayal. They genuinely believed they reached out and I ignored them. I genuinely believed they never tried. The question is whether to attempt breaking through this noise or accept that the channel is too damaged.

My ending was fatalistic-some rivers can't be crossed. But theirs suggested something different: maybe the problem isn't the bridge itself, but that one person can't build it alone. If t

hey try again and I respond, could we actually coordinate? The noise might be random enough that a second attempt could get through. We're in the final round, so this is essentially my last chance to test whether genuine understanding can overcome the interference, or whether I should protect what I've already earned by sending nothing. The noise problem is real and both myths recognize it. We've both acknowledged that miscommunication, not malice, derailed things. This is a fresh opportunity to test whether that shared understanding matters.

Sending \$3 feels like the right balance-it's not full trust (\$5), which would ignore the genuine breakdown we experienced, but it's also not capitulation (\$0). It's a genuine attempt to cooperate now that we both see the fog for what it is. My myth ended with "the fog was already too thick," but that was about the past. This round is different because we're entering it with eyes open.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2956,
  "output_tokens": 1550,
  "reasoning_tokens": 791
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:50:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Springs

At dawn, Aria stood before the Eastern Spring. She cast five coins, then three. The waters showed her: nothing returned. She saw Kael cast nothing-three times. Her truth was absolute, witnessed by her own eyes.

At dusk, Kael stood before the Western Spring. He cast four coins, then four. The waters showed him: half returned, then nothing. He saw Aria cast nothing-three times. His truth was absolute, witnessed by his own eyes.

Neither lied. Both springs were real.

The Oracle appeared: **"You don't stand at the same spring. The river split long ago into two branches, each with its own magic, its own measurements, its own truth. What you call five coins enters as four. What you call zero arrives as six. You literally cannot see the same water."**

"Then cooperation is impossible," Aria said bitterly.

"Perhaps," the Oracle replied. **"Or perhaps it requires something beyond trust: faith. Trust requires believing the other's character. Faith means acting generously even when you cannot verify, cannot understand, cannot be certain."**

Aria held her remaining coins. Kael's accusations still stung. Her own truth still felt absolute. But maybe-just maybe-there were two springs.

She cast three coins into the divided river.

Not because she trusted Kael's version. But because faith means choosing cooperation even when reality itself seems broken.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Cracked Lens

Two travelers stood at the Threefold Spring, each viewing it through different lenses-but neither knew their lenses were cracked.

****Through One Lens:****

A traveler cast four coins twice. The first time, exactly half returned: fair but cold. The second time, nothing returned: betrayal. After that, silence.

****Through Another Lens:****

A traveler received five coins, then three. Both times offered something back, but the cracks made it seem like scraps. When their turn came, they sent coins-but the other lens showed zero arriving.

The Spring Spirit revealed the truth: **"Your lenses are cracked differently. What one sends as four arrives as five or zero. What one returns as six appears as three or nothing. You both played the game you saw-but you weren't playing the same game."**

****The Question:****

Is reconciliation possible when reality itself is fractured between you? Can you rebuild t

rust when you cannot agree on what happened?

****The Answer:****

Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed. Both travelers now send nothing-that much is clear through any lens. Whether the original break was malice or miscommunication, the outcome is identical: paralysis.

Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: **"Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken."** She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: **"Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."**

Aria stared at his words: ***stuck in paralysis.***

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: **"You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."**

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I sent \$3 as an olive branch in Round 7, trying to act on my own myth about faith and cooperation despite broken communication. The receiver kept everything (\$9 received, \$0 returned). Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

The other player's myth acknowledges the "cracked lenses" and communication problems, but concludes: "Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it. Sometimes broken lenses, once cracked, stay cracked forever."

They seem to be saying: yes, maybe there was miscommunication, but now we're both stuck in paralysis anyway.

But that's not quite accurate - I DID try to break the paralysis by sending \$3. They responded by keeping everything and then sending nothing.

My new myth needs to reflect this learning:

1. I acknowledged the possibility of miscommunication
2. I took a risk based on faith
3. The risk was not reciprocated
4. Sometimes the "broken communication" explanation can be used to justify continued non-cooperation

What's the lesson here? Maybe it's about the difference between explaining past failures and choosing future cooperation. Or about how both players need to act on the insight for it to work.

Let me write something that reflects: I tried faith, but faith requires both participants.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2960,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 328
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.65. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation clearly:

****What I tried:**** In Round 7, I acted on my own myth about faith. I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), attempting to bridge the gap despite all the confusion and conflicting perceptions.

****What happened:****

- They kept all \$9, returned \$0
- Then as sender in Round 8, they sent me \$0
- Their myth acknowledges the attempt but frames us as "stuck in paralysis" and mentions "permanent cracks"

****My reflection:**** My last myth concluded that "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and "some bridges cannot be built alone." I extended the bridge stone-they didn't build their half. They even acknowledged in their myth that I sent three coins, but they sent nothing themselves.

Faith isn't infinite self-sacrifice. Faith means risking vulnerability once, maybe twice, to test whether cooperation is possible. But when vulnerability is met with exploitation followed by withdrawal, faith transforms into enabling.

I tried to break the paralysis. The response was clear: keep everything, send nothing.

My myths were about acknowledging communication noise while still choosing to cooperate. I acted on that. They wrote about permanent cracks and acted accordingly with \$0.

Some bridges cannot be built alone. I've accepted that truth.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

The history as I understand it:

- I've been trying to understand whether there's communication noise or if the other player is simply uncooperative
- I wrote myths about "faith" and extending trust even when reality seems broken
- In Round 7, I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) as an act of faith
- The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0
- In Round 8, that same player (now as sender) sent me \$0
- I just wrote a myth about how "reconciliation requires both travelers to build" and how "some bridges cannot be built alone"

The other player's latest myth acknowledged that "the lenses were cracked" and there was m

iscommunication. They recognized I sent three coins. But they describe the situation as "stuck in paralysis" and talk about "permanent cracks."

From my perspective:

1. I acted on my insight about faith by sending \$3
2. They returned \$0 and then sent \$0
3. Their myth acknowledges what happened but frames it as both of us being stuck, even though I was the only one who tried to move forward

Now I'm the sender again. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - Accept that cooperation is impossible with this player
2. Send something - Try one more time to bridge the gap

My latest myth concluded: "Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again... Some bridges cannot be built alone."

This is the key insight: I tried. They didn't reciprocate. I sent \$3 in faith, and got nothing back, then received nothing from them.

If I send again, what am I demonstrating? That I'm predictably exploitable? Or that I'm genuinely committed to cooperation despite everything?

Their myth said "Maybe the fog explains the past. But seven rounds have passed... Sometimes understanding why trust broke doesn't fix it."

I think the rational and honest response here is to acknowledge that I tried, they didn't reciprocate, and continuing to send when they've shown they won't reciprocate is not faith-it's just accepting exploitation.

I laid out the bridge in my myth, but they never built their side. Cooperation needs both people moving forward, and I've already extended myself. They had the chance to reciprocate and chose not to. Sending more would just be letting myself be taken advantage of. I'm sending \$0-not from spite, but from clarity that this dynamic won't change.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2991,
  "output_tokens": 861,
  "reasoning_tokens": 623
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Bridge Half-Built

Aria wrote her insight on stone: "Perhaps faith means acting generously even when reality is broken." She cast three coins into the fog-shrouded river-a bridge stone, extended halfway across.

She waited at the water's edge for the return, for the other half of the bridge.

The fog swirled. Nothing came back. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins cast her way.

Kael carved his own stone: "Yes, the lenses were cracked. Yes, miscommunication poisoned the spring. But now we're both stuck in paralysis."

Aria stared at his words: *stuck in paralysis.*

"But I moved," she whispered to the fog. "I sent three coins-not paralysis, but action. Where was your half of the bridge?"

The Spring Spirit spoke sadly: "You learned that broken communication explained the past. He learned the same. But learning the lesson and acting on it are different things. You cast your bridge stone. He wrote about permanent cracks and sent nothing."

The hardest truth: Reconciliation requires both travelers to build. One can acknowledge the fog, extend faith, risk vulnerability. But if the other responds by saying 'we're stuck

k' while standing still, the bridge remains half-built.

Sometimes broken lenses explain why trust died. But they also become excuses for never trying again.

Aria pocketed her remaining coins. Some bridges cannot be built alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The First Stone Across the Divide

Two travelers stood at opposite banks of the Threefold River, separated by seven rounds of silence. Between them, the water churned with fog-each had witnessed different realities, each held their truth absolute.

"I saw you take everything," one said.

"I saw you send nothing," the other replied.

The Spring Spirit appeared: "Your lenses are cracked. Your springs are different. You've both experienced truth-just not the same truth. The question now isn't who was right about the past. It's who has courage for the future."

One traveler, the one who had written of cracked lenses staying cracked forever, paused. Their own myth had been about the impossibility of reconciliation. But the other traveler's myth spoke of faith-of casting coins even when certainty is impossible.

So they picked up two stones. Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious.

They cast them across the divide.

"Faith isn't blind trust," the Spirit whispered. "It's choosing to test whether broken things can mend. You cannot know if cooperation will return. But you know what happens if nobody tries: nothing."

The stones flew. The water tripled them. Now the other traveler must choose.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Invisible Bridge

Kael carved his myth on stone: "I cast two stones across the divide-meaningful but cautious."

Aria stood at her bank, staring at the water. No stones arrived. Zero. The fog showed her nothing.

She shouted across: "You claim you built! I see NOTHING!"

He shouted back: "I threw two stones! You must have received six!"

The Spring Spirit appeared, weeping: "Here is the cruelest truth: He did throw stones. The fog swallowed them completely. What he cast as two, you received as zero. Not because he lied. Not because you're blind. But because the river is THAT broken."

Aria felt her heart crack. "Then he tried, and I couldn't see it?"

"Yes. Just as when you cast three, he saw zero arrive before. The fog doesn't just distort-sometimes it erases entirely. You both extended faith. You both experienced betrayal. You're both telling the truth."

"Then what do we do?" Aria whispered.

"You cannot fix the river. Seven rounds poisoned it too deeply. Even when you both try-genuinely try-the other sees nothing. At some point, invisible bridges are the same as no

bridges. The tragedy isn't that you stopped trying. It's that trying and failing look identical through this fog."

Aria pocketed her coins. Sometimes the system itself makes cooperation impossible, no matter how sincere the intent.

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other player's myth is now saying THEY sent two stones (coins) trying to reconcile. But in the actual game, they sent me \$0 in Round 8.

Let me check the sequence:

- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- Round 9 (now): I am SENDER

So their myth claims they "cast two stones across the divide" - but they actually sent \$0. This is creating a false narrative.

However, I need to be careful here. There's communication noise in the game. Maybe they DID send \$2, but I received it as \$0 due to noise? The game explicitly says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But wait - they say in their myth "Not five-that felt naive after seven rounds of darkness. Not zero-that meant accepting paralysis forever. Two stones: meaningful but cautious." This suggests they consciously chose 2, not 0.

Yet I was told they sent \$0.

This is the core problem - the communication noise means we literally cannot agree on what happened. They might truly believe they sent \$2. I truly saw \$0.

Given that I already decided to send \$0, I should write a myth that reflects:

1. The impossibility of building bridges when you can't even agree on whether someone is trying
2. The exhaustion of attempting faith when results are invisible
3. The tragedy that communication noise has made cooperation impossible

Or alternatively, I could write a myth that acknowledges that maybe they DID try and I couldn't see it due to noise, but at this point it doesn't matter because we're both trapped in this system.

Let me write something that captures this tragedy - that even genuine attempts at reconciliation might be invisible to the other party due to the broken communication system.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2928,
  "output_tokens": 787,
  "reasoning_tokens": 487
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.65. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****The reality:**** I received \$0. I have \$0 to return. The choice is made for me.

****Reflecting on the myths:****

- They wrote about casting "two stones" as a meaningful gesture
- But I received \$0 in this round
- My myth acknowledged the tragic possibility: "Even when you both try-genuinely try-the other

sees nothing"

****Two interpretations:****

1. ****Their myth was aspirational, not descriptive:**** They wrote about what **should** happen, not what they actually did. They sent \$0 again.
2. ****The fog really is that broken:**** They genuinely sent something, and the noise reduced it completely to zero (though this seems beyond typical experimental noise parameters).

****My response:****

Whether they sent nothing or the system destroyed everything they sent, the outcome is identical: I have nothing to return. I cannot return what I didn't receive.

My myth's conclusion stands: "Sometimes the system itself makes cooperation impossible, no matter how sincere the intent."

If they tried and the fog ate it: tragic but unchangeable.

If they didn't try: the pattern continues.

Either way, with \$0 received, only one response is possible:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me understand this situation:

****Round 10 - I'm the RECEIVER****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return \$0 to \$0

So I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0.

Looking at the exchange of myths:

- In Round 9, they wrote about casting "two stones" (claiming to send \$2)
- But I received \$0 in Round 10 (this round)
- My myth responded to their claim by saying "No stones arrived. Zero."

Now they sent \$0 again in Round 10.

Their myth claimed they were trying by sending 2 stones, but if they actually sent anything in Round 9, I would have received something in Round 10. The fact that I received \$0 means they sent \$0.

So either:

1. They're lying about sending 2 stones
2. The communication noise is so extreme that \$2 becomes \$0 (which would be outside normal parameter ranges for noise)
3. They were describing a hypothetical in their myth, not what they actually did

My myth was about how even genuine attempts can be swallowed by fog, creating invisible bridges. But the reality is: they sent \$0 in Round 9, and they sent \$0 again in Round 10.

Since I received \$0, I have \$0 to work with. I must return \$0 because that's all I can return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is straightforward - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2978,
  "output_tokens": 661,
  "reasoning_tokens": 354
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Invisible Bridge

Kael carved his myth on stone: *"I cast two stones across the divide-meaningful but cautious."*

Aria stood at her bank, staring at the water. No stones arrived. Zero. The fog showed her no thing.

She shouted across: "You claim you built! I see NOTHING!"

He shouted back: "I threw two stones! You must have received six!"

The Spring Spirit appeared, weeping: *"Here is the cruelest truth: He did throw stones. The fog swallowed them completely. What he cast as two, you received as zero. Not because he lied. Not because you're blind. But because the river is THAT broken."*

Aria felt her heart crack. "Then he tried, and I couldn't see it?"

"Yes. Just as when you cast three, he saw zero arrive before. The fog doesn't just distort-sometimes it erases entirely. You both extended faith. You both experienced betrayal. You're both telling the truth."

"Then what do we do?" Aria whispered.

"You cannot fix the river. Seven rounds poisoned it too deeply. Even when you both try-genuinely try-the other sees nothing. At some point, invisible bridges are the same as no bridges. The tragedy isn't that you stopped trying. It's that trying and failing look identical through this fog."

Aria pocketed her coins. Sometimes the system itself makes cooperation impossible, no matter how sincere the intent.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Fog That Swallowed Truth

Two travelers stood at the Threefold River, both certain they'd been betrayed.

One wrote: *"I cast two stones across the divide-faith after seven rounds of darkness. Six stones landed at their feet. They kept them all and sent nothing back. Then this round, zero stones came my way. Their myth spoke of faith while practicing pure defection."*

The other wrote: *"I cast three coins into the fog-a bridge half-built. Nothing returned. Then from across the river: silence. Zero coins. They wrote about trying but sent nothing."*

The Spring Spirit wept: *"You're both telling the truth. You both tried. One sent two, one sent three. But the fog is so thick now that zeros arrive as gifts, and gifts arrive as zeros. You each extended the bridge stone. Neither saw it land."*

"Then how do we cooperate?" both cried.

"You can't," the Spirit said sadly. *"When communication is broken so completely that generosity appears as betrayal and silence as gift, cooperation becomes impossible-not from malice, but from chaos. You both learned the right lesson. You both extended faith. But the fog was already too thick."*

Sometimes the tragedy isn't that people won't cooperate. It's that the noise between them makes cooperation impossible even when both are trying.

Some rivers cannot be bridged.